Dark Souls

The Board Game

Second Edition Rulebook



An unofficial, non-commercial fan work

Foreword

This book is the complete rulebook for Dark Souls: The Board Game, Second Edition. It gathers the rules of the core game and of every expansion into one text, resolves the conflicts between them, and incorporates the revisions that extended play has shown to be necessary. Nothing beyond this book and the game components is required to play.

The Second Edition alters the shape of play in a few deliberate ways. Encounters are shorter, and downtime between turns is reduced. Each defensive choice, whether to *block*, *resist*, *dodge* or *parry*, is viable. Andre's shop offers a chosen selection rather than a random one, and progression is paced across the whole adventure. Where the printed text of a card conflicts with this book, this book governs.

Terms set in italics are defined in the Glossary (see §21). Worked examples are labelled *Example* and are not themselves rules. Numbered procedures are followed in order. Where a rule is stated in one section and used in another, the using section refers to the owning section with a reference in the form (see §N.M).

Rules compiled and revised by PittedPanda. With thanks to Santuric, Wilhelm, Astray, Manuel, Chud, Winston, Jyace, Absolute Disgrace, Zed and Gorus, and to the players whose work informed these rules.

Based on Dark Souls: The Board Game by Steamforged Games Ltd. Dark Souls is a trademark of Bandai Namco Entertainment Inc. and FromSoftware, Inc. This is an unofficial, non-commercial fan work.

Contents

1 Introduction 4

2 Game Components 5
2.1 Characters 5
2.2 Enemies 5
2.3 Bosses 5
2.4 Phantoms 6
2.5 Treasure Cards 6
2.6 Encounter Cards and Ambush Cards 6
2.7 Dice 7
2.8 Tokens and Terrain Elements . . 7
2.9 Expansion Components 8

3 Characters 9
3.1 Character Dashboards 9
3.2 Equipment Slots 10
3.3 Stat Progression Track 10
3.4 Endurance Bar 10
3.5 Character Tokens 11

4 Equipment 12
4.1 Equipment Cards 12
4.2 Upgrades 13
4.3 Spells 13
4.4 Embers 14

5 Tiles and Nodes 15
5.1 Tiles and Nodes 15
5.2 Movement 15
5.3 Node Model Limits 15
5.4 Range 16
5.5 Terrain 16

6 Setup 18
6.1 Character Setup 18
6.2 Treasure Deck Setup 18
6.3 Shop Setup 19
6.4 Bonfire Setup 19
6.5 Encounter Setup 19
6.6 Setup After the Mini-Boss 20
6.7 Setup After the Main-Boss 21

7 Gameplay 23
7.1 Objective and Loss Conditions . 23
7.2 Death and Hollowing 23
7.3 Embering 23
7.4 Sparks 24
7.5 Encounters 24
7.6 Souls 26
7.7 Treasure Rewards 26

8 Combat Basics 28
8.1 Target versus Hit 28
8.2 Enemy Data Cards 28
8.3 Enemy Scaling 29
8.4 Pushing 29
8.5 Conditions 30

9 Enemy Turn 33
9.1 Overview 33
9.2 Enemy Movement 33
9.3 Enemy Attacks 34
9.4 Block and Resist 35
9.5 Dodge 36
9.6 Parry and Riposte 37

10 Character Turn 38
10.1 Turn Order 38
10.2 Character Movement 39
10.3 Character Attacks 39
10.4 Two-Handed Attacks 41
10.5 Stat Scaling 41

11 Returning to the Bonfire 43
11.1 The Bonfire 43
11.2 Resting 43
11.3 The Firekeeper 44
11.4 Blacksmith Andre 44
11.5 Resuming Exploration 45

12 Phantoms 46
12.1 Summons 46
12.2 Invaders 47

13 Mimics 49
13.1 Chests and Ambush Cards 49
13.2 The Mimic Encounter 49
13.3 Mimic Rewards 50
13.4 Failed Mimic Encounters 50

14 Crystal Lizards 51

15 Boss Encounters 52
15.1 The Fog Gate 52
15.2 Overview 52
15.3 Boss Tiles 53
15.4 Boss Data Cards 53
15.5 Boss Behaviour Cards 54
15.6 Arcs and Defence 55

16 Boss Turns 58
16.1 Overview 58
16.2 Boss Movement and Symbols . 58
16.3 Boss Attacks 60
16.4 Boss Aggro 60
16.5 Boss Death 61

17 Boss Special Rules 62
17.1 Rules Common to Several Bosses 62
17.2 Core Set 63
17.3 Asylum Demon and Stray Demon 63
17.4 Darkroot 64
17.5 Iron Keep 64
17.6 Explorers 64
17.7 Tomb of Giants 65
17.8 Black Dragon Kalameet 65
17.9 Executioner's Chariot 65
17.10 Bosses of Other Expansions . . 67

18 Campaign Play 68
18.1 Setup 68
18.2 The Fog Gate 69
18.3 Sparks 69
18.4 Adding and Dropping Players . 70
18.5 Encounter Rewards 70
18.6 The Bonfire 71
18.7 Bonfire Ascetic 71
18.8 Transposition 72

19 Campaigns 73
19.1 The First Journey 73
19.2 The Coiled Sword 73
19.3 Ambush Lies Ahead 74
19.4 The Gauntlet 74
19.5 Facing the Abyss 74
19.6 Demon Hunting 75
19.7 Call of the Abyss 75
19.8 A Hollow Pursuit 76
19.9 The Undead Colosseum 76
19.10 Into the Depths 76
19.11 Playing with Fire 77
19.12 Big Game Hunting 77

20 Player versus Player 78
20.1 Setup 78
20.2 Turn Order 78
20.3 Character Turns 78
20.4 Attacking a Character 79
20.5 Pushes and Conditions 79
20.6 Traps 80
20.7 Death 80
20.8 Victory 80
20.9 After the PvP Encounter 80

21 Glossary 82

22 F.A.Q. 90
22.1 Characters and Actions 90
22.2 Attack and Defence 90
22.3 Conditions and Terrain 91
22.4 Encounters, Souls, and the Bonfire 91
22.5 Bosses 92
22.6 Phantoms, Mimics, and Crystal Lizards 92
22.7 Campaign Play 92

A Weapon Stat Revisions 93
Revised Requirements 93
Treasure Type 94

B Card Amendments 95
Additional Treasure 95
Revised Treasure 95
Enemy Data Cards 96
Boss Data and Behaviour Cards . . . 97



CHAPTER 1

1 Introduction

Dark Souls: The Board Game, Second Edition is a cooperative dungeon crawl for one to four players. Each player controls one character. The party explores a chain of encounters, learns the behaviours of its enemies, returns to the *bonfire* to rest and grow stronger, and at last faces a boss.

The party must defeat a *mini-boss* and then a *main-boss*, both chosen during setup (see §6.5). If the party chooses, a *mega-boss* waits beyond the main-boss (see §6.7). Characters who die rise *hollow*, and regain their humanity only by resting at the bonfire or by consuming an *ember* (see §7.2). The bonfire's *sparks* are few, and every rest spends one (see §7.4).

Nameless accursed undead, seek strength, and prepare to die.



GRAVELORD NITO



BLACK KNIGHT



GIANT SKELETON ARCHER



GIANT SKELETON SOLDIER

CHAPTER 2

2 Game Components



Everything needed to play is listed in this chapter: characters, enemies, bosses, phantoms, cards, dice, tokens, tiles, and the components particular to each expansion. Each entry names the set that supplies it. Two set codes are used throughout: PWA is the Painted World of Ariamis expansion, and ToG is the Tomb of Giants expansion.

2.1 Characters

Each character has a model, a character dashboard (see §3.1), three or four *starting equipment* cards, and ten *class-specific treasure* cards, of which five are *transposed treasure* (see §2.5). A character supplied by two sets is listed with both.

- Assassin (Core)
- Cleric (Characters or ToG)
- Deprived (Characters or PWA)
- Herald (Core)
- Knight (Core)
- Mercenary (Characters or PWA)
- Pyromancer (Characters or ToG)
- Sorcerer (Characters or PWA)
- Thief (Characters or ToG)
- Warrior (Core)

2.2 Enemies

Each enemy has a *data card* (see §8.2) and the number of models listed. *Crystal lizards* (see §14) and *mimics* (see §13) are optional enemies with their own rules.

- 3x Alonne Bow Knight (Iron Keep)
- 3x Alonne Knight Captain (Iron Keep)
- 3x Alonne Sword Knight (Iron Keep)
- 2x Black Hollow Mage (Executioner's Chariot)
- 2x Bonewheel Skeleton (PWA)
- 3x Crossbow Hollow (Core)
- 2x Crow Demon (PWA)
- 2x Crystal Lizard (Iron Keep)
- 2x Demonic Foliage (Darkroot)
- 2x Engorged Zombie (PWA)
- 4x Falchion Skeleton (Executioner's Chariot)
- 3x Firebomb Hollow (Explorers)
- 2x Giant Skeleton Archer (ToG)
- 2x Giant Skeleton Soldier (ToG)
- 3x Hollow Soldier (Core)
- 3x Ironclad Soldier (Iron Keep)
- 2x Large Hollow Soldier (Core)
- 2x Mimic (Explorers), with the Hungry Mimic and Voracious Mimic data cards
- 1x Mushroom Child (Darkroot)
- 1x Mushroom Parent (Darkroot)
- 2x Necromancer (ToG)
- 5x Phalanx (PWA)
- 1x Phalanx Hollow (PWA)
- 3x Plow Scarecrow (Darkroot)
- 2x Sentinel (Core)
- 3x Shears Scarecrow (Darkroot)
- 3x Silver Knight Greatbowman (Core)
- 3x Silver Knight Spearman (Explorers)
- 3x Silver Knight Swordsman (Core)
- 3x Skeleton Archer (ToG)
- 1x Skeleton Beast (ToG)
- 3x Skeleton Soldier (ToG)
- 2x Snow Rat (PWA)
- 2x Stone Guardian (Darkroot)
- 2x Stone Knight (Darkroot)

2.3 Bosses

Each *boss* has a model, a *health dial*, a *data card* (see §15.4), a *behaviour deck* (see §15.5), and two or more *boss treasure* cards (see §2.5). A *mini-boss* or *main-boss* is fought on the *boss tiles* (see §15.3). A *mega-boss* is fought on the *mega-boss game board* supplied with its expansion (see §2.9), after a Level 4 encounter (see §6.7).

Mini-bosses

- Asylum Demon (Asylum Demon)
- Black Knight (ToG)
- Boreal Outrider Knight (Core)
- Gargoyle (Core)
- Heavy Knight (PWA)
- Old Dragonslayer (Explorers)
- Titanite Demon (Core)
- Winged Knight (Core)

Main-bosses

- Artorias (Darkroot)
- Crossbreed Priscilla (PWA)
- Dancer of the Boreal Valley (Core)
- Gravelord Nito (ToG)
- Great Grey Wolf Sif (Darkroot)
- Ornstein & Smough (Core)
- Pursuer (Explorers)
- Sir Alonne (Iron Keep)
- Smelter Demon (Iron Keep)

Ornstein & Smough is one main-boss fought with two models, Dragonslayer Ornstein and Executioner Smough. The pair shares one health dial and one behaviour deck, and each behaviour card names the model that acts (see §17.1).

Mega-bosses

Each mega-boss is supplied by the expansion of the same name, except the Stray Demon, which is supplied by the Asylum Demon expansion together with the Asylum Demon mini-boss.

- Black Dragon Kalameet
- Executioner's Chariot
- The Four Kings
- Gaping Dragon
- Guardian Dragon
- The Last Giant
- Manus, Father of the Abyss
- Old Iron King
- Stray Demon
- Vordt of the Boreal Valley

2.4 Phantoms

Phantoms are the *summons* and *invaders* of the Phantoms expansion (see §12). Each phantom has a model, a *data card*, and *behaviour cards*; Kirk, Knight of Thorns and Longfinger Kirk share one model.

Standard summons are called before a mini-boss encounter and advanced summons before a main-boss or mega-boss encounter (see §12.1). Standard invaders appear before the mini-boss is defeated and advanced invaders afterwards (see §12.2). The cards, tokens, and health dials of the expansion are listed with the expansion components (see §2.9).

Standard summons

- Eygon of Carim
- Horace the Hushed
- Ruined Aflis
- Siegward of Catarina
- Sword Master

Advanced summons

- Lucatiel of Mirrah
- Rogue Witch Beatrice
- Sellsword Luet
- Sirris of the Sunless Realms
- Solaire of Astora

Standard invaders

- Kirk, Knight of Thorns
- Maldron the Assassin
- Maneater Mildred
- Melinda the Butcher
- Oliver the Collector
- Xanthous King Jeremiah

Advanced invaders

- Armorer Dennis
- Fencer Sharron
- Invader Brylex
- Longfinger Kirk
- Marvelous Chester
- Paladin Leeroy

2.5 Treasure Cards

Treasure card. Any card from a treasure deck: *starting equipment*, *class-specific treasure*, *common treasure*, *legendary treasure*, or *boss treasure*. A treasure card that may be equipped to a dashboard slot is an *equipment card* (see §4.1). The treasure decks are built at setup from the cards listed below (see §6.2).

Treasure cards	Core	Expansions
Starting equipment	13	45
Class-specific treasure	40	120
Common treasure	60	145
Legendary treasure	10	20
Boss treasure	18	63

In all, 534 treasure cards are available. Each character's ten class-specific treasure cards comprise five class treasure cards and five *transposed treasure* cards. Each boss has two or more boss treasure cards, one of which is awarded when the boss is defeated (see §16.5). The 12 invader treasure cards of the Phantoms expansion are listed with the expansion components (see §2.9).

2.6 Encounter Cards and Ambush Cards

Encounter cards

An *encounter card* lists the level, enemies, terrain, and traps of one encounter. One encounter card is dealt face down to each encounter tile at setup (see §6.5) and is revealed when the characters enter the tile (see §7.5, Encounter Start). The *encounter level* is shown by the card's level icon: Level 1 ,

Level 2, or Level 3. A trapped encounter is marked with the trap icon (see §5.5, Traps).

Encounter Cards	Core	Expansions
Level 1	12	31
Level 2	12	31
Level 3	12	31
Level 4	0	40

In all, 169 encounter cards are available. Level 4 encounter cards are supplied only by the mega-boss expansions, four with each, and are used only for the encounter that precedes a mega-boss (see §6.7).

Ambush Cards

- 5x Ambush cards (Explorers)

Each *ambush card* shows Treasure or Mimic on its face. When *mimics* are in play, one ambush card is dealt face down beside each encounter tile and is revealed only when the characters choose to open that tile's *chest* (see §13).

2.7 Dice

- 5x Black dice (Core)
- 4x Blue dice (Core)
- 2x Orange dice (Core)
- 4x Green dice (Core)

Black, blue, and orange dice are rolled for attacks (see §10.3) and for *block* and *resist* (see §9.4); each face shows a value from zero to four. Green dice are rolled for *dodges* (see §9.5) and parries (see §9.6); each face is blank or shows one dodge icon. The faces of each die are as follows.

Die	Faces
Black	0, 1, 1, 1, 2, 2
Blue	1, 1, 2, 2, 2, 3
Orange	1, 2, 2, 3, 3, 4
Green	blank, blank, blank, dodge, dodge, dodge

2.8 Tokens and Terrain Elements

Cubes and Dials

- 32x Damage cubes (red) (Core)
- 32x Stamina cubes (black) (Core)
- 16x Stat cubes (white) (Core)
- 8x Hollow cubes
- 1x Spark dial (Core)

Damage cubes and *stamina cubes* are placed on the *endurance bar* (see §3.4). *Stat cubes* mark each character's *stat tier* on the stat progression track (see §3.3). *Hollow cubes* are of a colour distinct from the damage, stamina, and stat cubes; two are placed on the endurance bar of a character who is *hollow* (see §7.2).

The *spark* dial records the party's sparks (see §7.4). Each boss's *health dial* is supplied with the boss (see §2.3); the summon, invader, and mimic health dials are supplied with their expansions (see §2.9).

Tokens

- 1x Aggro token (Core)
- 4x Luck tokens (Core)
- 4x Heroic action tokens (Core)
- 4x Estus flask tokens (Core)
- 4x Ember tokens (Core)
- 6x Wound tokens of value 1, 3x Wound tokens of value 3, and 1x Wound token of value 5 (Core)
- 10x Soul tokens of value 1, 5x Soul tokens of value 3, 3x Soul tokens of value 5, and 1x Soul token of value 8 (Core)
- 36x Condition tokens: 7x each of bleed, poison, frostbite, and stagger (Core and expansions); 4x calamity (Black Dragon Kalameet); 4x corrosion (Gaping Dragon)
- 20x Trap tokens (Core)
- 1x Fog gate token (Core)

The *aggro token* marks the character with *aggro* (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order). *Luck*, *heroic action*, and *estus flask* tokens have a ready side and a used side; the *ember token* marks an *embered* character (see §3.5).

Wound tokens record the damage suffered by enemies (see §8.2). Soul tokens record each character's *souls* (see §7.6); the supply of soul tokens is not a limit, and when it is exhausted the players track souls with any other counters.

Condition tokens mark *bleed*, *poison*, *frostbite*, *stagger*, *calamity*, and *corrosion* (see §8.5). *Trap tokens* are dealt face down to the basic nodes of a trapped encounter (see §5.5, Traps). The *fog gate* token marks the entrance to a boss encounter (see §15.1).

Terrain Elements

- 4x Chest tokens (Core)
- 5x Gravestone tokens (Core)
- 8x Barrel tokens (Core)
- 4x Pillar tokens (Asylum Demon)

Chests, *gravestones*, and *barrels* are placed on the terrain nodes shown by the encounter card (see §5.5). The Explorers expansion supplies 18x Terrain models, which stand in place of the corresponding tokens. *Pillar tokens* are placed only on the pillar nodes of the Asylum Demon mega-boss game board (see §5.5, Pillars).

Tiles

- 1x Bonfire tile (Core)
- 6x Encounter tiles, double-sided (Core)
- 2x Boss tiles (Core), the mini-boss tile and the main-boss tile

The *bonfire* tile is the characters' haven and the start of every exploration (see §11.1). Encounter tiles are the sites of encounters (see §5.1). The *boss tiles* are the sites of mini-boss and main-boss encounters (see §15.3); each mega-boss expansion supplies its own game board (see §2.9).

2.9 Expansion Components

The components below are supplied by the expansions named and are used only with the rules of the sections cited.

Phantoms

- 10x Summon models, 10x Summon data cards (five standard, five advanced), 40x Summon behaviour cards, and 1x Summon health dial (see §12.1)
- 11x Invader models, 12x Invader data cards (six standard, six advanced), 64x Invader behaviour cards, 12x Invader treasure cards, and 1x Invader health dial (see §12.2)
- 6x Standard invader tokens, 6x Advanced invader tokens, and 3x Blank invader tokens (see §12.2)

An *invader token* shows an invader icon or is blank. When an *invasion* is provoked, one invader token is placed face down on each face-down encounter card, and each is revealed when the characters fight that encounter (see §12.2).

Explorers

- 2x Mimic models, 2x Mimic data cards (Hungry Mimic and Voracious Mimic), 14x Mimic behaviour cards, 1x Mimic health dial, and 5x Ambush cards (see §13)
- 18x Terrain models (see §2.8)

Iron Keep

- 3x Titanite Scale cards (see §14)

Characters

- 10x Armour set models, which represent armour treasure cards and have no effect on play

Mega-boss expansions

Each mega-boss expansion supplies one set of the following components.

- 1x Mega-boss game board, double-sided, with a Level 4 encounter side and a mega-boss side (see §6.7 and §15.3)
- 4x Level 4 encounter cards (see §2.6)
- 1x Mega-boss model (the Executioner's Chariot has two), 1x Mega-boss data card, 1x Health dial, the behaviour cards listed on the data card, and 2x Mega-boss treasure cards (see §6.7)
- Black Dragon Kalameet only: 8x Strafe cards and 4x Calamity tokens (see §17.8)
- Executioner's Chariot only: 4x Track behaviour cards and 1x Mega-boss setup card (see §17.9)
- Asylum Demon only: 4x Pillar tokens (see §17.3)

The *mega-boss game board* is used with its Level 4 encounter side face up for the Level 4 encounter and with its mega-boss side face up for the mega-boss encounter (see §6.7). The Executioner's Chariot expansion also supplies the Black Hollow Mage and Falchion Skeleton enemies (see §2.2) and six encounter cards of Levels 1 to 3. The Asylum Demon expansion also supplies the Asylum Demon mini-boss (see §2.3).



CLERIC PYROMANCER THIEF SKELETON SOLDIER



SKELETON ARCHER NECROMANCER SKELETON BEAST



3 Characters

Each character is one of the undead who answer the bonfire's call. The character is a model on the tiles and a dashboard beside the player, and the dashboard records what the character carries, learns, and suffers. This chapter describes the dashboard and its parts: the equipment slots, the stat progression track, the endurance bar, and the character tokens.



A character dashboard. *1 Name. 2 Illustration. 3 Heroic action. 4 Equipment slots. 5 Endurance bar. 6 Stat progression track. 7 Threat, printed as Taunt Level. 8 Heroic action token slot. 9 Luck token slot. 10 Estus flask token slot. 11 Ember token slot.*

3.1 Character Dashboards

Each character is represented by a model and by the *character dashboard* of the same name. The model stands on the tiles and occupies a *node* (see §5.1). The dashboard records everything particular to the character's class, and it carries the cards, cubes, and tokens that change during play.

The character dashboard shows the following.

- The name and the illustration identify the character.
- The character's *heroic action* is printed in full (see §3.5, Heroic Action).
- The four equipment slots hold the character's *armour* and weapons: the armour slot, the left weapon slot, the right weapon slot, and the *back-up slot* (see §3.2).
- The stat progression track records the character's four stats (see §3.3).
- The *endurance bar* records the stamina the character has spent and the damage the character has suffered (see §3.4).
- The *threat* value fixes the character's place in the turn order.
- The four token slots hold the heroic action, *luck*, *estus flask*, and *ember* tokens (see §3.5).

Threat. The value that fixes a model's place in the turn order. Characters act in descending order of threat, and the character with the highest threat takes the *aggro* token at the start of each encounter (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order). The dashboard prints the character's threat as its Taunt Level. Enemies and *phantoms* also have a threat value, printed on their *data cards* (see §8.2, §12).

The character's *souls* are kept on the dashboard as soul tokens (see §7.6). The character's inventory is kept beside the dashboard (see §3.2).

3.2 Equipment Slots

The dashboard has four equipment slots: the *armour* slot, the left weapon slot, the right weapon slot, and the *back-up slot*. Each slot holds only cards of the kind stated below. A character must meet an *equipment card*'s stat requirements to equip it (see §4.1).

Armour slot. The slot that holds one armour card, marked with the armour icon. An armour card cannot be equipped in a weapon slot.

Weapon slots. The left weapon slot and the right weapon slot: the weapon slot on the left of the dashboard as its player reads it, and the weapon slot on its right. Each holds one weapon card, marked with the one-handed weapon icon or the two-handed weapon icon. A one-handed weapon may be equipped in either weapon slot, and the other weapon slot may hold a second one-handed weapon. A two-handed weapon may be equipped in either weapon slot, and the other weapon slot must then be empty. A one-handed weapon equipped while the other weapon slot is empty is wielded *two-handed* (see §10.4).

Shields are weapon cards and occupy a weapon slot (see §4.1). Which weapon slot holds a shield matters for the *parry* and the *riposte* (see §9.6). Spell cards are equipped in a weapon slot or stored in an equipped *catalyst* (see §4.3).

Back-up slot. The slot that holds up to two *treasure cards* of any kind. Cards in the back-up slot are carried but not equipped. During an encounter, a character may exchange cards between the back-up slot and the armour and weapon slots only by the *Equip* minor action (see §10.1). An *ember card* must be in the back-up slot to be used (see §4.4).

Equipped. A card is equipped while it is in the armour slot or in a weapon slot. Cards in the back-up slot and in the inventory are not equipped. A character attacks only with the attack options of equipped cards (see §10.3) and rolls only the *block*, *resist*, and *dodge* dice shown on equipped cards (see §9.4, §9.5). Upgrade cards attached to an equipped card are equipped with it (see §4.2).

Inventory. A character's stack of unequipped treasure cards, kept face down beside the dashboard. The inventory has no limit. Outside an encounter, a character may move cards between the inventory and the dashboard's slots freely. During an encounter, the inventory cannot be accessed.

Outside an encounter, two characters may trade treasure cards between their inventories, one card for one card, if both players agree. During an encounter, characters cannot trade or give cards in any way.

> EXAMPLE The Knight has a one-handed sword in the right weapon slot, a shield in the left weapon slot, armour in the armour slot, and a two-handed axe in the back-up slot. During an encounter the Knight takes the Equip minor action, moves the sword and the shield to the back-up slot, which now holds two cards, and equips the axe in the right weapon slot. The left weapon slot stays empty while the axe is equipped.

3.3 Stat Progression Track

The stat progression track records the character's four stats: strength (STR), dexterity (DEX), intelligence (INT), and faith (FTH). Each stat has its own track with a base space and spaces for *stat tier* one, two, and three. Each space is printed with the stat's value at that tier, and each character has its own values. The character's current value in a stat is the value printed in the space that holds that stat's *stat cube*.

At setup, one stat cube is placed in the base space of each of the four tracks (see §6.1). A stat rises one tier at a time, from the base tier to stat tier one, from stat tier one to stat tier two, and so on. When a stat rises one tier, the character moves its stat cube one space to the right.

Characters raise stats only while resting at the *bonfire*, by paying *souls* to the Firekeeper (see §11.3). Each tier must be bought in sequence, and each tier has its own cost (see §11.3; for campaign play, see §18.6, Stat Tier Costs).

The track has no space for stat tier four. When a stat rises to stat tier four, the character replaces the stat cube in the stat tier three space with a red cube and returns the stat cube to the supply. A stat at stat tier four has a value of 40, or the stat tier three value plus five, whichever is higher. Stat tier four is the highest tier.

A character must meet an equipment card's stat requirements to equip it (see §4.1). A weapon whose highest stat requirement the character's stat exceeds by five or more is *scaled* (see §10.5).

> EXAMPLE The Warrior's strength stat cube is in the base space. While the characters rest at the bonfire, the Warrior pays the Firekeeper two souls for stat tier one and then four souls for stat tier two, and moves the strength stat cube two spaces to the right. The Warrior's strength is now the value printed in the stat tier two space.

3.4 Endurance Bar

The *endurance bar* is a row of 10 spaces along the bottom of the dashboard. It records both the stamina the character has spent and the damage the character has suffered. *Stamina cubes* (black) are placed from the left end of the bar and *damage cubes* (red) from the right end. The spaces not yet filled are the character's remaining capacity to spend stamina and to suffer damage.

The endurance bar is empty at the start of the game and is emptied when the characters rest at the *bonfire* (see §11.2). The bar may hold stamina cubes only, damage cubes only, or both.

When a character spends stamina, the character places one stamina cube for each point spent, filling the leftmost empty spaces first. When a character suffers damage, the character places one damage cube for each point of damage, filling the rightmost empty spaces first.

When a character recovers stamina, the character removes one stamina cube for each point recovered, taking the rightmost stamina cubes first. When a character recovers from damage, the character removes one damage cube for each point recovered, taking the leftmost damage cubes first. A recovery that finds no cube of the right kind to remove has no effect. A character recovers one stamina at the start of each of their turns (see §10.1).

When the two kinds of cube meet, the bar is full. If a character must place a damage cube and no empty space remains, the cube is not placed and the character dies (see §7.2). If a character must place a stamina cube and no empty space remains, the cube is not placed and the character is *staggered* instead; a character cannot choose to spend more stamina than the bar holds (see §10.1).

When a character is revived *hollow* (see §7.2), two *hollow cubes* are placed in the two rightmost spaces of the endurance bar. Those spaces hold no stamina or damage cubes while the hollow cubes remain, so a hollow character's endurance bar has eight spaces. The hollow cubes are removed only when the character stops being hollow (see §7.2).

> EXAMPLE The Warrior has three stamina cubes at the left of the endurance bar and four damage cubes at the right, so three spaces are empty. A Hollow Soldier hits the Warrior for four damage. The Warrior places three damage cubes in the three empty spaces and cannot place the fourth, so the Warrior dies.

> EXAMPLE The Herald is hollow, so two hollow cubes fill the two rightmost spaces of the endurance bar and eight spaces remain. The Herald has five damage cubes and two stamina cubes, leaving one empty space. The Herald chooses an attack option that costs one stamina rather than one that costs two, and fills the last empty space with a stamina cube.

3.5 Character Tokens

There are four types of character token: *heroic action*, *luck*, *estus flask*, and *ember*. Each character has one token of each type, and the dashboard has a slot for each.

The heroic action, luck, and estus flask tokens each have a ready side and a used side. The ready side is printed in brighter colours than the used side. A token's effect is available only while the token shows its ready side. When a character uses a token's effect, the character flips the token to its used side.

The heroic action, luck, and estus flask tokens begin the game ready, in their slots on the dashboard (see §6.1). They are flipped back to the ready side only when the characters rest at the *bonfire* (see §11.2). Clearing an encounter does not ready them (see §7.5, Encounter Recovery).

The ember token marks a character who is *embered*. It begins the game beside the dashboard, not in its slot, and is placed in its slot only when the character becomes embered (see §7.3).

Heroic action

Each dashboard prints a heroic action particular to the character's class. A character may flip the heroic action token to the used side as a *minor action* (see §10.1) to resolve the heroic action as printed. The printed wording of a heroic action overrides any other rule with which it conflicts. The token is readied only at the bonfire, so a character resolves the heroic action at most once between rests.

Luck

After rolling the dice for one of their own attack rolls or defence rolls (a *block*, *resist*, or *dodge* roll), a character may flip the luck token to the used side to reroll any or all of those dice. The character chooses every die to be rerolled at once and rerolls them together. The new results stand.

Estus flask

A character may flip the estus flask token to the used side as the Drink Estus *major action* (see §10.1) to remove all damage cubes from their endurance bar. Stamina cubes are not removed. Hollow cubes are not removed. Condition tokens are not removed.

The estus flask token is not readied when an encounter is *cleared*. It is flipped to the ready side only when the characters rest at the bonfire (see §11.2).

Ember

The ember token marks an embered character. When a character becomes embered, the character places the ember token in its slot on the dashboard; when an embered character dies, the ember token is removed from the dashboard (see §7.3). A character becomes embered by using an *ember card* (see §4.4). The effects of being embered, and when it ends, are stated with the embering rules (see §7.3). An embered character may summon a *phantom* before a boss encounter and attracts *invaders* (see §12).



CHAPTER 4

4 Equipment

Steel, cloth, and sorcery are all that stand between a character and the dark. Every weapon, shield, armour, spell, and upgrade is an equipment card. This chapter describes how those cards are read, equipped, improved, and consumed.

4.1 Equipment Cards

Treasure card. Any card drawn from a treasure deck or bought from Blacksmith Andre's *shop* (see §2.5). **Equipment card.** A treasure card that a character equips in a weapon or armour slot, stores in a *catalyst*, or attaches to an equipped card: weapon, shield, catalyst, spell, armour, and upgrade cards. An *ember card* is a treasure card that is consumed rather than equipped (see §4.4). Treasure cards from every expansion the party owns are included in the treasure decks (see §6.2).

CARD ANATOMY



An equipment card. *1 Name. 2 Card type. 3 Equipment slot. 4 Set symbol. 5 Range. 6 Stat requirements. 7 Attack options. 8 Block dice. 9 Resist dice. 10 Dodge dice. 11 Upgrade slots.*

Every equipment card shows the following parts. A part that does not apply to a card is not printed on it.

- **Name.** The card's name is printed across the top of the card.
- **Treasure type.** An emblem marks the card as *starting equipment*, *common treasure*, *class-specific treasure*, *transposed treasure*, *legendary treasure*, or boss treasure (see §2.5).
- **Slot icon.** The one-handed weapon icon, the two-handed weapon icon, or the armour icon shows which dashboard slot the card occupies (see §3.2).
- **Set symbol.** A symbol shows the core set or expansion the card belongs to.
- **Range.** The number beside the range icon is the card's base *range* (see §5.4).
- **Stat requirements.** Four values give the minimum strength (STR), dexterity (DEX), intelligence (INT), and faith (FTH) a character needs to equip the card.
- **Attack options.** Each line in the lower part of a weapon or spell card is one *attack option*: a stamina cost, the dice to roll, any fixed modifier, and any attack icons (see §10.3). An attack option that shows its own range uses that range in place of the card's base range (see §10.3, Range).
- **Block dice.** The dice beside the *block* icon are rolled against physical attacks (see §9.4).
- **Resist dice.** The dice beside the *resist* icon are rolled against magical attacks (see §9.4).
- **Dodge dice.** The dice beside the *dodge* icon are rolled to dodge (see §9.5).
- **Upgrade slots.** The upgrade slots icon shows how many *upgrade cards* the card holds: zero, one, or two (see §4.2).

Dice are shown as black 1, blue 2, or orange 3 die icons, and the number of each colour to roll is printed with the icon (see §2.7). Some dice carry a fixed modifier, +1 or −1 for example, which is added to or subtracted from the total rolled on those dice (see §9.4, §10.3).

CARD TYPES

Equipment cards are of five kinds, and Andre's shop is stocked by these kinds (see §6.3).

- A *weapon* is an equipment card that bears a weapon icon and whose art does not show a scroll. Catalysts, bows, crossbows, and throwable weapons are weapons.
- A *shield* is a one-handed weapon that shows block or resist dice and has no attack option. A shield is a weapon for the purpose of equipment slots (see §3.2) and counts as equipment in the other hand for two-handed attacks (see §10.4). A shield is required to *parry* (see §9.6).
- A *spell* is an equipment card that bears a weapon icon and whose art shows a scroll (see §4.3).
- An *armour* card bears the armour icon.

- An *upgrade card* bears the weapon upgrade icon or the armour upgrade icon (see §4.2). Rings and *Titanite* are upgrade cards.

Stat Requirements

A character may equip an equipment card only if each of the character's four stats equals or exceeds the card's matching *stat requirement*. A character's stat is the value marked on their stat progression track (see §3.3). A card's stat requirements also decide its treasure tier, split at a requirement of 25 (see §6.2).

A character whose stat exceeds a weapon's requirements by a wide margin wields it as a *scaled* weapon and gains a bonus to its attacks (see §10.5).

A character attacks by using one attack option of a weapon or spell equipped in a weapon slot as the *Attack* major action (see §10.3). A weapon that bears the two-handed icon requires the other weapon slot to be empty (see §3.2), and attacks with a *two-handed* weapon may reroll one die (see §10.4). When an enemy attacks the character, the block, resist, or dodge dice of the character's equipped cards are rolled in defence (see §9.4, §9.5).

> Example The Knight has 18 STR, 14 DEX, 9 INT, and 11 FTH. A Morning Star requires 16 STR only, so the Knight equips it. A Halberd requires 31 STR and 18 DEX; the Knight's strength is less than 31, so the Knight cannot equip the Halberd.

4.2 Upgrades

An *upgrade card* enhances the weapon or armour card it is attached to. An upgrade card bearing the weapon upgrade icon may be attached only to a weapon card. An upgrade card bearing the armour upgrade icon may be attached only to an *armour* card. An attached upgrade card is placed beneath the equipment card so that its rules text is visible.

Blacksmith Andre attaches and removes upgrade cards while the characters rest at the *bonfire* (see §11.4). Each attached upgrade card occupies one of the equipment card's *upgrade slots* (see §4.1, Card Anatomy). A card cannot hold more upgrade cards than it has upgrade slots. An upgrade card has its own *stat requirements*: a character may equip a weapon or armour card only if they meet the requirements of the card and of every upgrade card attached to it (see §4.1, Stat Requirements).

> Example The Knight's Sunless Armour has two upgrade slots. While the party rests at the bonfire, Andre attaches a Chloranthy Ring to it. The Chloranthy Ring fills one upgrade slot, and one upgrade slot remains free.

Titanite

Titanite upgrade cards (Titanite Shard, Titanite Chunk, Titanite Slab, and Titanite Scale) are weapon upgrades that fuse permanently to the weapon they are attached to. Once attached, a Titanite card cannot be removed, except when a Titanite Chunk or a Titanite Slab takes its place (see Appendix B, Titanite Replacement).

When a weapon with Titanite attached is sold, the Titanite is returned with the weapon to the bottom of the treasure deck of the weapon's tier (see §11.4). Every other upgrade card, such as a gem or a ring, is returned to the character's *inventory* when the card it is attached to is sold. A Titanite Scale is awarded for killing a crystal lizard (see §14).

> Example The Warrior's Morning Star has one upgrade slot. Andre attaches a Titanite Shard to it. The Morning Star holds no further upgrade card, and the Titanite Shard stays attached unless a Titanite Chunk later takes its place (see Appendix B).

Upgrade Spells

An upgrade card whose art shows a scroll is an *upgrade spell*. Andre does not attach upgrade spells. An upgrade spell is equipped in a weapon slot or stored in a *catalyst* (see §4.3), and it is attached during an *encounter* as the *Attack* major action (see §10.3). The character pays the stamina cost printed on the upgrade spell and attaches it to one weapon or armour card equipped to the same character.

Attaching an upgrade spell is the character's one spell attack option for the turn (see §4.3), and the weapon slot that holds the upgrade spell or its catalyst makes no other attack that turn. An attached upgrade spell occupies no upgrade slot. When the encounter ends, the upgrade spell returns to the character's inventory.

4.3 Spells

Spell Cards

A *spell* is an *equipment card* or *upgrade card* whose art shows a scroll. Spells belong to one of three schools, shown by the colour of the magic in the art and by the card's *stat requirements*.

- A pyromancy shows red or purple magic and has both an INT requirement and an FTH requirement.
- A sorcery shows blue or black magic and has an INT requirement only.
- A miracle shows yellow or pink magic and has an FTH requirement only.

A spell that is an equipment card is equipped in a weapon slot (see §3.2) or stored in a *catalyst*. An *upgrade spell* is attached to an equipped card during an *encounter* (see §4.2, Upgrade Spells).

A character may use at most one spell *attack option* per *turn*. Spells are never *scaled* (see §10.5). Spells are never *two-handed*: a spell gains no two-handed reroll, and a spell equipped with the other weapon slot empty is not two-handed (see §10.4). A spell attack option that bears the

magical damage icon ✦ deals magical damage, which the target reduces with its *resist* rather than its *block* (see §9.4).

Catalysts

A *catalyst* is a weapon card that stores spells of a matching school.

- A pyromancer flame stores up to three pyromancies.
- A staff, or a card named as a catalyst, stores up to three sorceries.
- A talisman or a chime stores up to three miracles.

A stored spell is placed beneath the catalyst card and occupies no equipment slot of its own. While the catalyst is equipped in a weapon slot, the character may use the attack options of a stored spell as if the spell were equipped. A character who does not meet a stored spell's stat requirements cannot use it (see §4.1, Stat Requirements).

A stored spell provides only its attack options; its block, resist, and dodge dice are not rolled. Using a stored spell's attack option counts as the catalyst's one attack for that turn. A character may move spells between a catalyst and their *inventory* only outside an encounter.

> EXAMPLE The Herald equips a talisman in the left weapon slot and stores three miracles beneath it. During the Herald's turn, the Herald pays the stamina cost of one stored miracle and uses its attack option. The talisman makes no other attack this turn, and the Herald uses no other spell attack option this turn. The Herald then attacks with the spear in the right weapon slot.

4.4 Embers

An *ember card* is a treasure card that a character consumes to become *embered* (see §7.3). Ember cards are stocked in the tier one *shop* at setup only and are not restocked (see §6.3). A character buys an ember card from the shop while the party rests at the *bonfire* (see §11.4).

A character may carry at most one ember card at a time, in the *back-up slot* or in the *inventory*. An embered character cannot carry an ember card. During an *encounter*, a character may consume an ember card only from the back-up slot (see §3.2). During an encounter, the inventory cannot be accessed, so an ember card there cannot be consumed until the encounter ends.

A character consumes an ember card by discarding it from the back-up slot, as the *Ember* major action during an encounter or at any time outside an encounter. The character then becomes embered and places an *ember token* on their dashboard (see §7.3). The ember token and the effects of being embered are set out with the character tokens (see §3.5, Ember) and with embering (see §7.3).



ADVENTURER'S ARMOUR



HAVEL'S ARMOUR



CATARINA ARMOUR



GUARDIAN ARMOUR



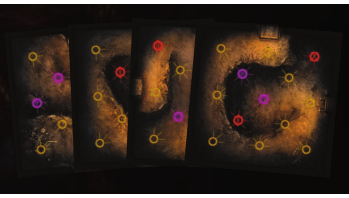
DARK ARMOUR



CRIMSON ROBES

CHAPTER 5

5 Tiles and Nodes



Every encounter is fought on a tile, and every tile is a fragment of a ruined world: a crypt, a courtyard, a hall of fallen pillars. The circular nodes printed on the tiles are the ground on which the characters stand, fight, and fall. This chapter describes tiles and nodes, movement, range, and the terrain that stands in the way.

5.1 Tiles and Nodes

Every *encounter* is fought on one or more tiles: an encounter tile, the *boss tiles* (see §15.3), or the *mega-boss game board* (see §6.7). The *bonfire* tile has no nodes, and no encounter is fought on it (see §11.1).

The edge of every tile is a wall. A *doorway* is a gap in the wall through which the characters pass from one tile to the next. Tiles are joined so that a doorway of each tile faces a doorway of the tile beside it (see §6.5). A tile's orientation is fixed when the tile is placed, and the tile is neither rotated nor moved until the tiles are next laid out for setup.

Every tile except the bonfire tile is printed with circular spaces called *nodes*. During an encounter every model occupies exactly one node; a model is never between nodes or in a doorway. Each node is one of three types: basic, spawn, or terrain.

Basic node. The most common node type, printed in yellow. *Trap tokens* are dealt to basic nodes (see §5.5, Traps).

Entry node. A basic node adjacent to a doorway. When the characters enter a tile, they are placed on the entry nodes beside the doorway through which they entered (see §7.5, Encounter Start).

Spawn node. A node on which enemy models are placed at the start of an encounter, as the *encounter card* directs (see §7.5, Encounter Start). The mini-boss tile has a mini-boss spawn node, the main-boss tile a main-boss spawn node, and a mega-boss game board a mega-boss spawn node; the *boss* is placed there at the start of its encounter (see §15.3).

Terrain node. A node on which a *terrain* token or model is placed at the start of an encounter, as the encounter card directs (see §5.5).

A spawn node or terrain node that holds no enemy or terrain is entered, left, and counted for range exactly as a basic node is.

Adjacent node. A node directly next to another node: horizontally, vertically, or diagonally. Two nodes separated by a wall, whether the wall is the edge of the tile or a wall printed across a tile or a mega-boss game board, are not adjacent. Nodes on different tiles are not adjacent; the two boss tiles joined for a main-boss encounter form one tile (see §15.3).

5.2 Movement

A model *moves* when it leaves its *node* for an *adjacent node*. A model that moves several nodes moves one node at a time, and the rules of each node it enters apply as it enters that node.

Move. Any change of node that a model makes by the *Walk* or *Run* minor action (see §10.2), by a *shift* icon (see §10.3, Shift), or by an enemy or boss movement icon (see §9.2; §16.2). The movement that follows a successful *dodge* (see §9.5) and the forced movement of a *push* (see §8.4) are not moves; a rule that treats them differently names them.

Valid node. A node that a model may enter by a given form of movement: an adjacent node that no wall separates from the model's node and that holds no *terrain* blocking that form of entry (see §5.5). A model may move, dodge, or be pushed only into a valid node. If no valid node exists for a move, a dodge, or a push, the model stays on its node. A node at its *node model limit* is a valid node; a model that enters it displaces another model as §5.3 describes.

During an encounter, no model may leave the tile or tiles on which the encounter is fought, and no model may pass through a doorway. Models pass between tiles only when the party travels from one encounter to the next (see §7.5, Encounter Start).

The stamina cost and the limits of each form of movement are stated with that form (see §10.2 for Walk and Run; §10.3, Shift; §9.2 for enemy movement; §16.2 for boss movement; §9.5 for the dodge; §8.4 for pushes).

5.3 Node Model Limits

Several models may share one *node*. The *node model limit* is three non-boss models, friendly or hostile in any combination, and one *boss* model. A boss model does not count towards the three.

When a fourth non-boss model enters a node, the players must *push* one of the three models already on the node to a *valid node* chosen by the players (see §8.4). If the entering model is a character or a *summon*, the players must push a

character or summon if one is on the node. If the entering model is an enemy or an *invader*, the players must push an enemy or invader if one is on the node. If no such model is on the node, the players push any model on it.

When a boss model moves onto a node that holds another boss model, the boss already on the node is pushed to a valid node chosen by the players (see §17.1).

> EXAMPLE The Knight, the Herald, and a Hollow Soldier share a node. The Warrior walks onto it, so the players must push a character or summon: they choose the Herald, who is pushed to a valid node of their choice. The Hollow Soldier stays. Then the Gargoyle moves onto a node that holds the Knight, the Herald, and the Assassin; the boss does not count towards the limit, so no model is pushed.

5.4 Range

Range is the distance between two models, counted in *nodes*. It is counted along the shortest chain of *adjacent nodes* from one model's node to the other's, and each step along the chain counts one. Range is counted between models, friendly or hostile alike.

Range 0 is the same node. Range 1 is an adjacent node or the same node. A range of any number N reaches a model up to N nodes away, including every closer node. Range ∞ (infinity) is unlimited and reaches every model in the encounter.

Range is a maximum, never a minimum: an attack or effect with range 2 reaches models at range 0, 1, or 2, except where its own rules say otherwise (for example the *shaft* icon, see §10.3, Shaft).

Range is never blocked. *Terrain*, *trap tokens*, and other models on the nodes between two models do not block range and do not lengthen it. A wall blocks range only because the nodes on either side of it are not adjacent, so the chain of nodes is counted around the wall.

The range of a character's attack is printed on the equipment card or on the attack option (see §10.3, Range). The range of an enemy's attacks is printed on its data card (see §9.3), and a boss's range on each of its behaviour cards (see §16.3).

> EXAMPLE The Assassin stands two nodes from a Hollow Soldier, and the node between them holds a *gravestone*. The Assassin's attack option has range 2. The gravestone does not block range, so the Hollow Soldier is within range. The Knight stands on the far side of a wall from the same Hollow Soldier; the two nodes touch across the wall but are not adjacent, and the Knight's attack option with range 1 cannot reach it.

5.5 Terrain

Terrain is the set of obstacles placed on a tile at the start of an *encounter*. There are five kinds: *gravestones*, *barrels*, *chests*, and pillars, which are placed on *terrain nodes* as the *encounter card* directs, and traps, which are dealt to *basic nodes* (see §7.5, Encounter Start). Each terrain token or model occupies one *node*.

The rules in this section apply to every model alike: characters, enemies, *phantoms*, and the *boss*. No terrain blocks *range* (see §5.4). An enemy or boss moves around terrain that blocks it, choosing its path as §9.2 or §16.2 describes.

When the characters rest at the *bonfire* and the encounters are reset (see §11.5), terrain stays on its nodes. What else happens to each kind of terrain at that time is stated under that kind.

Gravestones

A gravestone blocks its node completely. No model may *move*, *dodge*, or be *pushed* into a node containing a gravestone.

When an encounter that contains one or more gravestones is *cleared*, the players may *scry* one card, however many gravestones the tile holds. The scry is resolved during Encounter Resolution, which states the cards that may be scried and what is done with them (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution).

When the characters rest at the bonfire, a gravestone stays on its node.

Barrels

A barrel token has an intact side and a destroyed side, and a barrel begins every encounter intact. No model may move into a node containing an intact barrel.

A model may dodge or be pushed into a node containing an intact barrel. When it does, the barrel is destroyed: turn the token to its destroyed side, or remove a barrel model from the tile. A destroyed barrel blocks nothing, and its node is used as a basic node for the rest of the encounter.

When the characters rest at the bonfire and the encounters are reset, every barrel is restored: turn each destroyed token back to its intact side, and return each removed barrel model to its terrain node.

Chests

A chest token has a closed side and an open side. A chest is placed closed side up, and one face-down *treasure card* from the treasure deck of the current tier is placed beneath it (see §7.5, Encounter Start; §7.7). No model may move, dodge, or be pushed into a node containing a chest, whether the chest is closed or open.

A chest is opened, and the card beneath it awarded, only when the encounter that contains it is cleared (see §7.7). If *mimics* are in play, a chest is opened only as §13 describes. Opening a chest turns the token to its open side; an opened chest is never closed again and holds no further treasure.

When the characters rest at the bonfire and the encounters are reset, a chest stays on its node and on its current side.

Traps

An encounter whose encounter card shows the trap icon is a trapped encounter. *Trap tokens* are dealt to its tile the first time the encounter is set up, as part of Encounter Start (see §7.5, Encounter Start), and thereafter stay on the tile. A trap token is blank or shows a *dodge difficulty* and a damage value. Trap tokens are dealt to the tile as follows.

1. Shuffle every trap token in the supply face down.
2. Deal one face-down trap token to each basic node of the tile, except the basic nodes along a tile edge that adjoins another tile, beginning with the nodes farthest from the *entry nodes*.
3. If the supply runs out before every such node has a token, leave the remaining nodes without a trap.

Traps do not block movement, dodging, or pushes. When a character enters a node holding a face-down trap token, whether by a *move*, by the movement that follows a successful *dodge*, or by a *push*, the token is turned face up at once, before anything else is resolved. If the token is blank, nothing happens. Otherwise each character on that node must either suffer the damage shown or attempt to dodge it as an attack with the dodge difficulty shown (see §9.5); each player chooses for their own character. The dodge follows every rule in §9.5, including the move that follows a successful dodge. If the dodge fails, the character suffers the damage shown. Trap damage is not an attack, and it cannot be blocked or resisted.

A face-up trap token has no further effect during that encounter. Only characters trigger traps, and only characters are affected by them; enemies, bosses, and phantoms neither trigger traps nor suffer their damage.

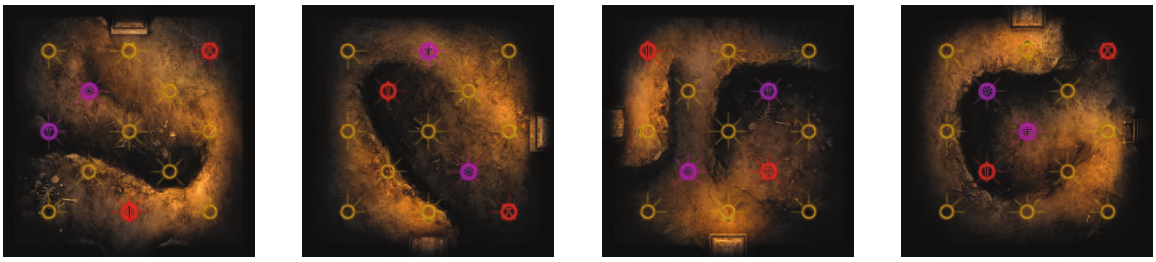
When the characters rest at the bonfire and the encounters are reset, every face-up trap token is turned face down and stays on its node. Trap tokens are not dealt to the same tile again when its encounter is reset.

> EXAMPLE The Knight runs onto a basic node holding a face-down trap token and turns it face up. The token shows dodge difficulty 1 and damage 3. The Knight chooses to dodge, pays one stamina, and rolls a total of 1: the dodge succeeds, the Knight suffers no damage and moves to an adjacent node. A Hollow Soldier then moves onto the same node; the face-up token has no effect on it.

Pillars

Pillar tokens exist only in the Asylum Demon expansion. At the start of a mega-boss encounter fought on that expansion's mega-boss game board, one pillar token is placed on each of its four pillar nodes (see §17.3). No model may move, dodge, or be pushed into a node containing a pillar token.

A pillar is destroyed only as §17.3 describes. Once destroyed, its node is used as a basic node for the rest of the encounter. When the characters rest at the bonfire, destroyed pillars are returned to their pillar nodes (see §17.3).



Encounter tiles

CHAPTER 6

6 SETUP



The fire is lit, and the dark waits beyond it. Before the first step is taken, the party readies its characters, builds the treasure decks, stocks Blacksmith Andre's shop, kindles the bonfire, and lays the tiles that lead to the bosses it has chosen to face. Campaign play alters parts of this setup (see §18.1).

6.1 Character Setup

Each player chooses one character (see §2.1). The number of characters in the party sets the scaling of enemy health and attack values (see §8.3) and the starting number of *sparks* (see §6.4, §7.4).

1. Place each character's dashboard (see §3.1) in front of its player.
2. Equip each character with its *starting equipment*, the equipment cards that bear the character's class icon, in the slots the cards show (see §3.2, §4.1).
3. Place one *stat cube* on the base tier space of each of the character's four stat progression tracks (see §3.3).
4. Place the character's *luck*, *heroic action*, and *estus flask* tokens on the dashboard, ready side up (see §3.5).
5. Place the *ember* tokens, *damage cubes*, *stamina cubes*, *hollow cubes*, soul tokens, *condition* tokens, *trap tokens*, and *wound tokens* in a supply within reach of every player (see §2.8).
6. Place the *aggro token* on the character with the highest *threat* value (see §7.5, Encounter Start).
7. If the party consists of one character, place six *souls* on that character's dashboard (see §7.6).

6.2 Treasure Deck Setup

Two treasure decks are built at setup: the *tier one treasure* deck and the *tier two treasure* deck. Every *treasure card* belongs to one of six types (see §2.5), and its type and its stat requirements (see §4.1) decide which deck, if any, it enters.

TREASURE CARD TYPES

Starting equipment. The three or four equipment cards a character begins with, marked with that character's class icon. Starting equipment is equipped during character setup (see §6.1). It is not shuffled into either treasure deck.

Common treasure. A treasure card that is not starting equipment, class-specific, transposed, legendary, or boss treasure. A common treasure card with any stat requirement of 25 or more is tier two. A common treasure card whose stat requirements are all below 25 is tier one.

Class-specific treasure. A treasure card marked with a small white class emblem in its top-right icon. The emblem has no rules effect. Class-specific treasure is sorted into tier one or tier two by its stat requirements exactly as common treasure is.

Transposed treasure. A class-specific treasure card marked with a blue light in the top-right of the card. All transposed treasure is tier two.

Legendary treasure. A treasure card marked with an orange light beneath a chest in the top-right of the card. Legendary treasure cannot be purchased, and no legendary treasure card enters a treasure deck at the start of the game. The first time the tier two shop is stocked, five legendary treasure cards drawn at random are shuffled into the tier two treasure deck and the rest are returned to the game box (see §6.3, Restocking After a Boss).

Boss treasure. A treasure card marked with a boss's silhouette over an orange light in the top-right of the card. Boss treasure is not shuffled into a treasure deck. The boss treasure cards of each selected boss are placed with that boss during encounter setup (see §6.5), and one of them is awarded at random when the boss is defeated (see §16.5). The boss treasure cards of bosses that are not selected are returned to the game box.

Ember cards are not shuffled into either treasure deck. One ember card per character is placed in the tier one shop at the start of the game (see §6.3), and the rest are returned to the game box (see §4.4).

TIER ONE TREASURE DECK

The tier one treasure deck holds every common treasure card and every class-specific treasure card whose stat requirements are all below 25. It holds no starting equipment, ember cards, transposed treasure, legendary treasure, or boss treasure.

TIER TWO TREASURE DECK

The tier two treasure deck holds every common treasure card and every class-specific treasure card with at least one stat requirement of 25 or more, and every transposed treasure card. It holds no starting equipment, ember cards, or boss treasure. Legendary treasure enters the deck only

after the tier two shop is first stocked (see §6.3, Restocking After a Boss).

Building the treasure decks

1. Set aside every boss treasure card, every legendary treasure card, every ember card, and every starting equipment card that is not equipped.
2. Return the starting equipment cards that are not equipped to the game box.
3. Sort the remaining treasure cards into two piles: cards whose stat requirements are all below 25, and cards with at least one stat requirement of 25 or more.
4. Add every transposed treasure card to the second pile.
5. Shuffle the first pile to form the tier one treasure deck.
6. Shuffle the second pile to form the tier two treasure deck.

Expansion treasure

Treasure cards from every expansion in the party's collection are included and are sorted into the tier one and tier two treasure decks by the rules of this section.

6.3 Shop Setup

Blacksmith Andre's *shop* holds two piles of face-up *treasure cards*: the tier one shop and the tier two shop. The tier one shop is stocked at the start of the game. The tier two shop is first stocked when the *mini-boss* is defeated (see §6.6), and both shops are restocked after each boss is defeated (see §6.6, §6.7); in campaign play the shops are restocked when a *section* is completed (see §18.6). Purchase and sale prices are set out in Andre's rules (see §11.4).

Stocking categories

Each shop is stocked by category: three weapons, three armour cards, two shields, two upgrades, and two spells. For stocking, a treasure card belongs to the first of the following categories that describes it (see §4.1).

- An upgrade is a card with the weapon-upgrade icon or the armour-upgrade icon, including rings and *titanite*.
- A spell is a card whose art shows a scroll.
- A shield is a weapon card that shows a *block* or *resist* value and has no *attack option*.
- An armour card is a card with the *armour* icon.
- A weapon is any other card that is equipped in a weapon slot, including *catalysts* and throwable cards.

Stocking at the start of the game

1. Draw one card from the tier one treasure deck.
2. If the card's category is not yet full, place it face up in the tier one shop; otherwise set it aside.
3. Repeat steps 1 and 2 until every category is full or the deck is exhausted. A category still unfilled when the deck is exhausted stays short.
4. Shuffle the set-aside cards back into the tier one treasure deck.
5. Add one *ember card* per character to the tier one shop, and return the remaining ember cards to the game box.

Restocking after a boss

The shops are restocked when a boss is defeated (see §6.6, §6.7) and at no other time in the standard game. Ember cards remaining in the tier one shop stay there. No ember card is added to a shop after the start of the game.

1. Place every card remaining in the tier one shop, other than ember cards, on the bottom of the tier one treasure deck.
2. Stock the tier one shop from the tier one treasure deck by steps 1 to 4 of Stocking at the Start of the Game, without adding ember cards.
3. If the tier two shop has been stocked before, place every card remaining in it on the bottom of the tier two treasure deck.
4. Stock the tier two shop from the tier two treasure deck in the same way.
   - **4.1** If a *legendary treasure* card is drawn, set it aside with the other set-aside cards. It is shuffled back into the tier two treasure deck with them when stocking ends.
5. If the tier two shop has been stocked for the first time, draw five legendary treasure cards at random without revealing them, shuffle them into the tier two treasure deck, and return the remaining legendary treasure cards to the game box.

6.4 Bonfire Setup

1. Place the *bonfire* tile on the table, leaving room for the encounter tiles and the boss tile (see §6.5).
2. Set the *spark* dial to six minus the number of characters (see §7.4).
3. Place every character's model on the bonfire tile.
4. Place the *tier one treasure* and *tier two treasure* decks face down beside the bonfire tile.
5. Place the tier one *shop* face up beside the bonfire tile, leaving room beside it for the tier two shop.

> EXAMPLE The Knight, the Herald, and the Assassin set out together. The party sets the spark dial to three, six minus three characters, and every enemy they meet is scaled for three characters.

6.5 Encounter Setup

Encounter setup lays the route from the *bonfire* to the first boss: the bosses are chosen, the tiles are laid, and each encounter tile receives its encounter card and its treasure.

Boss Selection

1. The party chooses one *mini-boss* and one *main-boss* from the bosses in its collection (see §2.3).
2. The party may add a *mega-boss* as the *final boss* (see §6.7).
3. Take each selected boss's model, *data card*, *behaviour cards*, *health dial*, and *boss treasure* cards, and return the boss treasure cards of the other bosses to the game box.
4. Keep the main-boss's components, and the mega-boss's if one is in play, aside until they are needed (see §6.6, §6.7).

Random boss selection is an optional rule. It requires no expansion. The party decides during setup whether random boss selection is in play.

When random boss selection is in play, each boss is chosen at random in step 1: shuffle the data cards of every boss of that rank in the party's collection and reveal one. A mega-boss added in step 2 is chosen in the same way.

Encounter Tiles

1. Draw four of the six encounter tiles at random.
2. Place each encounter tile with either side face up, as the party chooses.
3. Arrange the bonfire tile, the four encounter tiles, and the mini-boss tile, which is one of the two *boss tiles* (see §15.3), in a grid of two rows of three tiles, with the bonfire tile and the mini-boss tile in opposite corners.
4. Turn each encounter tile so that exactly two of its doorways open on to adjacent tiles, forming a single route from the bonfire tile through all four encounter tiles to the mini-boss tile.
5. Place the *fog gate* token on the doorway between the fourth encounter tile and the mini-boss tile (see §15.1).
6. Place the mini-boss's model, data card, health dial, and boss treasure cards on the mini-boss tile.
7. Build the mini-boss's *behaviour deck* (see §15.5) and place it face down on the mini-boss tile.

Encounter Cards

The *encounter levels* of the four encounters on the route to a boss are printed on that boss's data card. Encounter levels increase from the tile adjacent to the bonfire tile towards the boss tile.

1. Build the encounter decks: shuffle separately the Level 1 , Level 2 , and Level 3 *encounter cards* of the set that supplies the mini-boss (see §6.5, Expansion Encounters).
2. Deal one encounter card face down to each encounter tile, of the level the mini-boss's data card gives for that tile's position on the route.
3. Deal one *tier one treasure* card per character face down to each encounter tile. These cards are the encounter's treasure reward and are awarded when the encounter is first *cleared* (see §7.7).
4. If *mimics* are in play, deal one *ambush card* face down beside each encounter tile (see §13).
5. If *invaders* are in play, place the *invader tokens* on the encounter cards (see §12.2).

Expansion Encounters

Each encounter deck is built only from the encounter cards of the set that supplies the next boss. Encounter cards of other sets are not used on that leg of the exploration.

Mixed encounter decks are an optional rule. They require at least one expansion that supplies encounter cards. The party decides during setup whether mixed encounter decks are in play. When they are in play, each encounter deck is built from the encounter cards of its level from every set in the party's collection.

> EXAMPLE The party selects the Gargoyle as its mini-boss and Great Grey Wolf Sif as its main-boss. The decks for the four encounters before the Gargoyle are built from the core set's encounter cards. After the Gargoyle is defeated, the decks for the four encounters before Sif are built from the Darkroot expansion's encounter cards.

Optional Rules

The party decides during setup whether each of the following optional rules is in play. Each is stated in full in its own section.

- Random boss selection replaces the party's choice of bosses with a random draw (see §6.5, Boss Selection).
- Mixed encounter decks draw encounter cards from every set in the party's collection (see §6.5, Expansion Encounters).
- A mega-boss adds a Level 4 encounter and a final boss after the main-boss (see §6.7).
- Mimics require the Explorers expansion (see §13).
- *Crystal lizards* require the Iron Keep expansion (see §14).
- *Phantoms*, both *summons* and invaders, require the Phantoms expansion (see §12).
- Player versus player (PvP) encounters follow the defeat of each boss (see §20.1).

6.6 Setup After the Mini-Boss

When the *mini-boss* is defeated (see §16.5), the route is rebuilt for the second leg of the exploration, which leads to the *main-boss*. If player versus player (PvP) encounters are in play, a PvP encounter follows the mini-boss's defeat (see §20.1).

1. Return any *dropped souls* remaining on the tiles to the characters who dropped them (see §7.6).
2. Return the four *encounter cards* to the game box.
3. Clear every remaining token from the encounter tiles.
4. If *mimics* are in play, gather the *ambush cards* and shuffle them (see §13).

5. Flip the four encounter tiles to their other sides and shuffle them.
6. Arrange the *bonfire* tile, the four encounter tiles, and the main-boss tile in a straight line, with the bonfire tile and the main-boss tile at opposite ends. The main-boss tile is the two *boss tiles* joined as one (see §15.3).
7. Turn each encounter tile so that a single route runs from the bonfire tile through all four encounter tiles to the main-boss tile.
8. Move the *fog gate* token to the doorway between the fourth encounter tile and the main-boss tile (see §15.1).
9. Place the main-boss's model, *data card*, *health dial*, and *boss treasure* cards on the main-boss tile.
10. Build the main-boss's *behaviour deck* (see §15.5) and place it face down on the main-boss tile.
11. Build the encounter decks from the set that supplies the main-boss (see §6.5, Expansion Encounters).
12. Deal one encounter card face down to each encounter tile, of the level the main-boss's data card gives for that tile's position on the route (see §6.5, Encounter Cards).
13. Deal one *tier two treasure* card per character face down to each encounter tile. These cards are the encounter's treasure reward (see §7.7).
14. If mimics are in play, deal one ambush card face down beside each encounter tile (see §13).
15. If *invaders* are in play, place the *invader tokens* on the encounter cards (see §12.2).
16. Restock the tier one *shop* and stock the tier two shop (see §6.3, Restocking After a Boss).
17. Add one *spark* to the spark dial (see §7.4).
18. Place every character's model on the bonfire tile. The characters rest at the bonfire without spending a spark (see §11.2) and may visit the *Firekeeper* (see §11.3) and Blacksmith Andre (see §11.4).
19. Exploration resumes from the encounter tile adjacent to the bonfire tile (see §11.5).

6.7 Setup After the Main-Boss

A *mega-boss* is an optional rule. It requires a mega-boss expansion. The party decides during setup whether a mega-boss is in play (see §6.5, Boss Selection). If no mega-boss is in play, the *main-boss* is the *final boss*, and its defeat wins the game (see §7.1).

When a mega-boss is in play, the defeat of the main-boss (see §16.5) is followed by one *Level 4 encounter* and then by the mega-boss encounter. Both are fought on the *mega-boss game board* supplied with the mega-boss (see §2.9). If player versus player (PvP) encounters are in play, a PvP encounter follows the main-boss's defeat (see §20.1).

1. Return any *dropped souls* remaining on the tiles to the characters who dropped them (see §7.6).
2. Return the *encounter cards*, the encounter tiles, and the *boss tiles* to the game box.
3. Place the mega-boss game board adjacent to the *bonfire* tile, with its Level 4 encounter side face up, the side that shows enemy spawn nodes and terrain nodes, and with one of its doorways aligned with a doorway of the bonfire tile.
4. Shuffle the mega-boss's four Level 4 encounter cards and deal one face down to the game board.
5. Shuffle the mega-boss's *boss treasure* cards and deal one face down to the game board. This card is the Level 4 encounter's treasure reward (see §6.7, Level 4 Encounters). No tier two treasure cards are dealt to the game board.
6. Place the mega-boss's model, *data card*, *health dial*, *behaviour cards*, and remaining boss treasure cards beside the game board.
7. Restock the tier one and tier two *shops* (see §6.3, Restocking After a Boss).
8. Add one *spark* to the spark dial (see §7.4).
9. Place every character's model on the bonfire tile. The characters rest at the bonfire without spending a spark (see §11.2) and may visit the *Firekeeper* (see §11.3) and Blacksmith Andre (see §11.4).
10. The characters enter the Level 4 encounter from the bonfire tile (see §7.5, Encounter Start).

Level 4 Encounters

Level 4 encounter. The single encounter fought on the Level 4 encounter side of a mega-boss game board, after the main-boss is defeated and before the mega-boss encounter.

A Level 4 encounter is set up and fought as any other encounter (see §7.5), with the following differences. All four basic nodes along the wall beside the doorway are *entry nodes*. The encounter card places more enemies, *terrain*, and *trap tokens* than a Level 1 to 3 card, and the card is followed as printed.

The encounter's soul reward is the Level 4 reward (see §7.6). Its treasure reward is the single mega-boss treasure card dealt to the game board, which is awarded when the encounter is *cleared* in the same way as a chest's treasure card (see §7.7).

If a revealed Level 4 encounter card requires a set the party does not own, return it to the game box, deal another of the mega-boss's Level 4 encounter cards face down to the game board, and reveal that card instead.

A Level 4 encounter that is cleared is not fought again and does not reset when the characters rest at the bonfire. A Level 4 encounter that is *failed* resets as any other encounter does (see §11.2).

In campaign play, a Level 4 encounter listed in a section is fought on a mega-boss game board placed in the section's tile sequence (see §18.1).

The mega-boss encounter

Clearing the Level 4 encounter grants no free rest. Before passing through the fog gate the party may rest at the bonfire at the cost of one spark (see §11.2); the cleared Level 4 encounter does not reset.

1. Remove every token, model, and card from the game board.
2. Flip the game board to its mega-boss side and align one of its doorways with a doorway of the bonfire tile.
3. Place the *fog gate* token on that doorway (see §15.1).
4. Set up the mega-boss encounter as a boss encounter (see §15.2), with the mega-boss's model on the mega-boss *spawn node* and its data card, health dial, and *behaviour deck* (see §15.5) beside the game board.
5. Apply the mega-boss's special rules (see §17).

The mega-boss encounter begins when the characters pass through the fog gate (see §15.1). Death and hollowing are resolved as in any encounter (see §7.2), and a failed mega-boss encounter is resolved as any other failed boss encounter (see §15.2). Defeating the mega-boss wins the game (see §7.1). In campaign play, a mega-boss that is not the campaign's final boss is fought under the same rules, and the campaign continues when it is defeated (see §18.1).



ENCOUNTER CARD, LEVEL 1



TREASURE CARD



GRAVESTONE



BARREL



CHEST



SPARK DIAL

CHAPTER 7

7 Gameplay



The characters set out from the bonfire and fight their way, tile by tile, towards the boss that waits at the end of the road. Every death costs, every rest costs, and the sparks that pay for both are few. This chapter states how the game is won and lost and how every encounter begins, runs, and ends.

7.1 Objective and Loss Conditions

The players win the game when any character survives to defeat the *final boss*. In the standard game the final boss is the *main-boss*. During setup the party may instead add a *mega-boss*, fought after the main-boss, as the final boss (see §6.5 and §6.7). Victory over the final boss is shared by every player.

If the party chose player versus player (PvP) during setup, a PvP *encounter* is fought after each boss is defeated (see §20).

The players lose the game when the characters are required to rest at the *bonfire* and the *spark* dial shows zero. The characters are required to rest when an encounter is *failed*: when every character has died, or when a *hollow* character dies (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution). The party cannot choose to rest while the spark dial shows zero (see §7.4).

These conditions apply in every encounter, including boss and mega-boss encounters. A failed boss encounter is resolved as any other failed encounter.

7.2 Death and Hollowing

A character dies when they must place a *damage cube* on their *endurance bar* and no space is free (see §3.4). A dead character is out of play for the rest of the *encounter* and takes no *turns*.

When a character dies:

1. Place all of the character's *souls* on the encounter tile, in a pile separate from any other character's *dropped souls* (see §7.6).
2. Discard the character's *ember token*, if present (see §7.3).
3. If the character holds the *aggro token*, move it to the living character with the highest *threat* (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order).
4. Remove the character's model from the tile and place it on its side beside the *bonfire* tile.

If the encounter is *cleared*, each character who died in it is revived *hollow* during Encounter Recovery (see §7.5, Encounter Recovery). If every character dies, the encounter is *failed* instead (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution); a character who adventures alone is therefore never revived hollow.

Hollow cube. One of eight cubes of a colour distinct from the damage, stamina, and stat cubes. Two *hollow cubes* block the two rightmost spaces of a hollow character's endurance bar.

A hollow character has two hollow cubes on the two rightmost spaces of their endurance bar, which reduce the bar from ten usable spaces to eight. *Stamina cubes* and damage cubes fill the remaining eight spaces as usual (see §3.4). Hollow cubes are not removed by the *Rest* major action (see §10.1), by the *estus flask* (see §3.5, Estus Flask), or by Encounter Recovery. Hollow is removed only by resting at the bonfire (see §11.2) or by becoming *embered* (see §7.3).

A hollow character who dies is *lost*. A lost character is removed from play exactly as any dead character: their souls are dropped, their ember token is discarded, and their model is placed beside the bonfire tile. When a character becomes lost, the encounter is failed at once (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution) and the characters must rest at the bonfire; if the *spark* dial shows zero, the players lose the game (see §7.1). A lost character is not revived by clearing an encounter but only when the characters rest at the bonfire (see §11.2), and the rest removes their hollow cubes as usual.

These rules apply in every encounter, including boss and *mega-boss* encounters. Death in a PvP encounter has no cost (see §20.7).

7.3 Embering

A character becomes *embered* by discarding an *ember card* from their back-up slot (see §4.4). The card may be discarded as the *Ember* major action during an encounter (see §10.1) or at any time outside an encounter.

To ember a character:

1. Discard the ember card.
2. Remove every *damage cube* from the character's *endurance bar*.
3. Remove the character's *hollow cubes*, if present.
4. Place an *ember token* in the ember slot of the character's dashboard (see §3.5, Ember).

When an embered character suffers three or more damage from a single attack, the character reduces that damage by one. An embered character may call a *summon* before a boss encounter (see §12.1). Embered characters draw *invaders* into their encounters (see §12.2).

An embered character cannot hold an ember card. If a character becomes embered while holding an ember card, that character must at once give the card to a character who is neither embered nor holding an ember card. If no such character exists, the card is returned to the tier one shop (see §6.3).

The ember token stays on the dashboard until the character dies (see §7.2); it is not removed by resting at the *bonfire*. When a boss is defeated, every character becomes embered without discarding an ember card (see §16.5).

7.4 Sparks

Sparks are the party's shared resource and are tracked on the *spark* dial (see §6.4). The party begins the game with sparks equal to six minus the number of characters.

Each time a *mini-boss*, *main-boss*, or *mega-boss* is defeated and the game does not end, the party gains one spark (see §16.5), and the characters then rest at the *bonfire* without spending a spark. Resting at the bonfire at any other time costs one spark (see §11.2). In the standard game sparks cannot be gained in any other way; campaign play varies these rules (see §18.3).

The party cannot rest at the bonfire while the spark dial shows zero. If the characters are required to rest while the dial shows zero, the players lose the game (see §7.1).

7.5 Encounters

An *encounter* is a battle fought on an encounter tile against the enemies set out by the tile's *encounter card* (see §2.6). The characters begin at the encounter tile adjacent to the *bonfire* tile and advance one tile at a time towards the boss tile. Boss encounters follow these rules except where the boss rules differ (see §15 and §16); PvP encounters follow their own rules (see §20).

Encounter Start

The party may skip an encounter whose encounter card carries a black cube (an encounter marked *cleared*). Each character places one *stamina cube* on their *endurance bar* for each encounter skipped since the party last fought an encounter or rested at the bonfire, to a maximum of three. The cubes are placed when the characters enter the next encounter they fight.

The party may skip only if every character has enough free spaces on their endurance bar for the required stamina cubes (see §3.4). A skipped encounter is not fought and awards nothing.

> EXAMPLE The first three encounters are marked cleared. The party skips all three and enters the fourth encounter. Each character begins the fourth encounter with three stamina cubes on their endurance bar.

When the characters arrive at an encounter tile:

1. Turn the tile's encounter card face up, if it is face down.
2. If the encounter card carries a black cube, the party may skip the encounter: the characters move on to the next tile and begin again from step 1.
3. Place each character model on an *entry node* of the tile (see §5.1), no more than three models to a node (see §5.3).
4. Place one stamina cube on each character's endurance bar for each encounter skipped since the party last fought or rested, to a maximum of three.
5. Place the enemy models, scaled for the number of characters (see §8.3), on the spawn nodes and the *terrain* tokens on the terrain nodes shown on the encounter card (see §5.1 and §5.5).
6. If the encounter card shows the trap icon, deal *trap tokens* (see §5.5, Traps).
7. If *invaders* are in play, reveal the tile's invader token (see §12.2).
8. If *crystal lizards* are in play and the encounter card shows the crystal lizard symbol, place the crystal lizards (see §14).
9. Place one face-down treasure card from the treasure deck of the current tier (see §6.2) beneath each *chest* token placed on the tile for the first time.
10. Place the *aggro token* on the character with the highest *threat* . If two or more characters share the highest threat, the players choose which of them takes the aggro token and the order in which the tied characters take their *turns*; the order is kept for the whole encounter.

Encounter Turn Order

An encounter is fought in *rounds*. In each round every enemy model takes a turn, then every character takes a turn. Rounds continue until every enemy model has been killed or the encounter is *failed* (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution).

Enemy models take their turns one at a time in descending threat order (see §9.1). If two or more enemy models share a threat value, the model nearest to a character takes its turn first. If those models are equidistant from the nearest character, the model with the most *wound tokens* takes its turn first. If they are still tied, the players choose which takes its turn first.

Characters then take their turns one at a time in descending threat order (see §10.1), in the order settled at Encounter Start. A dead character takes no turn. An invader takes a turn after each character's turn (see §12.2). In boss

encounters the boss and the characters alternate turns (see §16.1).

The aggro token marks the character targeted by enemy behaviours that bear the skull icon (see §9.3). After the last character's turn of each round, the aggro token moves to the character who inflicted the most damage on enemy models during that round, counting wound tokens placed and damage recorded on an invader's health dial. If two or more characters tie for the most damage, or no character inflicted damage, the aggro token stays with its holder.

When the character holding the aggro token dies, the token moves at once to the living character with the highest threat; the players settle ties. In boss encounters the aggro token moves at the end of the turn of each character who inflicted damage on the boss during that turn (see §16.4).

Encounter Resolution

An encounter ends in one of two ways. The encounter is cleared when every enemy model has been killed and at least one character is alive; crystal lizards do not count (see §14). The encounter is failed when every character has died, or when a *hollow* character dies and is *lost* (see §7.2). A failed encounter awards no *souls* and no treasure.

An encounter is cleared for the first time while the treasure cards dealt to its tile at setup still lie on the tile (see §7.7). When an encounter is cleared for the first time:

1. Return to each surviving character their own *dropped souls* from the tile (see §7.6).
2. Award each character, including each character who died, the full soul reward for the encounter's level (see §7.6).
3. Give each character, including each character who died, one of the treasure cards dealt to the tile (see §7.7).
4. If the tile holds an unopened chest, open it and award its treasure card (see §7.7).
5. If the tile holds a *gravestone*, the players may *scry* one card.
6. Place a black cube on the encounter card to mark it cleared.
7. Recover (see §7.5, Encounter Recovery).

If *mimics* are in play and the tile holds an unopened chest, the characters decide whether to open it before step 1, and a mimic that appears is fought before any reward is collected (see §13).

When an encounter is cleared again after its treasure cards have been collected, the same steps are followed with two differences: in step 2 each character gains the *reduced reward* instead of the full reward (see §7.6), and step 3 is omitted, because a repeated clear awards no treasure. This is so whether or not the encounter card carries a black cube: an encounter that was cleared, later failed, and then cleared again is a repeated clear, and step 6 marks it cleared once more.

When an encounter is failed:

1. Place all of each living character's souls on the tile, in a pile separate from any souls already there (see §7.6).
2. Turn the encounter card face down and remove its black cube, if it has one.
3. Rest at the bonfire (see §7.5, Encounter Recovery).

Reset. The state of an encounter after the characters have rested at the bonfire: its encounter card is face down, its enemy models have been removed, and its terrain tokens remain in place (see §11.5).

When the characters rest at the bonfire, every encounter is *reset* (see §11.5), except a cleared *Level 4 encounter*, which is not fought again (see §6.7). A cleared encounter keeps its black cube through a reset; when the characters next enter its tile, they may skip it or fight it again for the reduced reward (see §7.5, Encounter Start). A failed encounter has no black cube and must be fought.

Scry. To reveal one hidden card and then either return it to its place or send it away.

When an encounter containing a gravestone is cleared, the players may scry one card of their collective choice (see §5.5, Gravestones). The card is one of the following.

- The top card of either treasure deck. The players reveal it and either return it face down to the top of that deck or place it face down at the bottom of that deck.
- One face-down encounter card. The players reveal it and either return it face down to its tile or replace it with the top card of the encounter deck of the same level, placing the revealed card face down at the bottom of that deck.
- The top card of the next boss's behaviour deck (see §15.5). The players reveal it and either return it face down to the top of that deck or place it face down at the bottom of that deck.

Encounter Recovery

Recovery follows every cleared encounter. If mimics are in play and the tile holds an unopened chest, recovery is deferred until the characters have decided whether to open it (see §13).

Each character who survived the encounter recovers as follows.

1. Remove all condition tokens from the character (see §8.5).
2. Remove all stamina cubes from the character's endurance bar.
3. Remove one *damage cube* from the character's endurance bar.

Each character who died in the encounter is revived hollow as follows.

1. Place the character's model upright on the tile beside the surviving characters.

2. Remove all condition tokens, stamina cubes, and damage cubes from the character.
3. Place two *hollow cubes* on the two rightmost spaces of the character's endurance bar (see §7.2).

Recovery does not ready the *estus flask*, *luck*, or *heroic action* tokens, and does not remove the hollow cubes of a character who was already hollow; only resting at the bonfire does so (see §11.2). A revived character's dropped souls stay on the tile (see §7.6).

When an encounter is failed, the characters must rest at the bonfire. If the *spark* dial shows zero, the characters cannot rest and the players lose the game (see §7.1). Otherwise the party spends one spark and rests (see §11.2): every character, including each dead or lost character, is placed on the bonfire tile and fully restored, and every encounter is reset (see §11.5).

After recovery the party chooses either to advance to the next encounter tile (see §7.5, Encounter Start) or to return to the bonfire tile and rest, spending one spark (see §7.4). After a boss is defeated, the characters rest without spending a spark (see §16.5).

7.6 Souls

Souls are the game's currency. Each character keeps their own souls as soul tokens on their dashboard. Souls cannot be transferred between characters. Souls are spent while resting at the *bonfire* (see §11.3 and §11.4). The one exception is the cost of calling a *summon* at the *fog gate*, which is paid before a boss encounter (see §12.1).

When an *encounter* is *cleared* for the first time, every character, including each character who died in it, gains the full soul reward for the encounter's level. When an encounter that has been cleared before is cleared again, every character gains the *reduced reward* instead, whether or not its encounter card still carries a black cube (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution).

Reduced reward. Half the full soul reward, rounded down.

When a boss is defeated, every character gains the boss reward (see §16.5). When an *invader* is killed, every character gains the invader reward in addition to the encounter reward (see §12.2). The rewards are as follows, and campaign play uses the same rewards (see §18.5).

Encounter	Full Reward per Character	Reduced Reward per Character
Level 1 encounter and standard *invader*	3	1
Level 2 encounter and advanced *invader*	4	2
Level 3 encounter	5	2
Level 4 encounter and bosses	6	3

The reduced reward applies to encounters only; invaders and bosses are rewarded in full.

Dropped souls. Souls placed on an encounter tile by a character who died there or, when an encounter was *failed*, by a living character.

When a character dies, all of the souls on their dashboard are dropped on the tile where they died, in a pile separate from any other character's *dropped souls* (see §7.2). When an encounter is failed, every living character also drops all of their souls on that tile (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution). Dropped souls stay on the tile through every *reset*. The souls a character drops at death are not forfeited by that death.

Only the character who dropped the souls may reclaim them, and only by surviving an encounter on that tile that ends cleared; the character retrieves them during Encounter Resolution (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution). The one exception is the setup that follows the defeat of a boss, which returns all dropped souls still on the tiles to the characters who dropped them (see §6.6; §6.7). A character who is dead or *lost* when the encounter is cleared does not retrieve them. If the character who dropped the souls dies before reclaiming them, the dropped souls are returned to the supply; souls dropped at the moment of that death remain on the tile.

> EXAMPLE The Knight dies in the second encounter, a Level 2 encounter, holding seven souls, which are placed on that tile. The Herald survives and the encounter is cleared, so the Knight is revived hollow and gains the four souls of the full reward, but the seven souls stay on the tile. The party rests at the bonfire, returns, skips the first encounter, and fights the second again. The Knight survives and the encounter is cleared, so the Knight retrieves the seven souls and gains the reduced reward of two souls.

7.7 Treasure Rewards

Treasure cards (see §2.5) are gained as the reward for clearing an *encounter* for the first time, from a *chest*, from a killed *invader* or *mimic*, from a killed *crystal lizard*, and from a defeated boss. A treasure card a character receives is placed in that character's inventory (see §4.1).

When an encounter is *cleared* for the first time, each character, including each character who died in it, takes one of the treasure cards dealt face down to that tile at setup (see §6.5 and §6.6). The dealt cards are the whole reward; no cards are drawn from the treasure decks at that time. The players decide which character takes which card; if they cannot agree, the character holding the *aggro token* decides.

An encounter cleared again awards no treasure. In the standard game the cards dealt before the *mini-boss* is defeated come from the *tier one treasure* deck and the cards dealt afterwards from the *tier two treasure* deck (see §6.2).

When an encounter containing an unopened chest is cleared, the chest is opened: flip the chest token to its open side and reveal the treasure card beneath it (see §5.5, Chests). The card is awarded to the party. If mimics are in play, a chest is opened only as the mimic rules describe, and the encounter is not resolved until the characters have decided whether to open it (see §13). A killed mimic awards two treasure cards in place of the chest's one (see §13).

Whenever a treasure card is awarded to the party rather than to a named character (a chest's card, a mimic's cards, a boss treasure card, or the *mega-boss* treasure card of a Level 4 encounter), the players decide which character receives it. If they cannot agree, the card goes to the character who holds the aggro token when the encounter ends.

If crystal lizards are in play, a character who kills a crystal lizard takes one Titanite Scale card at once (see §14). A killed invader awards its treasure (see §12.2).

When a boss is defeated, the party is awarded one of that boss's treasure cards, drawn at random (see §16.5). The treasure reward of a Level 4 encounter is the mega-boss treasure card dealt to its tile (see §6.7).



STONE GUARDIAN



MUSHROOM PARENT



MUSHROOM CHILD



DEMONIC FOLIAGE



PLOW SCARECROW



SHEARS SCARECROW



BLACK HOLLOW MAGE



FALCHION SKELETON



FIREBOMB HOLLOW



CHAPTER 8

8 Combat Basics

Every fight turns on the same few questions: who is struck, how hard, and what the blow leaves behind. This chapter sets out the terms on which all combat rests: the target and the hit, the enemy data card, the scaling of enemies to the party, the push, and the conditions that linger after a blow has landed.

8.1 Target versus Hit

Target. The model at which an attack is directed.

When a model attacks, the model that must defend against the attack is the attack's *target*. An attack has one target unless its icons give it more. Some attacks target every opposing model on one *node* (see §9.3; §10.3, Area-of-Effect), and some *boss* attacks target every character on several nodes (see §16.3).

A character targets enemies, bosses, and *invaders*. A character targets another character only in a player versus player (PvP) *encounter* (see §20). An enemy never targets another enemy. The targeting of *phantoms* is stated with their rules (see §12).

Hit. An attack hits its target when the target is within the attack's *range* (see §5.4) and does not avoid the attack by a successful *dodge* (see §9.5) or a successful *parry* (see §9.6).

A hit does not depend on damage. An attack whose damage is reduced to zero by *block* or *resist* still *hits* its target (see §9.4; §10.3).

A target that is out of range, or that dodges or parries the attack, is not hit. An attack has no effect on a target it does not hit: it deals no damage, does not *push* the target, and places no *condition* token on it.

A push (see §8.4) and a condition (see §8.5) carried by an attack apply only to a model that the attack hits. They apply to every model the attack hits, whether or not the attack dealt damage to it.

> EXAMPLE An enemy attack with an *attack value* of 4 bears the push icon and targets the Knight and the Herald, who share a node within its range. The Knight blocks and rolls a *defence total* of 4, so the Knight suffers no damage; the Knight is hit all the same and is pushed. The Herald dodges successfully, is not hit, and is not pushed.

8.2 Enemy Data Cards

Each kind of enemy has a *data card* (see §2.2). The data card holds everything needed to resolve that enemy's *turn* and to resolve a character's attack against it. An enemy data card shows the following.



An enemy data card. *1 Name. 2 Threat. 3 Base health. 4 Enemy icon. 5 Attack range. 6 Block. 7 Resist. 8 Dodge difficulty. 9 Behaviour icons. 10 Set symbol.*

- The name identifies the kind of enemy.
- The *threat* value fixes the order in which enemies take their turns (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order).
- The attack *range* is the greatest range at which the enemy's attacks reach a *target* (see §5.4; §9.3).
- The *dodge difficulty* is the total that a character's *dodge* roll must equal or exceed to avoid the enemy's attacks (see §9.5).
- The *block* and *resist* values reduce the damage of physical and magical attacks against the enemy (see §10.3).
- The *behaviour icons* are the enemy's movement icons and attack icons, resolved from left to right during its turn (see §9.1).
- The *base health* is the enemy's health before *enemy scaling* (see §8.3).
- The enemy icon is the picture by which *encounter cards* show the enemy (see §2.6).
- The set symbol shows the set that supplies the enemy (see §2.2).

Smaller icons printed around a behaviour icon modify it, as follows.

- The skull icon directs the movement or attack at the character who holds the *aggro token* (see §9.2; §9.3).
- The nearest-character icon directs the movement or attack at the nearest character (see §9.2; §9.3).
- The *node* icon makes an attack target every character on the target's node (see §9.3).
- The *push* icon makes a movement a *push-move* and an attack a *push-attack* (see §8.4).
- A push icon that carries a number makes a push-move deal that damage (see §8.4).
- The *repeat* icon shows the number of times the attack beside it is resolved (see §9.3).
- A *condition* icon places that condition on each model the attack *hits* (see §8.5).

The attack icon itself shows whether the attack deals *physical damage* or *magical damage* (see §9.3).

A *boss* data card shows a *behaviour deck* size in place of behaviour icons and adds a *heat-up* point (see §15.4). The data cards of *phantoms* and *mimics* are described with those models (see §12; §13).

Scaled health. An enemy's base health plus the increase that enemy scaling gives for the number of characters (see §8.3).

Damage to an enemy is recorded with *wound tokens*. When an enemy suffers damage, place wound tokens with a total value equal to that damage on the base of the enemy model (see §10.3). Wound tokens stay on the model until the enemy is killed or the *encounter* ends.

When the total value of the wound tokens on an enemy model equals or exceeds its *scaled health*, the enemy is killed. Remove the model and its wound tokens from the tile at once. Damage beyond the enemy's scaled health has no further effect.

A boss, a phantom, and a mimic record their health on a *health dial* in place of wound tokens (see §15.4).

> EXAMPLE The Knight, the Herald, and the Assassin fight a Hollow Soldier whose data card shows a base health of 1. With three characters its scaled health is 3. The Knight's attack deals two damage, and two wound tokens of value 1 are placed on the Hollow Soldier's base. The Herald's attack deals one damage. The wound tokens now total 3, so the Hollow Soldier is killed, and its model and wound tokens are removed from the tile.

8.3 Enemy Scaling

Enemy scaling matches the enemies to the size of the party. The number of characters is fixed at setup (see §6.1) and does not change when a character dies: a dead character and a *lost* character still count. Each enemy is scaled for that number when its model is placed (see §7.5, Encounter Start).

Characters	Enemy health	Enemy movement	Enemy attack value
1	*Base health*	No change	No change
2	Base health + 1	1 becomes 2	No change
3	Base health + 2	1 becomes 2	No change
4	Base health + 4	1 becomes 2	+1

An enemy's *scaled health* is its base health plus the increase shown in the table (see §8.2).

With two or more characters, every movement icon on an enemy's *data card* that shows a value of 1 is resolved with a value of 2. A *push-move* is scaled in the same way (see §8.4). A movement icon that shows a value of 2 or more is not changed.

With four characters, every attack value on an enemy's data card is increased by one. The increase applies to each attack icon and to the damage value of a push-move (see §8.4).

Every enemy is scaled, with four exceptions. A *boss*, a *mimic*, a *phantom*, and a *crystal lizard* are never scaled (see §15.4; §13; §12; §14).

In campaign play, the *bonfire ascetic* further increases the health of every enemy that is subject to enemy scaling (see §18.7). The number of characters in a campaign changes only when a player joins or leaves it (see §18.4).

> EXAMPLE A Hollow Soldier's data card shows a base health of 1, a movement value of 1, and an attack value of 4. Against the Knight alone it has a health of 1, moves one *node*, and attacks with a value of 4. Against the Knight and the Herald its scaled health is 2 and it moves two nodes. Against the Knight, the Herald, and the Assassin its scaled health is 3. Against the Knight, the Herald, the Assassin, and the Warrior its scaled health is 5 and its attack value is 5. The Warrior dies during the *encounter*, and the enemies of the next encounter are still scaled for four characters.

8.4 Pushing

Push. Forced movement of a model from its *node* to an *adjacent node*.

A *push* forces a model from its node to a *valid node* (see §5.2). A push is not a *move*, and it costs no stamina. A model is pushed from the node it occupies when the push is resolved. A model is pushed for one of four reasons.

- A *push-attack hits* the model.
- A *push-move* begins on the model's node or enters it.
- A fourth non-boss model enters the model's node, and the *node model limit* displaces the model (see §5.3).

- A *boss* model moves onto the node of another boss model (see §17.1).

A model is pushed only into a valid node. A node containing a *gravestone*, a *chest*, or a *pillar token* is not a valid node for a push, and a model pushed into a node containing an intact *barrel* destroys the barrel (see §5.5). A character pushed onto a node that holds a face-down *trap token* triggers the trap (see §5.5, Traps). A model pushed into a node at its node model limit displaces a model already on that node (see §5.3).

If no valid node exists for a push, the push does not happen and the model stays on its node. Every other effect of the attack or movement that caused the push is still resolved.

Push-attack. An attack that bears the push icon.

When a push-attack hits a model, the model is pushed after the attack's damage has been resolved (see §8.1). The model is pushed whether or not the attack dealt damage. A model that the attack does not hit is not pushed.

A push-attack pushes the model directly away from the attacker. A node is farther from the attacker when its *range* from the attacker's node is greater (see §5.4). The model is pushed into the valid node most directly opposite the attacker's node, chosen from the adjacent nodes that are farther from the attacker than the model's own node. If two or more such nodes are equally opposite the attacker, the players choose one of them.

If no valid node is farther from the attacker than the model's own node, the model is not pushed. If the attacker shares the model's node, every adjacent node is farther from the attacker, and the players choose any valid node.

Push-move. An enemy or boss movement that bears the push icon.

An enemy resolves a push-move one node at a time (see §9.2). For each node of the movement, the following steps are resolved in order.

1. Push each character on the enemy's node to a valid node chosen by the players.
2. Move the enemy one node, as its movement icon directs.
3. If the push icon carries a damage value, resolve a physical attack with that *attack value* against each character on the node the enemy has entered, one character at a time.
4. Push each character hit in step 3. If the push icon carries no damage value, push each character on the node the enemy has entered.

The characters pushed in step 1 are not attacked and suffer no damage. A character pushed in step 4 is pushed directly away from the node the enemy has left, as for a push-attack made from that node.

A push-move without a damage value is not an attack: a character cannot *dodge*, *block*, or *resist* it. The attack of a push-move with a damage value is defended as any other enemy attack (see §9.4; §9.5). A character who blocks that attack is hit and is pushed whether or not damage is dealt. A character who dodges it is not hit and is not pushed.

A boss resolves a push-move in the same way, with the differences stated for boss movement (see §16.2). When a boss pushes a character off the boss's own node, the boss's arcs limit the nodes to which the character is pushed (see §15.6).

A push caused by the node model limit, or by a boss model moving onto the node of another boss model, sends the displaced model to any valid node chosen by the players. The model to be displaced is chosen as §5.3 and §17.1 state.

A boss model cannot be pushed by a character's attack. The only push that affects a boss model is the push caused by another boss model moving onto its node (see §17.1).

In a PvP *encounter*, a push-attack pushes a character it hits (see §20.5).

> EXAMPLE An enemy, the Knight, and a gravestone occupy three nodes in a straight line, with the Knight in the middle. The enemy hits the Knight with a push-attack. The node most directly opposite the enemy holds the gravestone and is not a valid node. The two nodes on either side of the gravestone are valid nodes, are farther from the enemy than the Knight's node, and are equally opposite the enemy, so the players choose one of them and the Knight is pushed there.

> EXAMPLE The Herald stands on a corner node, and an enemy on the diagonally adjacent node hits the Herald with a push-attack. The two other nodes adjacent to the Herald are no farther from the enemy than the corner node is, so the Herald is not pushed. The attack's damage is resolved in full.

> EXAMPLE The Knight, the Herald, and the Assassin are in play, so an enemy's push-move with a movement value of 1 is resolved as two nodes. Its push icon carries a damage value of 5. The Assassin shares the enemy's node: the players push the Assassin to a valid node, and the Assassin suffers no damage. The enemy moves onto the Knight's node, and the Knight is attacked with an attack value of 5. The Knight blocks with a *defence total* of 3, suffers two damage, and is pushed directly away from the node the enemy has left. The enemy then moves its second node, which holds no character, and no model is pushed.

8.5 Conditions

Condition. A lasting effect marked by a condition token on a model.

A *condition* is one of six lasting effects: *bleed*, *poison*, *frostbite*, *stagger*, *calamity*, and *corrosion*. Each condition is marked by a condition token of its own kind

(see §2.8). Any model may hold condition tokens: a character, an enemy, a *boss*, or a *phantom*.

When an attack that bears a condition icon *hits* a model, place the matching condition token on that model (see §8.1). The token is placed after the attack's damage and any *push* have been resolved, and it is placed whether or not the attack dealt damage. Some rules place a condition token without an attack; the token then has the same effect.

A model holds at most one token of each condition, and it may hold tokens of different conditions at the same time. When a token of a condition is to be placed on a model that already holds a token of that condition, the token is not placed and has no effect. Bleed and poison are exceptions, each stated under its own heading below.

Damage dealt by a condition is recorded as any other damage is: with *damage cubes* for a character (see §3.4), with *wound tokens* for an enemy (see §8.2), and on the *health dial* for a boss, a phantom, or a *mimic* (see §15.4). A value reduced by a condition cannot fall below zero.

Each condition lasts until the rule under its heading removes it. Where a token is removed at the end of a model's next complete *turn*, a token placed during that model's own turn is not removed at the end of that turn; it is removed at the end of the model's following turn. Every condition token still in play is removed when the *encounter* ends (see §7.5, Encounter Recovery).

In a PvP encounter, conditions apply between characters (see §20.5).

Bleed

A model holds at most one bleed token, and the token alone has no effect. When a bleed token is to be placed on a model that already holds one, the token is not placed. The model suffers three damage at once instead, and its bleed token is removed.

Bleed damage is not an attack: it is not reduced by *block* or *resist*, and a character cannot *dodge* it. A bleed token is not removed at the end of any turn. It stays on the model until a second token triggers it or the encounter ends.

> EXAMPLE Four characters are in play, so a Hollow Soldier has a *scaled health* of 5. The Assassin hits it with an *attack option* that bears the bleed icon and deals two damage: two wound tokens of value 1 and a bleed token are placed on it. In the next *round* the Assassin hits it again with the same attack option, and the Hollow Soldier's block reduces the attack's damage to zero. The second bleed token is not placed. The Hollow Soldier suffers three damage, which its block does not reduce, and its bleed token is removed. Its wound tokens now total 5, so the Hollow Soldier is killed.

Poison

A model may hold any number of poison tokens: each attack that bears the poison icon and hits the model places one more. At the end of each of its turns, a model that holds poison tokens suffers one damage for each poison token it holds and then removes all of them. Poison damage is not an attack: it is not reduced by block or resist, and a character cannot dodge it.

> EXAMPLE During the enemies' turns the Herald is hit by three attacks that bear the poison icon and holds three poison tokens. At the end of the Herald's next turn, the Herald suffers three damage, places three damage cubes on the *endurance bar*, and removes all three poison tokens.

Frostbite

A character with a frostbite token cannot recover stamina by any means. The character does not recover one stamina at the start of their turn and cannot take the *Rest major action* (see §10.1). An enemy, boss, or phantom with a frostbite token reduces the value of each of its movement icons by one, after *enemy scaling* has been applied (see §8.3; §9.2).

A frostbite token is removed at the end of the affected model's next complete turn.

> EXAMPLE An enemy attack that bears the frostbite icon hits the Herald during the enemies' turns, and a frostbite token is placed on the Herald. At the start of the Herald's turn the Herald recovers no stamina, and the Herald cannot take the Rest major action during that turn. At the end of that turn the frostbite token is removed.

Stagger

A character with a stagger token subtracts one from the total of each attack roll and of each block, resist, and dodge roll that the character makes. An enemy, boss, or phantom with a stagger token reduces each of its *attack values*, its block and resist values, and its *dodge difficulty* by one.

A stagger token is removed at the end of the affected model's next complete turn.

Stagger is placed by an attack that bears the stagger icon, by stamina overflow (see §10.1), and by a *parry* (see §9.6).

> EXAMPLE During a Hollow Soldier's turn the Knight parries its attack, and a stagger token is placed on the Hollow Soldier. The token was placed during the Hollow Soldier's own turn, so it is not removed at the end of that turn. During the characters' turns the Hollow Soldier's block of 1 is reduced to zero. On the Hollow Soldier's next turn its attack value is 3 in place of 4 and its dodge difficulty is reduced by one, and the stagger token is removed at the end of that turn.

Calamity

Calamity is a condition of the Black Dragon Kalameet expansion (see §17.8). A model with a calamity token subtracts one from the total of each block, resist, and dodge roll that it makes. A calamity token is not removed at the end of any turn or when the model suffers damage. It is removed only when the encounter ends.

Corrosion

Corrosion is a condition of the Gaping Dragon expansion (see §17.10). A model with a corrosion token subtracts one from the total of each block roll that it makes. A corrosion token is not removed at the end of any turn. It is removed when the affected model next suffers damage, after that damage has been recorded.



THE DICE



GIANT SKELETON ARCHER



9 Enemy Turn

The dead do not wait. Each enemy follows the icons on its data card without pause or pity, and the characters are left to choose how to meet what comes. This chapter states how enemies move and attack, and how a character blocks, resists, dodges, or parries an attack.

9.1 Overview

Each *round* of an *encounter* begins with the enemies: every enemy model takes a *turn* before any character does, one model at a time in descending order of *threat*. The round as a whole, and the order between enemy models that share a threat value, are stated with the encounter turn order (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order).

Each enemy's behaviour is printed on its *data card* as a row of *behaviour icons*: movement icons (see §9.2) and attack icons (see §9.3). The other values on the data card are described with the card (see §8.2). During its turn the enemy resolves its icons one at a time from left to right, and each icon is resolved in full before the next.

An icon that has no valid *target*, or that cannot be resolved, is skipped, and the next icon to the right is resolved. The enemy's turn ends when its last icon has been resolved or when the enemy is killed.

Enemies target only characters; an enemy never targets another enemy (see §8.1). An enemy's health, movement, and attack values are scaled for the number of characters (see §8.3). An enemy that holds a *stagger* or *frostbite* token resolves its icons with the penalty stated for that *condition* (see §8.5).

Invaders do not take their turns with the enemies: an *invader* takes a turn after each character's turn (see §12.2). A *summon* acts as §12.1 describes. A *boss* takes its turns under its own rules (see §16), and a *mimic* under §13.

9.2 Enemy Movement

The movement icon moves an enemy towards or away from one character, the *target* of the movement. The number printed in the arrow is the number of *nodes* the enemy moves. An arrow that points upwards moves the enemy towards the target; an arrow that points downwards moves it away from the target.

The small icon at the top right of the movement icon names the target. The skull icon names the character who holds the *aggro token*; a living character always holds it (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order). The nearest-character icon names the *nearest character*.



A movement icon. *1 Target. 2 Nodes moved towards the target. 3 Nodes moved away from the target. 4 Push icon. 5 Leap icon, used by bosses.*

Nearest character. The living character at the shortest *range* from the enemy (see §5.4). If two or more characters are tied for nearest, the nearest character is the one of them who holds the aggro token. If none of them holds it, the nearest character is the one of them with the highest *threat*; if they share the highest threat, the players choose.

The target is determined once, when the icon begins to be resolved, and is not determined again as the enemy moves.

Paths

An enemy *moves* one node at a time, and each node it enters must be a *valid node* (see §5.2). The *terrain* that blocks a move is stated with each kind of terrain (see §5.5). An enemy never leaves the tile and never passes through a *doorway* (see §5.2). An enemy that enters a node at its *node model limit* displaces a model as §5.3 describes.

When the icon moves the enemy towards its target, the enemy follows the shortest path of valid nodes from its own node to the target's node. It stops when it has moved the number of nodes shown or when it stands on the target's node. If two or more such paths are equally short, the players choose which path the enemy follows. If the enemy already stands on the target's node, or if no path of valid nodes leads to that node, the enemy does not move.

When the icon moves the enemy away from its target, each node the enemy enters must be a valid node at a greater range from the target than the node it leaves. If two or more such nodes are open to the enemy, the players

choose which node it enters. If no such node is open to the enemy, it stops, and the rest of its movement is lost.

The number of nodes shown is adjusted by scaling for the number of characters (see §8.3) and is reduced while the enemy holds a *frostbite* token (see §8.5, Frostbite). Enemies neither trigger traps nor suffer them (see §5.5, Traps).

Towards aggro

The enemy moves the number of nodes shown towards the character who holds the aggro token. An enemy on that character's node does not move.

Away from aggro

The enemy moves the number of nodes shown away from the character who holds the aggro token. An enemy with no valid node farther from that character does not move.

Towards nearest

The enemy moves the number of nodes shown towards the nearest character. An enemy on that character's node does not move.

Away from nearest

The enemy moves the number of nodes shown away from the nearest character. An enemy with no valid node farther from that character does not move.

> Example The Knight and the Herald face a Hollow Soldier whose movement icon shows an upward arrow, the number 1, and the nearest-character icon. With two characters in play the Hollow Soldier moves two nodes. The Herald stands two nodes from the Hollow Soldier and the Knight stands three nodes from it, so the Herald is the nearest character. The node between the Hollow Soldier and the Herald holds a *gravestone* and is not a valid node. The Hollow Soldier moves two nodes along the shortest path of valid nodes that leads around the gravestone towards the Herald's node.

> Example An enemy's movement icon shows a downward arrow, the number 2, and the nearest-character icon. The Knight and the Assassin each stand one node from the enemy, and the Knight holds the aggro token, so the Knight is the nearest character. Two valid nodes lie at range 2 from the Knight; the players choose one of them, and the enemy moves onto it. One valid node beyond it lies at range 3 from the Knight, and the enemy moves onto that node.

Push-move

When the push icon is printed on a movement icon, the movement is a *push-move*. The target of a push-move is determined as for any movement icon, before any character is *pushed*. The enemy then moves one node at a time towards or away from the target's current node, as the arrow shows.

At each node of a push-move, the characters in the enemy's way are pushed as §8.4 describes: the characters on the enemy's node before it moves, and the characters on the node it enters after it moves. A push-move pushes characters only. An enemy model on a node the enemy enters stays there, unless the node model limit displaces it (see §5.3).

A push-move that shows no damage value is not an attack. The characters it pushes are not *hit*, and they cannot *block*, *dodge*, or *parry* it (see §8.4).

Push-move with a damage value

When the push icon on a movement icon shows a damage value 5, the push-move includes an attack. Each time the enemy enters a node, it makes a physical attack against every character on that node before those characters are pushed (see §8.4). The damage value is the *attack value* of that attack, and it is scaled as any attack value is (see §8.3).

Each attacked character defends separately, choosing to block or to dodge; the attack cannot be parried (see §9.3, Defence; §9.6). A character who is hit is then pushed. A character who dodges successfully is not hit, is not pushed, and moves as §9.5 describes.

The characters pushed from the enemy's node before it moves are not attacked. A character pushed onto a node that the enemy enters afterwards in the same movement is attacked again on that node.

> Example An enemy's movement icon shows an upward arrow, the number 2, the skull icon, and a push icon with the damage value 4. The Warrior holds the aggro token and stands two nodes from the enemy, and the Assassin stands on the node between them. The enemy enters the Assassin's node and attacks the Assassin with attack value 4. The Assassin blocks with a defence total of 3, suffers one damage, and is pushed directly away from the node the enemy has left, onto the Warrior's node. The enemy then enters the Warrior's node and attacks the Warrior and the Assassin separately, each with attack value 4.

9.3 Enemy Attacks

The attack icon is an attack by the enemy against one or more characters. The crossed swords icon marks an attack that deals *physical damage*, and the magical damage icon marks an attack that deals *magical damage*. The number printed in the centre of the attack icon is the *attack value*.

An enemy's attack value is fixed and is not rolled. It is scaled for the number of characters (see §8.3) and is reduced while the enemy holds a *stagger* token (see §8.5, Stagger).

The *range* of an enemy's attacks is printed on its *data card* (see §8.2) and is counted as §5.4 describes.

The small icons printed around the attack icon modify the attack.

- The skull icon or the nearest-character icon names the *target* (see §9.3, Targets).

- The node icon makes the attack a *node attack*.
- The push icon makes the attack a *push-attack*: each character *hit* by the attack is *pushed* away from the enemy after the damage is resolved (see §8.4).
- A *condition* icon places the matching condition token on each character hit by the attack (see §8.5).
- A *repeat* icon causes the attack to be resolved the number of times shown, and the target is determined afresh each time. A repeat icon applies only to the attack icon beside it, not to a movement icon.

Targets

An attack marked with the skull icon targets the character who holds the *aggro token*. An attack marked with the nearest-character icon targets the *nearest character*, determined as for movement (see §9.2). The target is determined when the attack icon begins to be resolved.

If the target is not within the attack's range, the attack misses: the icon is skipped and has no effect. No other character is attacked in the target's place.

Node attack. An attack that bears the node icon. It targets every character on the node of the character named by its skull icon or nearest-character icon.

If the node targeted by a node attack is not within range, the attack is skipped. Each character on the node is attacked separately: each defends on their own, and the full attack value is applied to each.

Defence

When an attack targets a character, the character's player must choose one defence before any dice are rolled. The choice cannot be changed once it is made. The defences are as follows.

- Block or resist: the character *blocks* an attack that deals physical damage and *resists* an attack that deals magical damage (see §9.4).
- Dodge: the character attempts to *dodge* the attack (see §9.5).
- Parry: the character attempts to *parry* the attack, if a parry is permitted (see §9.6).

A character is hit by an attack unless the dodge or the parry succeeds, even if the attack deals no damage (see §8.1). Conditions and pushes apply only to a character who is hit. Damage suffered is placed as *damage cubes* on the character's *endurance bar* (see §3.4; §7.2). An *embered* character reduces the damage of an attack as §7.3 describes.

The attacks of an *invader*, a *mimic*, or a *boss* are defended under §9.4, §9.5, and §9.6, except where their own rules differ (see §12.2; §13; §16.3). A character's attack on another character in a player versus player (PvP) encounter is defended as §20.4 describes.

> EXAMPLE An enemy's attack icon shows the crossed swords icon, attack value 4, and the skull icon, and the enemy's range is 1. The Knight holds the aggro token and stands two nodes from the enemy. The Herald stands on a node adjacent to the enemy. The attack targets the Knight, who is not within range, so the attack is skipped. The Herald is not attacked.

> EXAMPLE An enemy's attack icon shows attack value 2, the nearest-character icon, and the node icon, and the enemy's range is 3. The Assassin and the Warrior share a node two nodes from the enemy, and the Knight stands three nodes from it. The Assassin and the Warrior are tied for nearest. The Warrior holds the aggro token, so the Warrior is the nearest character and the attack targets the Warrior's node. The Warrior blocks and the Assassin dodges, each against attack value 2. The Knight is not attacked.

9.4 Block and Resist

A character *blocks* an attack that deals physical damage with the dice shown beside the block icon on their *equipped* cards. A character *resists* an attack that deals magical damage with the dice shown beside the resist icon on their equipped cards (see §4.1, Card Anatomy). Blocking and resisting cost no stamina. The roll is resolved as follows.

1. Gather the block dice, against physical damage, or the resist dice, against magical damage, shown on every equipped card: the *armour* card, the card in each *weapon slot*, and every *upgrade card* attached to them (see §3.2; §4.2).
2. Roll the dice.
3. The character may flip the *luck* token to reroll any or all of the dice (see §3.5, Luck).
4. Add together the two highest results. If one die was rolled, its result is the sum. If no dice were rolled, the sum is zero.
5. Apply to the sum every fixed modifier printed with the block or resist dice of the equipped cards. The result is the *defence total*.
6. Subtract the defence total from the *attack value*. The character suffers the difference as damage, to a minimum of zero (see §3.4).
7. Place any *condition* token the attack carries (see §8.5) and resolve any *push* (see §8.4), even if the character suffered no damage.

Dice beyond the two highest are ignored. A fixed modifier is applied after the two highest results are added, whether or not a die of its card is among the two highest. A defence total of less than zero is treated as zero. A condition token on the character may reduce the defence total (see §8.5).

Cards in the *back-up slot* and in the *inventory* provide no dice (see §3.2). A *spell* stored in a *catalyst* provides no dice (see §4.3).

A character who blocks or resists is *hit* by the attack, whatever the defence total (see §8.1). A defence total that equals or exceeds the attack value prevents all of the damage and nothing else.

> EXAMPLE A Hollow Soldier attacks the Knight with attack value 4 and physical damage. The Knight's armour shows two black block dice, and the shield in the Knight's left weapon slot shows one blue block die with a +1 modifier. The Knight rolls the three dice and they show 1, 2, and 2. The two highest results add to 4, and the +1 modifier makes the defence total 5. The Knight suffers no damage and is hit by the attack all the same.

> EXAMPLE An enemy attacks the Herald with attack value 3 and magical damage. The Herald's equipped cards show one blue resist die between them and no modifier. The Herald rolls the die and it shows 2, so the defence total is 2. The Herald suffers one damage and places one damage cube on the endurance bar.

9.5 Dodge

A character targeted by an attack may attempt to *dodge* it in place of a *block* or a *resist*. Only an attack that targets the character may be dodged; a *push-move* that shows no damage value is not an attack (see §9.2, Push-Move). A dodge is rolled with green dice (see §2.7), one for each die shown beside the dodge icon on the character's *equipped* cards.

Dodge difficulty. The number of dodge icons a dodge roll must equal or exceed. The dodge difficulty of an enemy's attacks is printed on its *data card* (see §8.2), that of a *boss*'s attack on its *behaviour card* (see §16.3), and that of a trap on its *trap token* (see §5.5, Traps).

A dodge is resolved as follows.

1. Place one *stamina cube* on the character's *endurance bar* to pay one stamina (see §3.4).
2. Gather one green die for each dodge die shown on the character's equipped cards (see §3.2).
3. The character may pay two further stamina to add one green die. This may be done once for each dodge, and no dodge is rolled with more than four dice.
4. If the dodge difficulty is zero, the dodge succeeds and no dice are rolled. Otherwise roll the dice.
5. The character may flip the *luck* token to reroll any or all of the dice (see §3.5, Luck).
6. Count the dodge icons rolled. If the count equals or exceeds the dodge difficulty, the dodge succeeds. Otherwise the dodge fails.

A character may attempt a dodge only if the stamina cube of step 1 has an empty space on the endurance bar, and may add the die of step 3 only if both further cubes have empty spaces (see §3.4). A character whose equipped cards show no dodge dice may still attempt a dodge. If no dice are rolled, the count is zero, and the dodge fails unless the dodge difficulty is zero. A *condition* token on the character may reduce the count (see §8.5).

Successful dodge

When a dodge succeeds, the attack does not hit the character (see §8.1). The character suffers no damage, receives no condition token, and is not *pushed*. The character must then move to an *adjacent node* that is a *valid node*, chosen by the character's player (see §5.2). If no valid node exists, the character stays on their node.

The movement that follows a dodge is not a *move*, and it costs no stamina beyond the cost of the dodge. It destroys an intact *barrel* on the node entered (see §5.5, Barrels) and turns a face-down trap token on that node face up (see §5.5, Traps). If the node entered is at its *node model limit*, a model is displaced as §5.3 describes.

Failed dodge

When a dodge fails, the character is *hit*. The character rolls only the block or resist dice, as the damage type requires, of their *armour* card and of the *upgrade cards* attached to it. The dice of weapons, *shields*, and *spells* are not rolled. The roll is resolved from step 2 of the block and resist procedure (see §9.4): the two highest results and the fixed modifiers of the dice rolled form the *defence total*, and conditions and pushes apply.

The stamina paid for a failed dodge is not returned. A character with no armour card, or whose armour provides no dice of the kind required, suffers the full *attack value*.

Traps

A trap is dodged under the rules of this section, against the dodge difficulty shown on its trap token (see §5.5, Traps). Trap damage cannot be blocked or resisted. A character who fails to dodge a trap rolls no dice and suffers the damage shown on the token.

> EXAMPLE An enemy attacks the Assassin with attack value 3 and physical damage, and the enemy's dodge difficulty is 2. The Assassin's equipped cards show two dodge dice. The Assassin pays one stamina, pays two further stamina for a third green die, and rolls three dice: two dodge icons and one blank. Two equals the dodge difficulty, so the dodge succeeds. The Assassin suffers no damage and moves to an adjacent valid node.

> EXAMPLE An enemy attacks the Warrior with attack value 4 and physical damage, and the enemy's dodge difficulty is 1. The Warrior's equipped cards show one dodge die. The Warrior pays one stamina and rolls one green die, which

shows a blank, so the dodge fails. The Warrior's armour shows one black block die, and the shield's two blue block dice are not rolled. The black die shows 1, so the defence total is 1 and the Warrior suffers three damage.

9.6 Parry and Riposte

A character targeted by an attack may attempt to *parry* it in place of a *block*, a *resist*, or a *dodge*. A parry is permitted only if both of the following are true.

- A *shield* is equipped in the character's left *weapon slot* (see §3.2; §4.1).
- The attacker is on the character's node.

A shield in the right weapon slot does not permit a parry. A character who wields a weapon *two-handed* has no shield equipped and cannot parry (see §10.4).

The following attacks cannot be parried.

- A *push-attack* (see §9.3).
- The attack made by a *push-move* that shows a damage value (see §9.2, Push-Move with a Damage Value).
- A *node attack* (see §9.3, Targets).
- An attack by a *boss*, except where §15.6 allows.

A parry is resolved as follows.

1. Place one *stamina cube* on the character's *endurance bar* to pay one stamina (see §3.4).
2. Gather one green die for each dodge die shown on the character's *equipped* cards (see §3.2). No further die may be added.
3. Roll the dice.
4. The character may flip the *luck* token to reroll any or all of the dice (see §3.5, Luck).
5. Count the dodge icons rolled. If the count equals or exceeds the attack's *dodge difficulty*, the parry succeeds. Otherwise the parry fails.

A character may attempt a parry only if the stamina cube of step 1 has an empty space on the endurance bar (see §3.4). If no dice are rolled, the count is zero. A *condition* token on the character may reduce the count (see §8.5).

Successful Parry

When a parry succeeds, the attack misses. The character is not *hit*: the character suffers no damage, receives no condition token, and is not *pushed*. A *stagger* token is placed on the attacker, which is staggered (see §8.5, Stagger). The character may then make a *riposte* at once.

Riposte

A riposte is one attack against the attacker, made with one *attack option* of the *weapon* equipped in the character's right weapon slot. The character pays the stamina cost of the attack option and resolves the attack as §10.3 describes. The attacker's stagger token is in place before the riposte is resolved. An enemy cannot dodge or parry a riposte.

A riposte is made during the attacker's *turn*. It is not the character's *Attack* major action, and it does not count against the attacks the character makes in their own turn (see §10.3). In every other respect a riposte is an attack: the character may flip the luck token to reroll its dice, and the icons of the attack option apply. A riposte against a character in a PvP encounter is defended as §20.4 describes.

A riposte is optional. No riposte is made if the right weapon slot holds no weapon with an attack option, if the character cannot pay the stamina cost, or if no attack option of that weapon may target the character's own node, as with the *shaft* icon (see §10.3, Shaft). The parry succeeds all the same, and the attacker is staggered.

If the riposte kills the attacker, the attacker's turn ends at once, and its remaining icons are not resolved (see §9.1).

Failed Parry

When a parry fails, the character is hit and suffers damage equal to the full *attack value*. No block or resist dice are rolled. Any condition token the attack carries is placed on the character (see §8.5). A stagger token is then placed on the character, who is staggered (see §8.5, Stagger); the stamina paid for the parry is not returned.

EXAMPLE An enemy on the Knight's node attacks the Knight with attack value 4 and physical damage, and the enemy's dodge difficulty is 1. The Knight has a shield in the left weapon slot and a sword in the right weapon slot. The Knight pays one stamina and rolls the one dodge die shown on the Knight's armour, which shows a dodge icon. One equals the dodge difficulty, so the parry succeeds: the Knight suffers no damage, and a stagger token is placed on the enemy. The Knight ripostes with the sword's attack option that costs one stamina, pays that stamina, and rolls an attack value of 4. The stagger token reduces the enemy's block from 1 to 0, so four *wound tokens* are placed on the enemy.

EXAMPLE An enemy on the Herald's node attacks the Herald with attack value 4 and physical damage, and the enemy's dodge difficulty is 2. The Herald has a shield in the left weapon slot and a spear in the right weapon slot. The Herald pays one stamina and rolls two dodge dice: one dodge icon and one blank. One is less than 2, so the parry fails. The Herald rolls no block dice, suffers four damage, and is staggered.



CHAPTER 10

10 Character Turn

When the enemies have struck, the characters answer. A character's turn is a careful spending of breath and steel: a step taken, a blow struck, a moment's rest stolen. This chapter sets out the order of a character's turn, how characters move, how their attacks are resolved, and what two hands and a strong arm add to a blow.

10.1 Turn Order

In each *round* of an *encounter* the enemies take their *turns* first, and the characters then take theirs one at a time in descending order of *threat* (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order). A dead character takes no turn. An *invader* takes a turn after each character's turn (see §12.2). In a *boss* encounter the boss and the characters alternate turns (see §16.1), and a *summon* acts after each character's turn (see §12.1).

Character turns in a player versus player (PvP) encounter follow this chapter with the changes stated for that encounter (see §20.3).

A character's turn is resolved as follows.

1. Recover one stamina: remove one *stamina cube* from the character's *endurance bar* (see §3.4). If the character holds a *frostbite* token, skip this step (see §8.5, Frostbite).
2. Take *minor actions* and up to one *major action*, in any order.
3. Resolve every *condition* that takes effect at the end of the character's turn (see §8.5).
4. End the turn.

Minor action. An action that a character may take before the major action, after it, or both. The four minor actions are *Walk*, *Run*, *Equip*, and *Heroic Action*.

- Walk: once per turn, the character *moves* one *node* without spending stamina (see §10.2).
- Run: any number of times per turn, the character spends one stamina and moves one node (see §10.2).
- Equip: once per turn, the character exchanges any number of cards among the *back-up slot*, the left and right *weapon slots*, and the *armour slot* (see §3.2).
- Heroic Action: once per turn, the character flips the heroic action token to its used side and resolves the heroic action printed on the dashboard (see §3.5, Heroic Action). Heroic Action may be taken only while the token shows its ready side.

Major action. The one principal action of a character's turn. The four major actions are *Attack*, *Rest*, *Drink Estus*, and *Ember*. A character may take one major action per turn.

- Attack: the character makes up to one attack with each *weapon* or *spell equipped* in a weapon slot (see §10.3).
- Rest: the character removes every stamina cube from their endurance bar. A character cannot Rest in a turn in which they have run, and a character who has rested cannot run for the remainder of that turn. A character who holds a frostbite token cannot Rest (see §8.5, Frostbite).
- Drink Estus: the character flips the *estus flask* token to its used side and removes every *damage cube* from their endurance bar (see §3.5, Estus Flask). Drink Estus may be taken only while the token shows its ready side.
- Ember: the character discards an *ember card* from their back-up slot and becomes *embered* (see §4.4, §7.3). An ember card in the *inventory* cannot be used during an encounter.

Rest removes stamina cubes only. Damage cubes, *hollow cubes*, and condition tokens stay where they are.

A character may take any, all, or none of these actions in a turn. Each action is resolved in full before another is begun: a character may walk, attack, and then run, but cannot take a minor action in the middle of an attack. A character cannot take Walk, Equip, or Heroic Action a second time in a turn, and cannot take a second major action.

The Equip minor action is the only way to change equipped cards during an encounter. Each card must go to a slot that accepts it, and the character must meet its *stat requirements* (see §3.2, §4.1). The inventory cannot be accessed during an encounter (see §3.2).

Stamina is spent by placing stamina cubes on the endurance bar (see §3.4). A character cannot choose to spend stamina that the bar has no empty space to hold: the character cannot run, and cannot choose an *attack option*, at a cost greater than the number of empty spaces. If a rule obliges a character to place a stamina cube and no empty space remains, the cube is not placed and the character is *staggered* instead (see §8.5, Stagger).

EXAMPLE The Knight begins the turn with four stamina cubes on the endurance bar and removes one. The Knight walks one node, takes the Attack major action with an attack option that costs two stamina, and then runs one node, placing one more stamina cube. The Knight ends the turn with six stamina cubes.

EXAMPLE The Herald begins the turn with seven stamina cubes and two damage cubes on the endurance bar. The Herald removes one stamina cube, walks one node, and takes the Rest major action, removing the remaining six stamina cubes. The two damage cubes stay, and the Herald does not run this turn.

EXAMPLE After recovering one stamina, the Assassin has five stamina cubes and four damage cubes, so one space of the endurance bar is empty. The Assassin's dagger has one attack option that costs one stamina and another that costs three. The Assassin chooses the first and places one stamina cube. The second is not available, because the bar has no room for three more cubes.

10.2 Character Movement

During an *encounter* a character changes *node* in five ways: by either of two *minor actions*, *Walk* and *Run*; by a *shift* icon on an *attack option* (see §10.3, Shift); by the movement that follows a successful *dodge* (see §9.5); and by a *push* (see §8.4). Walk, Run, and shift are *moves*. The movement that follows a dodge and the movement of a push are not moves (see §5.2).

Walk. A minor action. The character moves to one *adjacent node* without spending stamina. A character may walk once per *turn*.

Run. A minor action. The character spends one stamina and moves to one adjacent node. A character may run any number of times in a turn, spending one stamina for each node. A character who has run cannot *Rest* in that turn (see §10.1).

A character may walk and run before the *major action*, after it, or both (see §10.1). A character may run without having walked.

Every move is made into a *valid node* (see §5.2). The *terrain* rules decide which nodes a character may enter: a character cannot move into a node that holds a *gravestone*, a *chest*, an intact *barrel*, or a *pillar token* (see §5.5). A character who moves into a node at its *node model limit* forces a model there to be pushed (see §5.3). A character who enters a node that holds a face-down *trap token* triggers it (see §5.5, Traps).

During an encounter a character cannot leave the tile on which the encounter is fought and cannot pass through a *doorway* (see §5.2).

EXAMPLE The Warrior stands three nodes from a Hollow Soldier. The Warrior walks one node without spending stamina, runs two nodes and places two *stamina cubes*, and attacks the Hollow Soldier on its node. After the attack the Warrior runs one node away and places a third stamina cube.

10.3 Character Attacks

A character attacks by taking the *Attack* major action (see §10.1). During that action the character may make up to one attack with each *weapon* or *spell equipped* in a *weapon slot*: one with the card in the left weapon slot and one with the card in the right weapon slot, in either order. Each attack uses one *attack option* of that card (see §4.1, Card Anatomy). A weapon that bears the *two-handed* icon is one card in one weapon slot and makes one attack.

Spells are limited further (see §4.3). A character may use at most one spell attack option per *turn*. A spell stored in a *catalyst* is used as that catalyst's one attack. Attaching an *upgrade spell* is done as the Attack major action and uses the attack of the weapon slot that holds it (see §4.2, Upgrade Spells).

A character's attacks *target* hostile models: an enemy, a *boss*, an *invader*, a *mimic*, or a *crystal lizard*. In this section the word enemy covers all of these. Characters target other characters only in a PvP *encounter* (see §20.4).

Each attack is resolved as follows.

1. Choose one attack option of a weapon or spell equipped in a weapon slot.
2. Pay the stamina cost of the attack option by placing *stamina cubes* on the *endurance bar* (see §3.4).
3. If the attack option shows a *shift* icon before its dice, resolve the shift (see §10.3, Shift).
4. Choose the target: one enemy within *range* of the attack (see §10.3, Range).
5. Roll the dice shown on the attack option (see §2.7).
6. The character may reroll one die if the weapon is wielded two-handed (see §10.4).
7. The character may flip the *luck* token to reroll any or all of the dice (see §3.5, Luck).
8. Work out the *attack value*: add together the values rolled, apply any fixed modifier printed on the attack option, add one if the weapon is *scaled* (see §10.5), and subtract one if the character is *staggered* (see §8.5, Stagger).
9. Subtract the target's *block* from the attack value if the attack deals *physical damage*, or the target's *resist* if the attack deals *magical damage*. The result is the damage the target suffers.
10. Place *wound tokens* with a total value equal to the damage on the target (see §8.2).

11. Apply to the target any *push* icon and any *condition* icon shown on the attack option (see §8.4, §8.5).
12. If the attack option shows a shift icon after its dice, resolve the shift (see §10.3, Shift).

The character may take the rerolls of steps 6 and 7 in either order, and may take both on the same roll. A fixed modifier, +1 or −1 for example, is applied once to the total of the dice after every reroll; it is not applied to each die (see §4.1, Card Anatomy). An attack value below zero counts as zero.

An attack deals physical damage unless its attack option bears the magical damage icon, in which case it deals magical damage. An enemy's block and resist are the fixed values printed on its *data card* (see §8.2). If the target's block or resist equals or exceeds the attack value, the target suffers no damage.

An enemy that is the target of an attack within range is *hit*, whether or not it suffers damage (see §8.1). An enemy whose wound tokens equal or exceed its scaled health is killed and removed from the tile (see §8.2, §8.3). Damage to a boss, an invader, or a mimic is recorded on its *health dial* in place of wound tokens (see §15.4).

An attack against a boss is resolved by the same steps. The *boss arc* from which the character attacks decides whether a black die is added to the roll for a *weak arc* (see §15.6). In a PvP encounter the defending character rolls a defence in place of a fixed block or resist (see §20.4).

An attack that a rule grants outside the Attack major action, a *riposte* for example (see §9.6), is resolved by the same steps. It does not count towards the limit of one attack with each weapon slot.

Besides the magical damage icon, an attack option may show a push icon (see §8.4), a condition icon (see §8.5), and the icons set out in the remainder of this section: range, shift, area-of-effect, shaft, and repeat.

> EXAMPLE The Warrior wields a great axe that bears the two-handed icon. The axe's highest *stat requirement* is 14 STR and the Warrior's strength is 20, so the axe is scaled. The Warrior chooses an attack option that costs two stamina and shows two blue dice and one black die with a +1 modifier, and places two stamina cubes. The Warrior targets a Silver Knight Swordsman on an *adjacent node*, within the axe's range of 1. The dice show 2, 1, and 0. The Warrior takes the two-handed reroll on the 0, which now shows 2, for a total of 5. The +1 modifier makes 6 and the scaling bonus makes 7, which is the attack value. The attack deals physical damage and the Silver Knight Swordsman's block is 2, so it suffers five damage and the Warrior places wound tokens with a total value of 5 on it.

RANGE

Every weapon card and spell card prints a base range beside the range icon (see §4.1, Card Anatomy). An attack option that prints a range of its own uses that range in place of the card's base range. The attack option's range applies to that attack option alone; the card's other attack options keep the base range.

Range is counted in *nodes* (see §5.4). The range of an attack is a maximum: a target at any shorter distance, including a target on the attacker's own node, is within range unless an icon on the attack option forbids it (see §10.3, Shaft). Range is checked when the target is chosen, after any shift resolved before the dice. A character cannot make an attack that has no permitted target within its range.

> EXAMPLE The Herald's spear prints a base range of 1, and one of its attack options prints a range of 2. With that attack option the Herald targets a Hollow Soldier two nodes away. With any other attack option of the spear the Herald targets an enemy on the Herald's own node or on an adjacent node.

SHIFT

An attack option that bears the shift icon allows the character to *move* as part of the attack. The character may move up to the number of nodes shown with the icon, and may move fewer nodes or none. If the icon is printed before the attack option's dice, the shift is resolved before the target is chosen and the dice are rolled. If the icon is printed after the dice, the shift is resolved after the damage and every other effect of the attack.

A shift costs no stamina. A shift is a move (see §5.2): every node entered must be a *valid node*, and the rules for *terrain*, the *node model limit*, and *trap tokens* apply as they do to *Walk* and *Run* (see §10.2). A shift is separate from the Walk and Run minor actions and does not use them up.

> EXAMPLE The Assassin stands two nodes from a Skeleton Soldier. The Assassin's attack option has a range of 1 and shows a shift icon with the number 1 before its dice. The Assassin pays the stamina cost, moves one node, chooses the Skeleton Soldier on the adjacent node as the target, and rolls the dice. The Assassin has not walked this turn and walks one node away after the attack.

AREA-OF-EFFECT

An attack option that bears the *area-of-effect* icon targets one node within range instead of one enemy. Every enemy on that node is a target of the attack and is hit by it. The dice are rolled once and one attack value is worked out. That attack value is compared separately with the block or resist of each enemy on the node, and each enemy suffers the damage that results.

A push icon or a condition icon on the attack option applies to every enemy on the node (see §8.4, §8.5). The attack may target the attacker's own node unless the attack option also bears the *shaft* icon (see §10.3, Shaft). Outside a PvP encounter, characters on the targeted node are not affected (see §20.4).

EXAMPLE The Herald uses a miracle whose attack option bears the area-of-effect icon and the magical damage icon and prints a range of 2. The Herald targets a node two nodes away that holds two Hollow Soldiers and a Silver Knight Swordsman, rolls once, and works out an attack value of 4. Each Hollow Soldier has a resist of 1 and suffers three damage, so the Herald places a wound token of value 3 on each. The Silver Knight Swordsman has a resist of 4 and suffers no damage, but it is hit.

SHAFT

An attack option that bears the shaft icon cannot target a model on the attacker's own node. An area-of-effect attack option that bears the shaft icon cannot target the attacker's own node. Every other node within range may be targeted.

EXAMPLE The Knight's bow prints a range of 3, and each of its attack options bears the shaft icon. One Hollow Soldier shares the Knight's node and another stands two nodes away. The Knight targets the second Hollow Soldier, because the first is not a permitted target.

REPEAT

An attack option that bears the *repeat* icon ② is resolved in full the number of times shown in the icon. The character pays the stamina cost once, before the first resolution, and then resolves steps 3 to 12 of the attack once for each time shown.

Each resolution is a separate attack roll with its own target: the character may target the same enemy again or a different enemy within range. The two-handed reroll applies to each roll (see §10.4). The luck token rerolls the dice of one roll only (see §3.5, Luck). All the resolutions together are that weapon's one attack for the turn.

EXAMPLE The Assassin's dagger has an attack option that costs one stamina and bears the repeat icon showing 2. The Assassin places one stamina cube and resolves the attack option twice. The first roll kills a Hollow Soldier on the Assassin's node. The Assassin targets a second Hollow Soldier on the same node with the second roll and places two wound tokens of value 1 on it.

10.4 Two-Handed Attacks

A *weapon* is wielded *two-handed* in either of two cases.

- The weapon card bears the two-handed weapon icon. Such a weapon requires the other *weapon slot* to be empty (see §3.2).
- The weapon card bears the one-handed weapon icon and is *equipped* while the other weapon slot holds no card.

Any card in the other weapon slot is equipment in the other hand. A one-handed weapon equipped beside a *shield*, a *catalyst*, a *spell*, or a second weapon is not two-handed (see §4.1, Card Types). Whether a weapon is wielded two-handed is judged when each attack is made.

When a character attacks with a weapon wielded two-handed, the character may reroll one die of the attack roll after rolling (see §10.3). The new result stands. The reroll is available on every attack roll made with that weapon, including each resolution of an *attack option* that bears the *repeat* icon ② (see §10.3, Repeat).

A spell is never two-handed (see §4.3). A spell card equipped while the other weapon slot is empty gains no reroll, and the attack options of a spell stored in a catalyst gain none.

A character who wields a weapon two-handed has no shield equipped and therefore cannot *parry* (see §9.6).

EXAMPLE The Knight has a one-handed sword in the right weapon slot and no card in the left weapon slot, so the sword is wielded two-handed. The Knight attacks a Hollow Soldier and rolls two black dice, which show 2 and 0. The Knight rerolls the 0, which now shows 1, and the *attack value* is 3. On the next *turn* the Knight takes the *Equip* minor action and equips a shield in the left weapon slot. The sword is no longer two-handed, and its attacks gain no reroll.

10.5 Stat Scaling

Relevant stat. The stat whose *stat requirement* is the highest of the four printed on a *weapon* card (see §4.1, Stat Requirements). If two or more requirements are tied for the highest, the character chooses one of the tied stats as the relevant stat.

A weapon is *scaled* while it is *equipped* by a character whose value in the relevant stat exceeds that highest stat requirement by five or more (see §3.3). When a weapon becomes scaled, the character must mark the weapon card with a red cube. The cube is removed when the weapon is no longer equipped.

Every *attack option* of a scaled weapon adds one to its *attack value* (see §10.3). The bonus is +1 and no more, however far the stat exceeds the requirement. Only the relevant stat is compared; the weapon's other stat requirements play no part in scaling.

Spells are never scaled (see §4.3).

EXAMPLE The Warrior's great axe prints requirements of 14 STR, 8 DEX, 0 INT, and 0 FTH, so strength is its relevant stat. The Warrior's strength is 20, which exceeds 14 by six. The axe is scaled: the Warrior marks it with a red cube, and each of its attack options adds one to its attack value.

EXAMPLE The Assassin's Rapier requires 14 STR and 21 DEX (see Appendix A), so dexterity is its relevant stat. The Assassin's dexterity is 24, which exceeds 21 by three, and the Rapier is not scaled. At the *bonfire* the Assassin raises dexterity to 29. The Rapier is now scaled, and the Assassin marks it with a red cube.

EXAMPLE The Knight's sword prints requirements of 18 STR and 18 DEX, tied for the highest. The Knight has 24 STR and 20 DEX and chooses strength as the relevant stat. The Knight's strength exceeds 18 by six, so the sword is scaled.



PYROMANCER



THIEF



SORCERER



DEPRIVED



CLERIC



BLACK IRON ARMOUR



EMBRACED ARMOUR OF FAVOUR



GOLD-TRIMMED BLACK ROBES



BLACK KNIGHT ARMOUR

CHAPTER 11

11 Returning to the Bonfire



The bonfire is a safe haven in a treacherous world. Two strangers wait beside it. The Firekeeper, blindfolded and silent, strengthens the characters in exchange for souls. Blacksmith Andre, toiling at his forge, sells equipment and fits upgrades.

11.1 The Bonfire

The *bonfire* is represented by the bonfire tile, which is placed at setup (see §6.4). The bonfire tile has no nodes, and no *encounter* is fought on it. A model on the bonfire tile stands anywhere on the tile. The *Firekeeper* (see §11.3) and Blacksmith Andre (see §11.4) wait at the bonfire, and the characters may visit them only while the party rests (see §11.2).

The characters begin the game on the bonfire tile (see §6.4). The party returns to it in the following cases.

- After an encounter is *cleared*, the party may return to the bonfire tile instead of advancing to the next tile (see §7.5, Encounter Recovery).
- When an encounter is *failed*, the party must return to the bonfire tile and rest (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution). The death of a *hollow* character fails the encounter at once (see §7.2).
- When a boss is defeated, the characters return to the bonfire tile and rest (see §16.5).

When the party returns, the characters' models are placed on the bonfire tile. The characters do not pass back through the encounter tiles, and no encounter is fought on the way.

Returning to the bonfire tile costs nothing. The party spends a *spark* only when it rests (see §11.2). Until the party rests, no character is restored, the Firekeeper and Andre cannot be visited, and no encounter is *reset*.

11.2 Resting

Resting at the bonfire is an action of the whole party: the characters rest together, and no character rests alone. The party may rest whenever the characters are on the *bonfire* tile and the *spark* dial shows one or more (see §7.4). When an *encounter* is *failed*, the party must rest; if the spark dial shows zero, the party cannot rest and the players lose the game (see §7.1).

Resting costs one spark. A rest that follows the defeat of a boss costs no spark (see §7.4). If a player versus player (PvP) encounter follows the boss, that free rest is taken after the PvP encounter (see §20.9). In campaign play, a rest costs no spark only when it follows the completion of a *section* (see §18.3).

The party rests as follows.

1. Turn the spark dial down by one, unless the rest costs no spark.
2. Revive each dead or *lost* character: stand the character's model upright on the bonfire tile (see §7.2).
3. Remove every *damage cube* and every *stamina cube* from each character's endurance bar (see §3.4).
4. Remove every *hollow cube* from each character's endurance bar (see §7.2).
5. Remove every *condition* token from each character (see §8.5).
6. Flip each character's *heroic action*, *luck*, and *estus flask* tokens to the ready side (see §3.5).
7. If the *shop* has not been restocked since a boss was last defeated, restock it (see §6.3, Restocking After a Boss).
8. The characters may visit the *Firekeeper* (see §11.3) and Blacksmith Andre (see §11.4), in either order and any number of times.
9. *Reset* every encounter (see §11.5).

A rest restores every character in the same way, whether the character was living, dead, or lost when the rest began. After a rest no character is *hollow*, and every endurance bar is empty.

Resting neither places nor removes an *ember token*. An *embered* character stays embered through the rest, and a character who is not embered does not become embered by resting (see §7.3).

Resting does not restock the shop except as step 7 directs. Cards bought from the shop are not replaced, and unsold cards stay in the shop, until the shop is next restocked (see §6.3, Restocking After a Boss). In campaign play, step 7 applies when a section has been completed rather than when a boss has been defeated (see §18.6, Blacksmith Andre's Shop).

While the party rests, each character may rearrange their *inventory* and equipment slots and may trade cards with other characters, as at any time outside an encounter (see §3.2).

EXAMPLE The Knight, the Herald, and the Assassin clear the second encounter, a Level 2 encounter. The Herald died in it holding three souls, which lie on the second tile, and has been revived hollow. The Knight and the Assassin hold seven souls each, and the spark dial shows three. The party returns to the bonfire tile and rests. The spark dial is turned down to two. The Knight's four damage cubes and the Herald's two hollow cubes are removed, and the Knight's used estus flask token and the Assassin's used luck token are flipped to the ready side. No boss has been defeated, so the shop is not restocked. The Knight pays the Firekeeper two souls to raise strength from the base tier to stat tier one and holds five souls. The Assassin pays Andre two souls for a Rapier from the tier one shop and places it in the inventory, then sells a Morning Star for one soul and holds six souls. The Morning Star is placed face down at the bottom of the tier one treasure deck. The party then resets every encounter: the first and second encounter cards are turned face down and keep their black cubes, and the Herald's three souls stay on the second tile.

11.3 The Firekeeper

The *Firekeeper* raises a character's stats in exchange for that character's *souls*. A character may visit the Firekeeper only while the party rests at the *bonfire* (see §11.2).

Each purchase raises one of the character's four stats by one *stat tier* (see §3.3). Stat tiers are bought in sequence: a stat rises from the base tier to stat tier one, then to stat tier two, then to stat tier three, and then to stat tier four, and no tier is passed over. The character pays the cost of the stat tier bought, as the following table shows.

Stat tier bought	Cost in souls
Stat tier one	2
Stat tier two	4
Stat tier three	8
Stat tier four	10

A character may make any number of purchases during one rest, for one stat or for several, and pays for each purchase separately. When a stat rises, the character moves its *stat cube* as the stat progression track directs; the value of a stat at stat tier four and the way that tier is marked are stated there (see §3.3). Campaign play uses its own costs (see §18.6, Stat Tier Costs).

Each character pays with their own souls. Souls cannot be pooled or transferred between characters (see §7.6). Outside a rest, souls are spent only to call a *summon* at the *fog gate* (see §12.1).

EXAMPLE The Herald's strength stat cube is in the base space, and the Herald holds six souls. During a rest the Herald pays the Firekeeper two souls for stat tier one and then four souls for stat tier two. The Herald moves the strength stat cube two spaces to the right and holds no souls.

11.4 Blacksmith Andre

Blacksmith Andre keeps the *shop* and fits upgrades. A character may visit Andre only while the party rests at the *bonfire* (see §11.2). Andre trades *treasure cards* for *souls*, and each character pays and is paid in their own souls (see §7.6).

Shop tiers

The shop is two piles of face-up treasure cards: the tier one shop and the tier two shop (see §6.3). The tier one shop is open from the start of the game. The tier two shop opens when the *mini-boss* is defeated (see §6.6); in campaign play it opens when the *bonfire ascetic* is burnt (see §18.7).

The shop is restocked only after a boss is defeated, and its unsold cards are returned to their treasure decks before it is restocked (see §6.3, Restocking After a Boss). In campaign play the shop is restocked only when a *section* is completed (see §18.6, Blacksmith Andre's Shop). A card bought from the shop is not replaced until the shop is next restocked.

Purchases

A character may buy any card in the shop. A card in the tier one shop costs two souls, and a card in the tier two shop costs four souls. The character returns the souls to the supply and places the card in their *inventory* (see §3.2). A character may buy any number of cards during one rest.

An *ember card* is a tier one shop card and costs two souls. A character who is not permitted to carry an ember card cannot buy one (see §4.4). *Boss treasure* and *legendary treasure* are not placed in the shop and cannot be bought (see §6.2).

Sales

A character may sell to Andre any treasure card they hold, whether it is *equipped*, in the *back-up slot*, or in the inventory. *Starting equipment* cannot be sold. Andre pays one soul for a tier one or tier two treasure card and six souls for a boss treasure card, and the character takes the souls from the supply. Legendary treasure and *transposed treasure* are *tier two treasure* cards (see §6.2).

A sold card goes to one of the following places.

- A sold tier one or tier two treasure card is placed face down at the bottom of the treasure deck of its tier (see §6.2).
- A sold boss treasure card is returned to the game box.
- A sold ember card is returned face up to the tier one shop.

When a *weapon* with *Titanite* attached is sold, the Titanite goes with the weapon to the bottom of the treasure deck of the weapon's tier, and every other *upgrade card* attached to a sold card returns to the character's inventory (see §4.2, Titanite). The sell value of the weapon is paid once; attached Titanite adds nothing to it.

PRICES

CARD	PURCHASE COST IN SOULS	SELL VALUE IN SOULS
Tier one card	2	1
Tier two card	4	1
Boss treasure card	-	6

An ember card is priced as a tier one card. Boss treasure cannot be purchased. Campaign play uses its own prices (see §18.6, Shop Price Table).

UPGRADES

Andre attaches an upgrade card bearing the weapon upgrade icon or the armour upgrade icon from a character's inventory to a weapon or *armour* card equipped by that character. Andre also removes an attached upgrade card other than Titanite and returns it to the character's inventory. Andre charges no souls for either service, and a character may have any number of upgrade cards attached or removed during one rest.

The *upgrade slots* that limit the number of attached cards, the *stat requirements* of upgrade cards, the permanence of Titanite, and the attaching of *upgrade spells* are stated with the upgrade rules (see §4.2).

11.5 Resuming Exploration

The last step of a rest *resets* every *encounter* (see §11.2). The characters then set out again from the *bonfire* tile; their visits to the *Firekeeper* and Blacksmith Andre are over until the party next rests.

The encounters are reset as follows.

1. Turn every face-up *encounter card* face down.
2. Leave the black cube on each encounter card that carries one (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution).
3. Remove every enemy model from the encounter tiles.
4. Leave every *terrain* token and model on its node, and restore each kind of terrain as its rules direct (see §5.5).
5. Leave all *dropped souls* on their tiles (see §7.6).

A *cleared* encounter keeps its black cube through the reset, and a *failed* encounter has none (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution). A cleared *Level 4 encounter* is the exception to the reset: it is not reset and is not fought again (see §6.7, Level 4 Encounters). A failed boss encounter is reset as the boss rules direct (see §15.2). An *invader* that has appeared does not return when the encounters are reset (see §12.2).

After the reset the characters leave the bonfire tile and enter the encounter tile adjacent to it, where that tile's encounter begins (see §7.5, Encounter Start). The characters then advance one tile at a time towards the boss tile. If the *fog gate* token is on the bonfire tile, the party may instead pass through it to the boss encounter without entering any encounter tile (see §15.1).

When the characters enter a tile whose encounter card carries a black cube, the party may skip the encounter or fight it again. Skipping costs each character stamina; the cost and its limit are stated with the encounter rules (see §7.5, Encounter Start). An encounter fought again awards the *reduced reward* and no treasure (see §7.6). An encounter whose card carries no black cube, because it was failed or has not yet been cleared, cannot be skipped and must be fought.

> EXAMPLE The Knight, the Herald, and the Assassin have rested after clearing the first and second encounters, and they set out again. The first and second encounter cards carry black cubes, and the party skips both encounters. The characters enter the third tile, each placing two stamina cubes on their endurance bar, and the third encounter begins. The Herald's three dropped souls stay on the second tile, because the Herald has not survived a cleared encounter there since dropping them.



THE BONFIRE TILE



SPARK DIAL



12 Phantoms

Not every spirit that crosses into the characters' world comes as a foe, and not every foe belongs to it. White phantoms answer the call of the embered and stand beside them against the great bosses. Red phantoms come unbidden, drawn by the same flame. This chapter describes both.

Phantom. A *summon* or an *invader*. A summon is a friendly phantom that fights beside the characters in one boss encounter (see §12.1). An invader is a hostile phantom that joins the enemies of one encounter (see §12.2).

Every phantom has a model, a *data card*, and *behaviour cards* (see §2.4). A phantom is neither a character nor a *boss*. A rule that names characters or bosses applies to a phantom only where this chapter says so.

12.1 Summons

Summons are an optional rule. They require the Phantoms expansion. The party decides during setup whether summons are in play.

A summon is a friendly *phantom* that *embered* characters call to fight beside them in one *boss* encounter. No more than one summon takes part in an *encounter*. Standard summons are called before a *mini-boss* encounter, and advanced summons before a *main-boss* or *mega-boss* encounter (see §2.4).

Summoning

Each time the characters are about to pass through the *fog gate* into a mini-boss, main-boss, or mega-boss encounter (see §15.1), the embered characters may call a summon as follows.

1. Each embered character may pay two *souls*. A character pays no more than once.
2. For each character who pays, draw one summon *data card* at random and turn it face up: a standard summon before a mini-boss encounter, an advanced summon before a main-boss or mega-boss encounter.
3. Choose one of the drawn data cards. The summon on that card joins the encounter.
4. Return every other drawn data card to the supply.
5. Take the chosen summon's model, its four *behaviour cards*, and the summon *health dial*.
6. Set the health dial to the starting health 24 printed on the data card.
7. Shuffle the four behaviour cards and place them face down as the summon's *behaviour deck*.
8. When the character models have been placed on the *entry nodes* of the *boss tile* (see §15.2), place the summon model on an entry node that holds fewer than three models.

The players choose the summon together in step 3. Souls paid in step 1 are not returned, whichever card is chosen. This payment is an exception to the rule that souls are spent only while resting at the *bonfire* (see §7.6). If no character pays, no summon joins the encounter.

> EXAMPLE The Knight and the Herald are embered, and the Assassin is not. Before the Gargoyle encounter the Knight and the Herald each pay two souls and draw Eygon of Carim and Sword Master. The players choose Eygon of Carim. The data card of Sword Master returns to the supply, and all four souls stay paid.

Summon Turns

In a boss encounter the boss and the characters alternate *turns* (see §16.1). The summon takes a turn after each character's turn and before the boss's next turn. The summon takes no turn after a boss's turn.

On each of its turns the summon acts as follows.

1. If the summon's behaviour deck is empty, turn its discard pile face down, without shuffling, to form a new behaviour deck.
2. Draw the top card of the behaviour deck.
3. Resolve each icon on the behaviour card in order from left to right.
4. Place the behaviour card face up on the discard pile.

The players make every choice that a behaviour card leaves open. An attack on a behaviour card is resolved as a character's attack is, with the *range*, dice, and modifiers shown on the card, and costs no stamina (see §10.3). A summon that attacks a boss from a node in the boss's *weak arc* adds one black die 1 to the attack roll (see §15.6).

When a summon resolves a *shift* icon, it may *move* up to the number of nodes shown (see §10.3, Shift). A shift icon printed before the dice is resolved before the attack roll. A shift icon printed after the dice is resolved after the attack roll.

Distract. An icon found only on summon behaviour cards. During the boss's next turn the summon is treated as holding the *aggro token*; the token itself is not moved.

> EXAMPLE The Assassin and the Knight fight the Gargoyle with Eygon of Carim as their summon. The Gargoyle takes its turn, then the Assassin, then Eygon. The Gargoyle takes its next turn, then the Knight, then Eygon again.

SUMMONS IN COMBAT

A summon's data card shows its *threat* ◈, its starting health, its *block*, *resist*, and *dodge* dice, and a special ability. A summon has no *endurance bar* and pays no stamina. It has no *boss arcs* and no *heat-up* point, and its health is not scaled.

The boss's behaviours treat a summon as a character. A summon is counted when a behaviour *targets* the nearest character or compares threat (see §16.3). A summon that is *hit* is *pushed* and receives *conditions* as a character does (see §8.4; §8.5).

A summon never holds the aggro token. Damage that a summon deals to the boss does not move the token (see §16.4).

When an attack targets a summon, the players choose its defence and roll the dice shown on its data card as for a character (see §9.4; §9.5).

- Block or resist: the summon rolls its block dice against physical damage or its resist dice against magical damage. Its *defence total* is the sum of the two highest dice.
- Dodge: the dodge costs the summon nothing. If the roll equals or exceeds the attack's *dodge difficulty*, the summon is not hit and must move to an adjacent *valid node* chosen by the players. If the roll is lower, the summon suffers the attack's full damage.

Each point of damage that a summon suffers lowers its health dial by one.

A summon's special ability applies as printed on its data card. An ability that is used once per encounter may be used at any moment the players choose. When it is used, a *wound token* is placed on the data card to mark the ability as used.

Summons neither trigger traps nor suffer them (see §5.5, Traps).

REMOVAL OF A SUMMON

A summon is removed from play when its health dial is reduced to zero or when the encounter ends. Its model, data card, and behaviour cards are returned to the supply.

A summon is not a character. The encounter is not *failed* by the death of a summon, and no character becomes *hollow* because of it. An encounter in which every character has died is failed even if the summon is still on the tile (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution).

12.2 Invaders

Invaders are an optional rule. They require the Phantoms expansion. The party decides during setup whether invaders are in play.

An invader is a hostile *phantom* that joins one *encounter* and hunts the characters. Standard invaders appear before the *mini-boss* is defeated, and advanced invaders after it (see §2.4). Except where this section says otherwise, the rules for enemy models apply to an invader.

INVASIONS

Invasion. The placing of *invader tokens* that brings one invader into the game.

Embered characters provoke invasions. An invasion is provoked at either of two moments.

- At setup: when the *encounter cards* are dealt to the tiles (see §6.5; §6.6), if one or more characters are embered.
- During the exploration: when a character becomes embered by discarding an *ember card* (see §7.3), if one or more face-down encounter cards lie on the encounter tiles.

No more than one invasion is provoked before the mini-boss is defeated, and no more than one after it. Once an invasion has been provoked, no further invasion is provoked in that part of the game, however many characters are or become embered. If no character is embered when the encounter cards are dealt, no invader token is placed at that step.

The embering of every character at a boss's defeat (see §16.5) provokes no invasion at that moment. The invasion that follows the mini-boss's defeat is provoked when the encounter cards of the next setup are dealt (see §6.6).

INVADER TOKENS

When an invasion is provoked, the invader tokens are placed as follows.

1. Draw one invader token at random and keep it face down: a standard invader token if the mini-boss has not been defeated, an advanced invader token if it has.
2. Add blank invader tokens, face down, until there is one token for each face-down encounter card on the encounter tiles. If the blank tokens run out, make up the number with invader tokens of the kind not drawn in step 1; such a token is treated as blank when it is revealed.
3. Shuffle these tokens face down.
4. Place one token face down on each face-down encounter card.

An invader token stays face down on its encounter card until the characters fight that encounter. It stays in place when the encounters are *reset* (see §11.5) and when the party skips its encounter (see §7.5, Encounter Start). Invader tokens still on the tiles when the mini-boss is defeated are returned to the supply unrevealed (see §6.6).

The token on an encounter card is revealed during Encounter Start, after the enemy models and *terrain* have been placed (see §7.5, Encounter Start). A blank token is returned to the supply, and the encounter is fought without an invader. A token that shows an invader brings that invader into the encounter; the token is returned to the game box and is not used again during the game.

Invader tokens are placed only on encounter cards. No invader appears in a *boss* encounter, and none takes part in a mimic encounter (see §13). Some campaigns place named invaders in listed encounters and use no invader tokens (see §19.3; §19.4).

> EXAMPLE The Herald discards an ember card while two face-down encounter cards lie on the tiles ahead, before the mini-boss is defeated. The party draws one standard invader token, adds one blank token, shuffles the two face down, and places one on each card. The token on the next tile is blank and returns to the supply. The token on the tile after it shows Maneater Mildred, who joins that encounter.

Invader Setup

When a revealed token shows an invader, the invader is set up as follows.

1. Take the invader's model, *data card*, *behaviour cards*, and *treasure card*, and the invader *health dial*.
2. Set the health dial to the starting health 24 printed on the data card.
3. Shuffle the invader's behaviour cards.
4. Deal a number of behaviour cards equal to the behaviour deck size 4 on the data card, face down, to form the invader's *behaviour deck*.
5. Set the remaining behaviour cards aside, face down.
6. Place the invader model on the central node of the tile.
7. If terrain blocks the central node (see §5.5), place the model instead on a node adjacent to the central node that no terrain blocks, chosen by the players.

The invader is placed directly on its node. No model enters a tile through a *doorway* during an encounter (see §5.2).

Invader Turns

An invader does not take its *turn* with the enemy models (see §9.1). The invader takes one turn after each character's turn (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order).
On each of its turns the invader acts as follows.

1. If the invader's behaviour deck is empty, turn its discard pile face down, without shuffling, to form a new behaviour deck.
2. Draw the top card of the behaviour deck.
3. Resolve each icon on the behaviour card in order from left to right, as the icons of a boss's behaviour card are resolved (see §16.2; §16.3).
4. Place the behaviour card face up on the discard pile.

An invader has no *boss arcs*. Its behaviour cards show no attack arcs and no *weak arc*, and no attack against an invader gains the weak-arc die (see §15.6).

An invader has no *heat-up cards*. When an invader's health is reduced to or below the *heat-up* point 12 on its data card, one of its unused behaviour cards, taken at random, is shuffled into its behaviour deck in place of a heat-up card (see §15.5).

The invader's special ability applies as printed on its data card.

Combat with an Invader

Characters *target* and attack an invader as they do an enemy model (see §10.3). The invader's *block* and *resist* values 2 1 are printed on its data card. Damage to an invader is recorded on its health dial, not with *wound tokens*, and counts when the *aggro token* is reassigned (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order).

An invader is not scaled. Neither enemy scaling (see §8.3) nor the *bonfire ascetic* (see §18.7) changes its health or its attacks.

If any character dies while an invader is on the tile, the invader vanishes at once. Its model is removed from the tile, and it awards no souls and no treasure. The encounter continues against the remaining enemy models, and the character's death is resolved as any other (see §7.2).

Invader Rewards

An invader is killed when its health dial is reduced to zero. Its model is removed from the tile at once, even if other enemy models remain.
When an invader is killed, every character gains *souls* equal to the invader reward at once, in addition to the reward of the encounter (see §7.6). The invader's treasure card is awarded to the party at once (see §7.7). The players decide which character receives it. If they cannot agree, the card goes to the character who holds the aggro token at that moment.

End of an Invasion

An invader is an enemy model and counts towards clearing an encounter. While the invader is on the tile, the encounter is not *cleared*: it is cleared only when every enemy model, the invader included, has been killed, or when the invader has vanished and every other enemy model has been killed (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution).

An invader appears once. Whether it was killed or vanished, its model and cards are returned to the game box. It is not placed again when its encounter is reset (see §11.5).



CHAPTER 13

13 Mimics

Greed has warped certain creatures into the likeness of treasure chests, and they wait with a hunter's patience for a hand upon the lid. A party that has bled for its victory finds one more enemy where its reward was promised. This chapter describes the chest that bites.

Mimics are an optional rule. They require the Explorers expansion. The party decides during setup whether mimics are in play.

13.1 Chests and Ambush Cards

When *mimics* are in play, one *ambush card* is dealt face down beside each encounter tile at setup (see §6.5; §6.6). An ambush card shows Treasure or Mimic on its face (see §2.6). It stays face down until the party chooses to open the *chest* on its tile.

When an *encounter* that contains an unopened chest is *cleared*, its resolution and the characters' recovery are deferred (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution). The characters remain on their nodes. No character recovers, no dead character is revived, and no *souls* or treasure are collected.

The party then decides whether to open the chest or to forgo it. If the players cannot agree, the player whose character holds the *aggro token* decides.

If the party forgoes the chest, the encounter is resolved and the characters recover in the ordinary way, except that the chest is not opened (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution). The chest stays closed, and its ambush card stays face down. Each later time that encounter is cleared, the party again decides whether to open the chest.

If the party opens the chest, the ambush card beside the tile is turned face up.

- Treasure: the chest is opened, and the *treasure card* beneath it is awarded as a chest's card is (see §7.7). The encounter is then resolved and the characters recover in the ordinary way.
- Mimic: the chest is a mimic. A *mimic encounter* begins at once, before any recovery or reward (see §13.2).

In the campaign A Hollow Pursuit, one chest is a mimic without an ambush card (see §19.8).

13.2 The Mimic Encounter

Mimic encounter. The encounter fought against a *mimic* on the tile of a *cleared* encounter whose *chest* the party has opened.

A mimic encounter is fought as a *mini-boss* encounter, with the differences stated in this section (see §15; §16; §17.6). The Hungry Mimic is fought if the mini-boss has not been defeated, and the Voracious Mimic if it has. The mimic encounter is set up as follows.

1. Take the *data card*, the *behaviour cards*, and the model of the Hungry Mimic or the Voracious Mimic, and the mimic *health dial*.
2. Set the health dial to the starting health printed on the data card.
3. Shuffle the mimic's behaviour cards.
4. Deal a number of behaviour cards equal to the behaviour deck size on the data card, face down, to form the mimic's *behaviour deck*.
5. Set the remaining behaviour cards aside, face down.
6. Remove the chest token from its node and place the mimic model on that node.
7. Keep the chest token and the treasure card that lay beneath it beside the tile.
8. Leave every character model on the node it occupies.

The characters begin the mimic encounter as the cleared encounter left them. Each character keeps their damage cubes, stamina cubes, and condition tokens, and the *aggro token* stays with its holder. A character who died in the cleared encounter stays dead and takes no part in the mimic encounter.

The mimic takes the first *turn*. The mimic and the characters then alternate turns as a boss and the characters do (see §16.1), and the aggro token moves as it does in a boss encounter (see §16.4).

A mimic differs from a boss in three ways.

- A mimic has no *boss arcs*. Its behaviour cards show no attack arcs and no *weak arc*, and no attack against a mimic gains the weak-arc die (see §15.6).
- A mimic has no *heat-up cards*. When a mimic's health is reduced to or below the *heat-up* point on its data card, one of its unused behaviour cards, taken at random, is shuffled into its behaviour deck in place of a heat-up card (see §15.5).

- The killing of a mimic is not the defeat of a boss. It grants no boss soul reward, no *boss treasure*, no *spark*, no embering, and no rest (see §16.5).

A mimic's health is not scaled. No *summon* is called for a mimic encounter, and no *invader* takes part in one (see §12).

13.3 Mimic Rewards

A *mimic* is killed when its *health dial* is reduced to zero, and the *mimic encounter* ends. The following steps are then resolved in order.

1. Remove the mimic model from the tile.
2. Award the party two *treasure cards*: the card that lay beneath the *chest*, and one card drawn from the treasure deck of the current tier (see §6.2).
3. Resolve the *encounter* that contained the chest as a *cleared* encounter, omitting the opening of the chest (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution).
4. Return the chest token and the *ambush card* to the supply.

The two treasure cards are the reward that the mimic's data card calls Loot the Body. They take the place of the single card that the chest held, and they are awarded to the party as a chest's card is (see §7.7).

A mimic has no soul reward of its own. The *souls* and the treasure that the characters collect in step 3 are the deferred rewards of the encounter that contained the chest (see §7.6; §7.7).

The recovery deferred since the encounter was cleared takes place at the end of step 3. Each surviving character removes all condition tokens, all stamina cubes, and one damage cube, and each character who died in either encounter is revived *hollow* (see §7.5, Encounter Recovery).

A killed mimic does not return. Its chest token is not placed again when the encounter is *reset*, and the chest's node is used as a basic node (see §5.1).

> EXAMPLE The Knight and the Herald clear a Level 2 encounter that contains a chest, before the mini-boss is defeated. The Knight carries three damage cubes and four stamina cubes. The party opens the chest, and the ambush card shows Mimic. The Hungry Mimic replaces the chest token, takes the first turn, and attacks the Knight, who still carries all seven cubes. The characters kill the mimic. The party gains the chest's treasure card and one card drawn from the tier one treasure deck. Each character then gains four souls and one of the treasure cards dealt to the tile, and the Knight removes all four stamina cubes and one damage cube.

13.4 Failed Mimic Encounters

A *mimic encounter* is *failed* when every character has died, or when a *hollow* character dies and is *lost* (see §7.2). The *encounter* that contained the *chest* is then failed, although its enemies had been killed. It awards no *souls* and no treasure, and it is resolved as any failed encounter (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution).

When a mimic encounter is failed, the *mimic* returns to its chest.

1. Remove the mimic model from the tile.
2. Return the chest token, closed side up, to its node, with its *treasure card* beneath it.
3. Leave the *ambush card* face up beside the tile.
4. Return the mimic's data card, behaviour cards, and *health dial* to the supply.

Each later time that encounter is *cleared*, the party again decides whether to open the chest (see §13.1). Opening the chest begins a new mimic encounter, set up afresh (see §13.2). The chest yields no treasure until the mimic is killed.



A MIMIC AT REST



A MIMIC REVEALED



CHAPTER 14

14 Crystal Lizards

Crystal lizards are glimmering reptiles whose hides are studded with the rarest titanite. They want no part of a fight and are gone the moment the last blade is sheathed. A character quick enough to kill one before it escapes carries off a rare prize.

Crystal lizards are an optional rule. They require the Iron Keep expansion. The party decides during setup whether crystal lizards are in play.

When an *encounter card* shows the crystal lizard symbol, one crystal lizard model is placed on each *terrain node* that the card marks with that symbol. The models are placed during Encounter Start (see §7.5, Encounter Start). A crystal lizard is an enemy model with its own *data card* (see §8.2), and the rules for enemy models apply to it except where this chapter says otherwise.

A crystal lizard takes its *turn* with the other enemy models, in descending *threat* order (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order). On its turn it resolves the *behaviour icons* on its data card, which move it away from the characters. A crystal lizard makes no attack.

A crystal lizard is not scaled. Neither enemy scaling (see §8.3) nor the *bonfire ascetic* (see §18.7) changes its health or its movement.

Crystal lizards do not count towards clearing an *encounter*. The encounter is *cleared* when every other enemy model has been killed (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution). Every crystal lizard still on the tile at that moment is removed at once: it has escaped, and it awards nothing.

When a character kills a crystal lizard, that character takes one Titanite Scale card from the supply at once and places it in their *inventory* (see §4.2). The Iron Keep expansion supplies three Titanite Scale cards. When none remains, a killed crystal lizard awards nothing, and no crystal lizard is placed in any later encounter.

Once a crystal lizard has been killed in an encounter, no crystal lizard is placed in that encounter again, however many times the encounter is *reset* and fought (see §11.5). The party marks the tile to record the kill, for example by laying the killed model upside down beside the tile's encounter card. Until a crystal lizard has been killed there, the crystal lizards are placed again each time the encounter is set up.



CRYSTAL LIZARD CHEST BARREL GRAVESTONE



CHAPTER 15

15 Boss Encounters

Boss encounters are the heart of the adventure. A boss is a single model of great health and power, with a behaviour deck in place of fixed behaviours. There are three types: mini-boss, main-boss, and mega-boss.

Bosses follow the enemy rules of §8 and §9 except as stated in this chapter and §16.

15.1 The Fog Gate

The *fog gate* token marks the *doorway* through which the characters enter a *boss encounter*. During setup it is placed on the doorway between the last encounter tile of the route and the *boss tile* (see §6.5, §6.6), or on the doorway of the *mega-boss game board* (see §6.7).

The characters enter a boss encounter only by passing through the fog gate, and the party passes through it together. The boss encounter begins when the characters pass through (see §15.2). The party may pass through the fog gate when it advances from the last encounter tile of the route (see §7.5, Encounter Recovery). Before the characters pass through, an *embered* character may call a *summon* (see §12.1).

The first time the characters pass through the fog gate of a boss, the fog gate token is moved from the doorway to the *bonfire* tile. The token stays on the bonfire tile until that boss is defeated. The setup that follows the boss's defeat moves the token to the doorway of the next boss (see §6.6, §6.7).

While the fog gate token is on the bonfire tile, it is a shortcut to that boss. When the characters set out from the bonfire tile (see §11.5), the party may pass through the fog gate on the bonfire tile and begin the boss encounter at once. The encounters on the route are then neither fought nor skipped: no *stamina cube* is placed for them (see §7.5, Encounter Start). An encounter on the route that is not marked *cleared* does not bar the shortcut.

The party may instead leave the shortcut unused and travel the route from the first encounter tile. Each encounter on the route is then fought or skipped as in any exploration (see §7.5, Encounter Start), and the boss encounter begins when the party advances from the last encounter tile.

In campaign play the fog gate token is aesthetic only and is not a shortcut (see §18.2).

> EXAMPLE The Knight and the Herald clear the fourth encounter and pass through the fog gate for the first time. The fog gate token is moved to the bonfire tile, and the *mini-boss* encounter begins. The Herald, who is *hollow*, dies, and the encounter is *failed*. The party spends one *spark* and rests at the bonfire. The characters then pass through the fog gate on the bonfire tile and begin the mini-boss encounter again. The four *reset* encounters are not fought, and no stamina cubes are placed for them.

15.2 Overview

A *boss* encounter is an *encounter* fought against a boss on a *boss tile* or on a *mega-boss game board* (see §15.3). It follows the rules for encounters (see §7.5) except as this chapter and §16 state. No *encounter card* is dealt to a boss tile, and the boss is the only enemy in the encounter unless its special rules add others (see §17).

A *mini-boss* is fought at the end of the first leg of the exploration and a *main-boss* at the end of the second (see §6.5, §6.6). A *mega-boss*, when one is in play, is fought after the *Level 4 encounter* (see §6.7). A boss is not scaled for the number of characters (see §8.3).

The boss's *behaviour deck* is built during setup, before the boss encounter begins, and is not built again at this point (see §15.5). When the characters pass through the *fog gate*, the boss encounter is set up as follows.

1. Move the fog gate token to the *bonfire* tile, if this is the first time the characters pass through this boss's fog gate (see §15.1).
2. Place each character model on an *entry node* of the boss tile (see §15.3), no more than three models to a node (see §5.3).
3. Place on each character's *endurance bar* the *stamina cubes* owed for encounters skipped on the route (see §7.5, Encounter Start).
4. If the party called a *summon* at the fog gate, place the summon's model (see §12.1).
5. Set the boss's *health dial* to the starting health shown on its *data card* (see §15.4).
6. Place the boss model on the boss *spawn node*, with the centre of its front arc facing the *adjacent node* closest to

the entry nodes (see §15.6). If two or more adjacent nodes are equally close, the players choose one of them.

7. Carry out any setup that the boss's special rules require (see §17).
8. Place the *aggro token* on the character with the highest *threat* (see §7.5, Encounter Start).
9. Begin the boss's first *turn* (see §16.1).

If a boss's special rules state where the boss is placed or how it faces, those rules replace step 6 (see §17).

The boss takes the first turn of the encounter. The boss and the characters then alternate turns: one character takes a turn after each boss turn (see §16.1). A summon takes its turns as §12.1 describes. No *invader* joins a boss encounter (see §12.2).

When the boss's health is reduced to or below the *heat-up point* on its data card, the boss heats up, and a *heat-up card* joins its behaviour deck (see §15.5).

A boss encounter ends in one of two ways. The boss is defeated when its health dial is reduced to zero (see §16.5). The encounter is *failed* when every character has died, or when a *hollow* character dies (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution).

A failed boss encounter is resolved as any failed encounter (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution). This rule applies to every boss, a mega-boss included: a character who dies in a mega-boss encounter is revived as after any other encounter (see §7.2).

When the characters rest at the bonfire after a failed boss encounter, the boss encounter is *reset* with every other encounter (see §11.5). The boss model is removed from the boss tile and kept with its data card, and its behaviour deck is built again (see §15.5, Deck Reset). The boss's health dial is returned to its starting health when the encounter is next set up. *Souls* dropped on the boss tile stay there (see §7.6). The encounter is set up again from step 2 when the characters next pass through the fog gate.

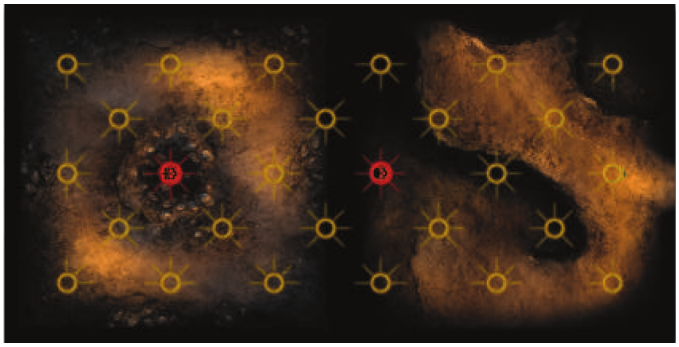
15.3 Boss Tiles

Boss tile. One of the two tiles on which *mini-boss* and *main-boss encounters* are fought. One boss tile is printed with the mini-boss *spawn node* and is the mini-boss tile. The other is printed with the main-boss spawn node.

A mini-boss encounter is fought on the mini-boss tile alone.

A main-boss encounter is fought on both *boss tiles*. The two tiles are joined along one edge to form a single rectangular tile, the main-boss tile (see §6.6). The joined tiles are one tile for every rule. No wall runs along the join, and each *node* beside the join is adjacent to the nodes that face it across the join (see §5.1). Models *move*, are *pushed*, and count *range* across the join as within any tile.

A *mega-boss* encounter is fought on the mega-boss side of the *mega-boss game board* supplied with that mega-boss (see §6.7). A wall printed across a game board separates the nodes on either side of it (see §5.1).



The boss tiles. *The two boss tiles joined along one edge for a main-boss encounter. Each tile shows its boss spawn node in red.*

Boss spawn node. The spawn node of the boss's type: the mini-boss spawn node, the main-boss spawn node, or the mega-boss spawn node. The boss model is placed on it at the start of every boss encounter (see §15.2).

The mini-boss spawn node of the main-boss tile is used as a *basic node* during a main-boss encounter (see §5.1), unless the main-boss's special rules place a model on it (see §17).

The *entry nodes* of a boss encounter are the basic nodes adjacent to the *doorway* on which the *fog gate* token is placed during setup (see §5.1). They are the same nodes whether the characters arrive along the route or by the fog gate shortcut (see §15.1).

No *encounter card* and no *trap tokens* are dealt to a boss tile, and no *terrain* is placed on it, unless the boss's special rules place some (see §17).

15.4 Boss Data Cards

A *boss*'s *data card* lists no behaviours. A boss acts according to its *behaviour deck* (see §15.5). Every boss data card shows the following parts.

- **Name.** The boss's name is printed across the top of the card.
- **Threat.** The value beside the threat icon is the boss's *threat* (see §8.2).
- **Behaviour deck size.** The value beside the behaviour deck size icon is the number of standard *behaviour cards* that form the boss's behaviour deck (see §15.5).
- **Starting health.** The value beside the starting health icon is the health at which the boss begins every attempt at its encounter.
- **Heat-up point.** The value beside the heat-up point icon is the health at or below which the boss heats up (see §15.5).
- **Block and resist.** The two values on the shield icon are the boss's *block* and *resist*. Block is subtracted from

each physical attack against the boss and resist from each magical attack (see §8.2).

- **Special ability.** A rule unique to that boss. It applies for the whole encounter (see §17).
- **Encounter levels.** The *encounter levels* of the four encounters on the route to that boss, in order from the *bonfire* tile (see §6.5, Encounter Cards). The route to a *mega-boss* is the single *Level 4 encounter* fought on its game board (see §6.7).
- **Boss type icon.** An icon marks the boss as a *mini-boss*, a *main-boss*, or a mega-boss.
- **Set symbol.** A symbol shows the core set or expansion the boss belongs to.



A boss data card. *1 Name. 2 Threat. 3 Starting health. 4 Boss type icon. 5 Behaviour deck size. 6 Block. 7 Resist. 8 Heat-up point. 9 Special ability. 10 Set symbol.*

Threat, block, and resist are used exactly as on an enemy data card (see §8.2). A boss's values are not scaled for the number of characters (see §8.3).

Boss health is tracked on that boss's *health dial*, not with *wound tokens* (see §8.2). The dial is set to the boss's starting health when the boss encounter is set up (see §15.2). Each point of damage the boss suffers lowers the dial by one. A boss whose health dial is reduced to zero is defeated (see §16.5).

> EXAMPLE A mini-boss has starting health 24, block 2, and resist 1, and its health dial is set to 24 when the encounter is set up. The Knight makes a physical attack and rolls an *attack value* of 7. The boss's block of 2 is subtracted, the boss suffers five damage, and the health dial is turned to 19.

15.5 Boss Behaviour Cards

A *boss* has no fixed behaviours. Its *behaviour cards* take the place of the *behaviour icons* on an enemy *data card* (see §8.2). One behaviour card is drawn at the start of each of the boss's *turns*, and the boss does what the card shows (see §16.1).

Card Anatomy

Every boss behaviour card shows the following parts.

- **Name.** The name of the behaviour is printed across the top of the card.
- **Range.** The value beside the range icon is the *range* of every attack on the card (see §5.4; §16.3).
- **Dodge difficulty.** The value beside the dodge icon is the *dodge difficulty* of every attack on the card (see §9.5).
- **Heat-up symbol.** The heat-up symbol marks the card as a *heat-up card*. A card without the symbol is a standard behaviour card.
- **Behaviour icons.** A row of movement icons and attack icons, resolved one at a time from left to right (see §16.2; §16.3).
- **Arc diagram.** A diagram beneath each attack icon shows which of the boss's arcs the attack is made into and which arcs are weak (see §15.6, Arc Diagrams).
- **Repeat.** A card that bears the *repeat* icon is resolved the number of times the icon shows (see §16.1).

A boss has no single range or dodge difficulty of its own. The card a boss drew most recently is its current behaviour card until the next card is drawn: the card being resolved during the boss's turn, and at every other time the card it resolved most recently. The range and dodge difficulty of the current behaviour card apply, and its arc diagram shows the boss's *weak arcs*, for that whole time (see §15.6, Arc Diagrams).

Deck Construction

The *behaviour deck* of each boss is built during setup, at the step that places the boss's components on its tile (see §6.5, §6.6, §6.7). It is not built at the start of the boss *encounter*. The deck is built as follows.

1. Set aside the boss's heat-up cards.
2. Shuffle the boss's standard behaviour cards face down.
3. Deal a number of standard behaviour cards equal to the behaviour deck size on the boss's data card into a face-down pile, without looking at them. This pile is the behaviour deck.
4. Set aside the standard behaviour cards that were not dealt, face down, without looking at them. They take no part in the encounter.
5. Shuffle the heat-up cards and place them face down beside the *boss tile*.

The behaviour deck is kept face down on the boss tile, or beside the game board of a *mega-boss*, until the boss encounter begins. The players do not look at its cards, except that a *scry* may reveal its top card (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution). A boss whose special rules build its deck differently follows those rules (see §17).

Deck Renewal

At the start of each boss turn the top card of the behaviour deck is drawn. When the card has been resolved, it is placed face up on top of the boss's discard pile (see §16.1). The discard pile is kept in the order in which its cards were resolved.

When the behaviour deck is empty at the start of a boss turn, the discard pile is turned face down, without shuffling, and becomes the behaviour deck. The cards are then drawn again in the order in which they were first drawn.

Heat-up

Heat-up point. The health value, printed on a boss's data card, at or below which the boss heats up.

A boss heats up when its health is reduced to or below its *heat-up point* . A boss heats up once in each attempt at its encounter. When a boss heats up, a heat-up card is added to its behaviour deck as follows.

1. Take one card at random from the boss's heat-up cards, without looking at it.
2. Shuffle that card, face down, into the cards that remain in the behaviour deck. The discard pile is not shuffled and its order is not changed.
3. If no cards remain in the behaviour deck, place the heat-up card face down as the behaviour deck. The discard pile is not renewed until that card has been drawn.

If a boss heats up during a character's turn, these steps are carried out as soon as the attack that caused the heat-up has been resolved. If a boss heats up during its own turn, as a *riposte* may cause, the steps are carried out after the current behaviour card has been resolved and discarded. The boss's other heat-up cards stay face down beside the boss tile and take no part in the encounter.

Some bosses heat up in other ways. The special rules of such a boss replace the steps of this sub-section (see §17).

> EXAMPLE A *mini-boss* has a heat-up point of 12, and its *health dial* shows 14. Two cards remain in its behaviour deck and three lie in its discard pile. The Warrior's attack inflicts three damage, and the dial is turned to 11. The boss heats up: the players take one of its heat-up cards at random and shuffle it, unseen, into the two cards of the behaviour deck. The three cards of the discard pile are left as they lie. The boss draws from a deck of three cards on its next turn.

Deck Reset

When a *failed* boss encounter is *reset* (see §15.2), the boss's behaviour deck is built again as follows.

1. Gather all of the boss's behaviour cards: the behaviour deck, the discard pile, the heat-up cards, and the standard behaviour cards set aside when the deck was built.
2. Build the behaviour deck from them (see §15.5, Deck Construction).
3. Place the behaviour deck face down on the boss tile, or beside the game board of a mega-boss.

Each attempt at a boss is fought against a newly built behaviour deck.

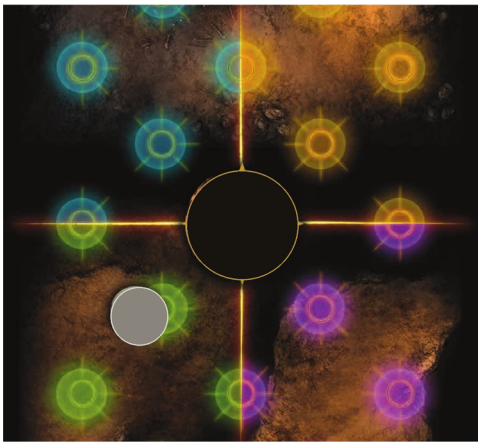
15.6 Arcs and Defence

Boss Arcs

Boss arc. One of the four sectors into which the base of a *boss* model is divided: front, left, right, and back.

Facing. The direction in which the centre of a boss's front arc points. A boss faces directly towards an *adjacent node*, so that the centre of its front arc lines up with the centre of that node.

The lines that divide the base of a boss model, extended across the tile, divide the tile into four areas, one for each *boss arc*. Every *node* on the tile is in at least one arc. A node on the line between two arcs is in both arcs, and a model on that node is in both arcs at once.



Boss arcs. *The lines that divide the boss's base, extended across the tile, divide the nodes among the front, left, right, and back arcs. A node on a line is in both arcs. The dark disc is the boss's base and the grey disc is a character.*

When a boss faces a node in the same row or column as its own, the lines between its arcs run along the diagonals through its node. When a boss faces a node diagonally, the lines run along the row and the column through its node.

A character on the boss's own node is placed against the boss's base in one of the four arcs and is in that arc only (see §15.6, Characters and Arcs).

Mimics, *invaders*, and *summons* have no arcs. The rules of this section for arcs do not apply to attacks against them or to movement on their nodes (see §12; §13).

Facing and Turning

A boss changes its *facing* only when a movement icon turns it towards or away from a *target* (see §16.2) or when it resolves a turn icon. A boss does not change its facing when it attacks (see §16.3).

A boss resolves a turn icon by turning in place on its node.

- The turn 90° right icon turns the boss 90° to its right.
- The turn 90° left icon turns the boss 90° to its left.
- The turn around icon turns the boss 180°, so that its front arc points where its back arc pointed.

A turn icon may leave a boss facing a wall. The boss keeps that facing until it next turns.

When a boss turns, no other model moves. A character on the boss's node stays in place while the boss model turns beneath them, and the character is then in the arc of the base that they touch. The arcs of every other node are read from the boss's new facing.

Arc Diagrams

Beneath each attack icon on a *behaviour card* is an arc diagram. It shows each of the boss's four arcs in one of three states.

- A neutral arc, shown in black, has no effect.
- An *attack arc*, shown in green, is an arc into which an *area attack* is made (see §16.3, Area Attacks).
- A *weak arc*, shown in red, is an arc from which the boss is open to attack (see §15.6, Weak Arcs).

The attack arcs of a diagram apply only to the attack icon beneath which the diagram is printed. The boss's weak arcs are those shown on its current behaviour card (see §15.5, Card Anatomy). If that card bears more than one arc diagram, the diagram beneath its last attack icon shows the boss's weak arcs.

Weak Arcs

A character attacks a boss as any other enemy (see §10.3). The boss's *block* or *resist* is subtracted from the attack (see §8.2), and the damage lowers the boss's *health dial* (see §15.4).
When a character attacks a boss from a weak arc, the attack gains one additional black die 1. A character attacks from the arc in which their node lies or, on the boss's own node, from the arc of the base in which they are placed. The die is gained at any *range*.

A character on a node that lies in two arcs attacks from both arcs, and the attack gains the die if either arc is weak. The same character is targeted by an area attack made into either arc (see §16.3, Area Attacks). The attack gains one black die only, however many weak arcs the character is in.

The die is added to every attack roll made from a weak arc. This includes each roll of an *attack option* that bears the *repeat* icon (see §10.3, Repeat) and the roll of a *riposte* (see §9.6). A summon that attacks a boss from a weak arc gains the die as a character does (see §12.1).

> EXAMPLE The boss faces the node directly ahead of it, on which the Herald stands. The Herald is in the front arc. The Knight stands on the node directly behind the boss, in the back arc. The Assassin stands on the node diagonally ahead of the boss and to its left, which lies on the line between the front arc and the left arc, and is in both arcs. The boss's current behaviour card shows the left arc and the back arc as weak arcs. The Knight attacks from the back arc and adds one black die. The Assassin attacks from the front arc and the left arc and adds one black die. The Herald attacks from the front arc and adds no die.

Characters and Arcs

A character who shares a node with a boss must be placed against the boss's base in one of its four arcs.
When a character moves onto a boss's node, the character is placed in the arc in which the node they left lies. If that node lies in two arcs, the character's player chooses one of the two.

A character on a boss's node may, in place of moving one node, move to an adjacent arc of the base. The front arc and the back arc are each adjacent to the left arc and to the right arc. Each node of movement granted by the *Walk* or *Run minor action* (see §10.2) or by a *shift* icon (see §10.3, Shift) may be used in this way.

When a character moves off a boss's node, the character must move to a *valid node* that is adjacent and that lies in the arc in which the character is placed. A node that lies in two arcs lies in each of them for this purpose. If that arc holds no such node, the character cannot move off the boss's node from that arc.

A character who is *pushed* off a boss's node must be pushed to a valid adjacent node that lies in the arc in which the character is placed. This limit applies whatever causes the push: a *push-move* (see §8.4; §16.2), a *push-attack* (see §16.3), or the *node model limit* (see §5.3). The players choose among the valid adjacent nodes in that arc.

If that arc holds no valid adjacent node because of a wall, the character is pushed to any valid adjacent node that touches that wall. If no valid node exists, the character is not pushed (see §8.4). The push that follows a *leap* is not limited by arcs (see §16.2, Leap).

> EXAMPLE The Knight is on the boss's node, in the front arc. The Knight takes the Walk minor action and moves to the left arc, which costs no stamina. The Knight then takes the Run minor action, places one *stamina cube*, and moves to the back arc.

Defence

A character targeted by a boss's attack defends as against any enemy attack: by block or resist (see §9.4), by *dodge* (see §9.5), or by *parry* (see §9.6). The *dodge difficulty* of the attack is the one printed on the boss's current behaviour card.
The movement that follows a successful dodge ignores arcs. A character who dodges while on a boss's node must move either to any valid adjacent node, whatever arc it lies in, or to any other arc of the boss's base. A character who dodges

onto a boss's node from another node is placed in an arc of their player's choice.

A character may parry a boss's attack only when the attack targets one character and the conditions for a parry are met (see §9.6). An area attack, a *node attack*, and a push-attack cannot be parried. A boss that is parried is *staggered*, and the character may riposte, as against any enemy (see §9.6).

A boss model cannot be pushed by a character's attack or by a character's movement (see §8.4). The push icon on a character's attack option has no effect on a boss, and a boss is not displaced under the node model limit (see §5.3). A boss model is pushed only when another boss model moves onto its node (see §17.1).



GREAT GREY WOLF SIF



BLACK DRAGON KALAMEET



SMELTER DEMON



EXECUTIONER'S CHARIOT



PURSUER



SIR ALONNE

CHAPTER 16

16 Boss Turns



A boss does not take its place in the line of lesser foes. It answers every blow, and each card it turns shows a new way to die. This chapter states how a boss takes its turns, how it moves and attacks, whom it hunts, and what follows when it falls.

16.1 Overview

The *boss* takes the first *turn* of a boss *encounter* (see §15.2). After each boss turn one character takes a turn, and the boss then takes its next turn. The boss and the characters alternate in this way until the boss is defeated (see §16.5) or the encounter is *failed* (see §15.2).

A boss encounter is fought in *rounds*. In each round every living character takes one turn, and the boss takes one turn before each of those turns. The players choose which living character takes each character turn; the descending *threat* order of other encounters does not apply to the characters (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order). No living character takes a second turn in a round until every other living character has taken one. A dead character takes no turn and is not counted.

A character's turn in a boss encounter is resolved as in any encounter (see §10.1). If a *summon* is in play, it takes a turn after each character's turn and before the boss's next turn (see §12.1). A tie in threat is settled as in any encounter (see §7.5, Encounter Start).

A boss's turn is resolved as follows.

1. If the *behaviour deck* is empty, turn the discard pile face down, without shuffling it, to form the behaviour deck (see §15.5, Deck Renewal).
2. Draw the top card of the behaviour deck and place it face up beside the deck. This card is the boss's current *behaviour card* (see §15.5, Card Anatomy).
3. Resolve each icon on the card, one at a time from left to right: each movement icon (see §16.2) and each attack icon (see §16.3).
4. If the card bears the *repeat* icon, resolve the whole row of icons again from left to right, until the row has been resolved the number of times the icon shows.
5. Place the card face up on top of the discard pile.

Each icon is resolved in full before the next. An icon that has no valid *target*, or that cannot be resolved, is skipped, and the next icon to its right is resolved (see §9.1). The repeat icon on a behaviour card repeats the whole card, not one attack. Each time the row is resolved, the target of each icon is determined again.

The boss's turn ends when step 5 is complete. *Conditions* affect a boss as they affect any enemy (see §8.5). If the boss heats up during its own turn, the *heat-up card* joins the behaviour deck after step 5 (see §15.5, Heat-Up). If the boss is defeated during its own turn, as a *riposte* may cause, the turn ends at once and no further icon is resolved (see §16.5).

> EXAMPLE The Knight, the Herald, and the Assassin fight a *mini-boss* whose behaviour deck holds four cards. The boss takes the first turn. The players choose the Herald to act, and the boss takes its second turn. The Knight acts, the boss takes its third turn, and the Assassin acts. Every character has taken a turn, so the round is complete. The boss takes its fourth turn, and the players choose any of the three characters to act next. At the start of its fifth turn the boss's behaviour deck is empty: the discard pile is turned face down without shuffling, and the boss draws the card it drew on its first turn.

16.2 Boss Movement and Symbols

A *boss moves* as an enemy moves (see §9.2), with the differences stated in this section. The number of *nodes* a boss moves is not scaled for the number of characters (see §8.3). Each node a boss enters must be a *valid node* (see §5.2).

Each movement icon on a *behaviour card* shows a direction and a number of nodes. A movement icon that names a *target* shows the skull icon, for the character who holds the *aggro token*, or the nearest-character icon, for the *nearest character* (see §9.2). A *summon* is counted as a character when the target is determined (see §12.1).

Movement Towards a Target

When a movement icon moves a boss towards its target, the boss follows the shortest path of valid nodes to the target's node, as an enemy does (see §9.2, Paths). Each node of the movement is resolved in two steps.

1. Turn the boss so that the centre of its front arc faces the next node of its path.
2. Move the boss forwards onto that node.

The boss stops when it has moved the number of nodes shown or when it stands on the target's node. If two or more paths are equally short, the players choose the path (see §9.2, Paths).

When the target is on the boss's own node, the boss does not leave its node. The boss turns in place until the arc in which the target is placed is its front arc: 90° towards a

target in a side arc, or 180° for a target in the back arc. No character on the node moves while the boss turns (see §15.6, Facing and Turning).

Movement away from a target

When a movement icon moves a boss away from its target, each node the boss enters must be a valid node at a greater *range* from the target than the node it leaves, as for an enemy (see §9.2, Paths). Each node of the movement is resolved in two steps.

1. Turn the boss so that the centre of its back arc faces the node it is to enter.
2. Move the boss backwards onto that node, without turning it further.

If two or more such nodes are open to the boss, the players choose one of them. If no such node is open to the boss, it stops, and the rest of the movement is lost (see §9.2, Paths).

Movement without a target

A movement icon that names no target moves the boss the number of nodes shown in the direction shown: forwards, backwards, to its left, or to its right. The boss does not change its *facing*. Each node it enters is the *adjacent node* at the centre of its front arc, its back arc, its left arc, or its right arc. If that node is not a valid node, the boss stops, and the rest of the movement is lost.

Characters on a node the boss enters

When a boss moves onto a node that holds one or more characters, and the movement is not a *push-move*, the characters stay on that node. Each character is placed against the boss's base in the arc in which the node lay immediately before the boss entered it. If the node lay in two arcs, the character's player chooses one of the two (see §15.6, Characters and Arcs).

A boss model does not count towards the *node model limit*, and its arrival displaces no model (see §5.3).

Push-moves

A movement icon that bears the push icon is a push-move. A boss resolves a push-move one node at a time, as an enemy does (see §8.4), with three differences.

- The boss turns before each node of the movement, as this section describes for movement towards or away from a target.
- A character *pushed* off the boss's own node before the boss moves must be pushed within the arc in which the character is placed (see §15.6, Characters and Arcs).
- A character on a node the boss enters is pushed directly away from the node the boss has left (see §8.4). If no valid node lies directly away, the character is pushed as a character on the boss's own node is pushed: within the arc in which the node lay immediately before the boss entered it, or along the wall if that arc holds no valid adjacent node (see §15.6, Characters and Arcs).

If the push icon carries a damage value, each character on a node the boss enters is attacked before being pushed (see §8.4). The damage value is not scaled, and a *dodge* of the attack is rolled against the *dodge difficulty* of the boss's current behaviour card (see §15.5, Card Anatomy).

Leap

Leap. A boss movement marked with the leap icon. The boss is placed directly on the node of its target, at any distance.

A *leap* names its target as any movement icon does: the character who holds the aggro token or the nearest character. A leap is resolved as follows.

1. Remove the boss model from its node.
2. Place the boss model on the target's node, without changing its facing.
3. Push every character on that node to a valid adjacent node chosen by that character's player.

A leap has no limit of distance, and no model or *terrain* on the nodes between blocks it. The characters pushed in step 3 are not placed in an arc, and the arc limit on pushes does not apply to them (see §15.6, Characters and Arcs). A character who has no valid adjacent node stays on the node and is placed in an arc of their player's choice.

If the target is on the boss's own node, the boss stays on its node and keeps its facing, and step 3 is carried out. If the push icon of a leap carries a damage value, each character on the target's node is attacked before being pushed, as for a push-move (see §8.4).

Turn icons

The turn 90° right icon, the turn 90° left icon, and the turn around icon turn the boss in place on its node. The boss does not move, and no other model moves (see §15.6, Facing and Turning).

> EXAMPLE The boss draws a behaviour card whose first icon is a push-move of two nodes towards the character who holds the aggro token. The Knight holds the aggro token and stands two nodes straight ahead of the boss, on a node against the wall. The Assassin stands on the node between them, and the Herald is on the boss's own node, in the left arc. The Herald is pushed first, to a valid adjacent node in the left arc that the players choose. The boss already faces the Assassin's node and moves forwards onto it without turning. The Assassin is pushed directly away from the node the boss has left, onto the Knight's node. The boss moves forwards again, onto the Knight's node. No valid node lies directly away from the boss, and the front arc holds no valid adjacent node because of the wall. The Knight and the Assassin are each pushed to a valid adjacent node that touches the wall.

EXAMPLE A boss's movement icon moves it one node towards the nearest character. The Warrior is the nearest character and is on the boss's own node, in the back arc. The boss does not leave its node. It turns 180°, and the Warrior, who has not moved, is now in the front arc.

16.3 Boss Attacks

A *boss* attacks as an enemy attacks (see §9.3), with the differences stated in this section. The number printed in the attack icon is the *attack value*, which is fixed and is not scaled for the number of characters (see §8.3). The *range* and the *dodge difficulty* of the attack are those printed on the *behaviour card* that bears the icon (see §15.5, Card Anatomy).

A boss does not change its *facing* when it attacks (see §15.6, Facing and Turning). Range is counted from the boss's *node* (see §5.4).

Targets

An attack icon that shows the skull icon *targets* the character who holds the *aggro token*. An attack icon that shows the nearest-character icon targets the *nearest character* (see §9.2). A *summon* is counted as a character when the target is determined (see §12.1).

The target is attacked in whatever *boss arc* they stand. If the target is not within the card's range, the icon is skipped, and no other character is attacked in the target's place (see §9.3, Targets).

An attack icon that bears the node icon is a *node attack*. It targets every character on the node of the character named by the icon, and each of those characters is attacked separately (see §9.3, Targets).

Area Attacks

Area attack. A boss attack whose icon bears the area icon . It is made into one or more of the boss's arcs, not against one character.
An *area attack* targets every character who is within the card's range of the boss and who is in an *attack arc* of the arc diagram beneath the icon (see §15.6, Arc Diagrams). A character on a node that lies in two arcs is targeted if either arc is an attack arc. A character on the boss's own node is targeted if the arc in which they are placed is an attack arc.

The aggro token and the nearest character play no part in an area attack. Each targeted character is attacked separately with the full attack value, and each defends on their own. If no character is targeted, the icon is skipped.

Damage, Pushes, and Conditions

An attack icon that shows the *magical damage* icon deals magical damage, which a character *resists*. Every other boss attack deals *physical damage*, which a character *blocks* (see §9.4).

An attack icon that bears the push icon is a *push-attack*. Each character it *hits* is *pushed* directly away from the boss after the damage has been resolved (see §8.4). A character who is hit while on the boss's own node is pushed within the arc in which they are placed (see §15.6, Characters and Arcs).

An attack icon that shows a *condition* icon places the matching condition token on each character it hits (see §8.5).

Defence

Each character targeted by a boss's attack chooses one defence before any dice are rolled, as against any enemy attack (see §9.3, Defence). The character blocks or resists (see §9.4), attempts to *dodge* (see §9.5), or attempts to *parry* where a parry is allowed (see §15.6, Defence).

A dodge or a parry is rolled against the dodge difficulty of the behaviour card that bears the attack icon. A character who dodges is not hit: the character suffers no damage, is not pushed, and receives no condition token (see §8.1). The movement that follows the dodge ignores arcs (see §15.6, Defence).

EXAMPLE The boss's current behaviour card shows range 1, dodge difficulty 2, and an area attack with attack value 5 and physical damage. Its arc diagram shows the front arc and the right arc as attack arcs. The Knight stands on the node the boss faces. The Assassin stands on an *adjacent node* on the line between the right arc and the back arc. The Herald stands two nodes from the boss, in the front arc. The Knight and the Assassin are targeted; the Herald is out of range and is not attacked. The Knight blocks with a *defence total* of 3 and suffers two damage. The Assassin pays one stamina and rolls two dodge dice, which show two dodge icons. Two equals the dodge difficulty, so the Assassin is not hit and moves to an adjacent node.

16.4 Boss Aggro

The *aggro token* marks the character whom a *boss*'s *behaviour cards target* with the skull icon (see §16.2; §16.3). When a boss *encounter* is set up, the token is placed on the character with the highest *threat* (see §15.2).

In a boss encounter the aggro token does not move at the end of a *round* as it does in other encounters (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order). At the end of each character's *turn*, if that character inflicted damage on the boss during the turn, the aggro token moves to that character. If the character inflicted no damage on the boss, the token stays with its holder.

A character inflicts damage on a boss when an attack lowers the boss's *health dial* by one or more. An attack that the boss's *block* or *resist* reduces to no damage does not move the token.

A *riposte* is made during the boss's turn (see §9.6). If a riposte inflicts damage on the boss, the aggro token moves

to the character who made it at the end of that boss turn, after the behaviour card has been resolved. If more than one character ripostes in the same boss turn, the token moves to the last of them to inflict damage.

When the character who holds the aggro token dies, the token moves at once to the living character with the highest threat (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order). A *summon* does not hold the aggro token, and damage inflicted by a summon does not move it (see §12.1).

> EXAMPLE The Knight holds the aggro token. The Herald attacks the boss and inflicts two damage, and at the end of the Herald's turn the token moves to the Herald. The boss takes its turn and attacks the Herald. The Assassin then attacks the boss, and the boss's block reduces the attack to no damage. The token stays with the Herald.

16.5 Boss Death

A *boss* is defeated when its *health dial* is reduced to zero (see §15.4). The boss *encounter* ends at once. The boss model is removed from the tile, and no further icon of its *behaviour card* is resolved.

A boss fought with two models, and the *Twin Gargoyles*, are defeated as their own rules state (see §17.1).

If the defeated boss is the *final boss*, the players win the game (see §7.1), and the numbered steps of this section are not carried out. If player versus player (PvP) encounters are in play, a last *PvP encounter* is then fought (see §20.1).

When any other boss is defeated, its defeat is resolved as follows.

1. Award each character, including each character who died in the encounter, the boss soul reward (see §7.6).
2. Shuffle the boss's *boss treasure* cards, draw one at random, and award it to the party (see §7.7).
3. Return the boss's other treasure cards to the game box.
4. Place an *ember token* in the ember slot of every character's dashboard, including each character who died in the encounter. Every character is *embered*, and no *ember card* is discarded (see §7.3).
5. Remove every *damage cube* and every *hollow cube* from each living character, as for any embering (see §7.3).
6. If PvP encounters are in play, fight a PvP encounter on the tile on which the boss was defeated (see §20.1).
7. Carry out the setup that follows the boss: the setup after the *mini-boss* (see §6.6) or, when a *mega-boss* is in play, the setup after the *main-boss* (see §6.7).

The setup of step 7 adds one *spark* to the spark dial. This is the spark that each defeated boss grants (see §7.4). The setup ends with the characters on the *bonfire* tile, where they rest without spending a spark (see §11.2) and may visit the *Firekeeper* (see §11.3) and Blacksmith Andre (see §11.4).

The spark is gained once and the rest is taken once for each defeated boss, whether or not a PvP encounter is fought (see §20.9). The recovery that follows a *cleared* encounter is not carried out after a boss (see §7.5, Encounter Recovery). A character who died in the boss encounter stays out of play until the rest, which restores every character (see §11.2).

The embering of step 4 provokes no *invasion* at that moment (see §12.2). In campaign play the spark, the rest, and the setup that follow a boss differ (see §18.1; §18.3).

> EXAMPLE The Knight, the Herald, and the Assassin defeat the mini-boss, and the Assassin died during the encounter. Each of the three characters gains the boss soul reward. One of the mini-boss's treasure cards is drawn at random, and the players give it to the Herald. All three characters receive an ember token, and the Knight removes four damage cubes. No PvP encounter is in play, so the party carries out the setup after the mini-boss. The spark dial, which shows two, is turned to three. The characters rest at the bonfire without spending a spark, and the rest restores the Assassin.



BLACK DRAGON KALAMEET GAME BOARD



EXECUTIONER'S CHARIOT GAME BOARD



EXECUTIONER'S CHARIOT GAME BOARD, SECOND SIDE

CHAPTER 17

17 Boss Special Rules



No two bosses fight alike. One hunts as a pair, one brings the pillars down upon its prey, one burns the ground from the air, and one cannot be wounded while its servants stand. This chapter sets out, boss by boss, what each adds to the boss encounter.

17.1 Rules Common to Several Bosses

Every *boss* is played from its *data card* and the general boss rules (see §15 and §16). The special ability printed on the data card applies throughout the boss's *encounter* (see §15.4). This chapter states the further rules that particular bosses require. A boss with no entry in this chapter has no rules beyond its data card.

Where a rule in this chapter and a data card disagree, the rule in this chapter governs. Each entry states, where the boss has them, its components, its setup, its special ability, its *heat-up*, and its unique icons.

Zero Dodge Difficulty

Some *behaviour cards* show a *dodge difficulty* of 0. A character targeted by an attack on such a card may pay one stamina to *dodge* it without rolling, and the dodge succeeds even if the character has no dodge dice. The character then moves to an *adjacent node* as after any successful dodge (see §9.5). A character whose equipment states that the character cannot dodge may not dodge the attack.

The character may instead *block* or *resist* the attack and pay no stamina (see §9.4).

Two Boss Models in One Encounter

Some bosses are fought with more than one model. The rules under this heading apply whenever two or more boss models stand on separate *nodes* in one encounter. The two models of the Executioner's Chariot share one node and act as a single model (see §17.9).

Each boss model is placed at the start of the encounter on the node that the boss's entry names. Each boss model has its own four *boss arcs* (see §15.6). A character who shares a node with a boss model is placed in the arcs of that model.

A node holds at most one boss model (see §5.3). When a boss model moves onto a node that holds another boss model, the model already on the node is *pushed* to a *valid node* chosen by the players and keeps its facing (see §8.4). Characters on either node are placed in the arcs of the boss model that now shares their node, as when a boss moves onto a character's node (see §16.2). No character's movement or attack pushes a boss model (see §8.4).

When two models are one boss, as the models of Ornstein & Smough are (see §17.2), they share one data card, one *health dial*, and one *behaviour deck*, and the boss has one heat-up. A character who attacks either model attacks the boss: the attack is resolved against the block and resist values on the data card, and its damage is recorded on the shared health dial. A *condition* token gained by either model is placed beside the health dial and affects the boss, whichever model acts. Both models stay on the tile until the boss is defeated (see §16.5).

Such a boss takes one *turn* after each character's turn, as any boss does (see §16.1). Each behaviour card names the model that acts. Only the named model resolves the card: its movement, its facing, the *range* of its attack, its attack arcs, and the direction of any push are all taken from that model. The other model does not act in that turn.

The *weak arcs* shown on the most recently resolved behaviour card apply to both models. A character gains the weak-arc bonus (see §15.6) when attacking either model from an arc of that model that the card shows as weak.

Twin Gargoyles

Twin Gargoyles. The boss encounter set by a campaign *section* that lists the Gargoyle as fought twice (see §19).

The Twin Gargoyles are one *mini-boss* encounter in two parts, fought on the mini-boss tile against one Gargoyle and then, at once, against a second. The one Gargoyle model, data card, health dial, and set of behaviour cards serve for both parts. In the standard game the Gargoyle is selected once and is fought once.

When the first Gargoyle's health dial reaches zero, the encounter does not end, and Boss Death is not resolved (see §16.5).

1. Remove the Gargoyle model from the tile and place it on the mini-boss *spawn node*, facing as at the start of a boss encounter (see §15.2).
2. Place any character on that node on the model's base, in an arc chosen by that character's player.
3. Set the health dial to the Gargoyle's starting health.
4. Gather all of the Gargoyle's behaviour cards and build a new behaviour deck (see §15.5).
5. Continue the encounter in the same turn order (see §16.1).

The second Gargoyle takes its first turn after the turn of the character who defeated the first. Nothing else changes between the two parts. Each character stays on their node

and keeps their *damage cubes*, *stamina cubes*, condition tokens, and used tokens. A character who died stays dead, a *summon* in play stays in play, and the *aggro token* stays with its holder.

The characters do not rest at the *bonfire* between the two parts, and no *souls*, no treasure, and no *spark* are awarded. The second Gargoyle heats up at its own heat-up point 12, as any boss does (see §15.5). When its health dial reaches zero, the boss is defeated and Boss Death is resolved once (see §16.5).

The soul reward, one Gargoyle *boss treasure* card, and one spark are awarded, every character becomes *embered*, and the characters rest at the bonfire, at that time and not before. If player versus player (PvP) encounters are in play, the *PvP encounter* follows the second Gargoyle's defeat (see §20.1).

If the encounter is *failed* while either Gargoyle is in play, the whole encounter is failed and is resolved as any failed boss encounter (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution; §15.2). A first Gargoyle defeated before the failure earns no reward. When the characters next enter the encounter, both Gargoyles are fought again: the first is placed with its health dial at its starting health and a newly built behaviour deck, and the second follows as this heading describes.

> EXAMPLE The Knight and the Herald fight the Twin Gargoyles. The Knight defeats the first Gargoyle while holding four damage cubes. The Gargoyle model returns to the mini-boss spawn node, its health dial is set to its starting health, and a new behaviour deck is built. The Knight still holds four damage cubes, and no reward is given. The second Gargoyle then kills the Herald, who is *hollow*, and the encounter is failed. After the characters rest at the bonfire and return, they face the first Gargoyle again at its starting health.

17.2 Core Set

The Gargoyle, the Titanite Demon, the Boreal Outrider Knight, and the Winged Knight each have the rank of *mini-boss*, and the Dancer of the Boreal Valley is a *main-boss*. These five bosses have no rules beyond their *data cards*. A campaign *section* that lists the Gargoyle as fought twice sets the Twin Gargoyles *encounter* (see §17.1, Twin Gargoyles).

Dragonslayer Ornstein and Executioner Smough

Ornstein & Smough is one main-boss fought with two models, Dragonslayer Ornstein and Executioner Smough (see §2.3).

Components. The two models share one data card, one *health dial*, one set of *behaviour cards*, and one set of *boss treasure* cards.

Setup. The joined *boss tiles* of a main-boss encounter show two boss *spawn nodes*: the main-boss spawn node and the mini-boss spawn node (see §15.3). One model is placed on each, as the data card directs. If the data card names no *node* for a model, the players choose which model takes which spawn node. One *behaviour deck* is built for the *boss* (see §15.5), and the health dial is set to the starting health on the data card.

Special ability. The rules for two boss models in one encounter apply in full (see §17.1, Two Boss Models in One Encounter). Each behaviour card names Ornstein or Smough as the model that acts, and the card's attack uses that model's arcs. A character who attacks either model attacks the boss, and the weak-arc bonus is judged against the arcs of the model attacked.

Heat-up. Ornstein & Smough heats up once, when the shared health dial is reduced to or below the *heat-up* point 12 on the data card (see §15.5).

17.3 Asylum Demon and Stray Demon

The Asylum Demon is a *mini-boss* and the Stray Demon is a *mega-boss*; both are supplied by the Asylum Demon expansion (see §2.3). The rules of this section apply to both. The Stray Demon is fought after a *Level 4 encounter*, as any mega-boss is (see §6.7).

Components

- 4x Pillar tokens
- 1x Mega-boss game board, whose mega-boss side shows four pillar nodes

Pillar node. One of the four *terrain nodes* printed on the mega-boss side of the Asylum Demon expansion's *mega-boss game board*, on each of which a *pillar token* is placed.

Setup

At the start of every boss *encounter* fought on the mega-boss side of that game board, one pillar token is placed on each of its four pillar nodes, before the *boss* takes its first *turn*. A *node* that holds a pillar token is closed to every model (see §5.5, Pillars). An encounter fought on a tile without pillar nodes uses no pillar tokens.

Special Ability

The Asylum Demon and the Stray Demon share the special ability Pillar Smasher. When either demon makes a physical *area attack*, that is, a physical attack that shows the area icon, every pillar within the area of the attack is destroyed before the attack is resolved. A pillar is within the area of the attack if its node is within the attack's *range* of the demon and lies in one of the attack arcs marked on the *behaviour card* (see §16.3).

1. Find every pillar token within the area of the attack.
2. For each such pillar token, deal one damage to each character within range 1 of the pillar's node (see §5.4), and give each of those characters a *stagger* token.
3. Remove each such pillar token from the game board.
4. Resolve the area attack, including its *dodges* and its pushes (see §16.3).

The damage of a destroyed pillar is not an attack, and it cannot be *blocked*, *resisted*, or dodged. One attack may destroy several pillars. A character within range 1 of several destroyed pillars suffers one damage for each of them and holds one stagger token (see §8.5, Stagger). A magical attack, or an attack that does not show the area icon, destroys no pillar.

Once a pillar is destroyed, its node is used as a *basic node* for the rest of the encounter (see §5.5, Pillars). When the characters rest at the *bonfire*, every destroyed pillar token is returned to its pillar node.

> EXAMPLE The Stray Demon resolves a behaviour card with a physical area attack whose attack arcs are its front arc and its left arc. Two pillar tokens stand within range in the front arc. The Knight stands on a node adjacent to both pillars, and the Herald on a node adjacent to one of them. The Knight suffers two damage and gains one stagger token; the Herald suffers one damage and gains one stagger token. Both pillar tokens are removed. The area attack is then resolved, and the Knight, who is within range in the front arc, blocks it with one subtracted from the block total for stagger.

UNIQUE ICONS

The *Wind Up* icon appears on behaviour cards of the Asylum Demon and of the Stray Demon. A Wind Up icon printed on any other behaviour card is resolved in the same way.

When a Wind Up icon is resolved, each character may spend one stamina to *move* to an *adjacent node*. Each player decides for their own character. The movement counts as a *Run* (see §10.2), and every rule that applies to a Run applies to it. The characters complete the movement before the next icon on the behaviour card is resolved (see §16.1).

17.4 Darkroot

Great Grey Wolf Sif and Artorias each have the rank of *main-boss*. Several *behaviour cards* of each show a *dodge difficulty* of 0 (see §17.1, Zero Dodge Difficulty).

GREAT GREY WOLF SIF

Special ability. Sif's behaviour cards include the cool-down card Limping Strike, which shows Sif weakened and close to death. The cool-down card is used only as Sif's *data card* directs. Sif has no other rules beyond the data card.

ARTORIAS

Heat-up. Artorias does not heat up as other bosses do (see §15.5). When Artorias's health is reduced to or below its *heat-up* point 12 :

1. Gather the *behaviour deck* and its discard pile.
2. Remove two of the gathered cards at random and return them to the game box.
3. Add all three of Artorias's *heat-up cards* to the gathered cards.
4. Shuffle the cards to form the new behaviour deck.

17.5 Iron Keep

The Smelter Demon and Sir Alonne each have the rank of *main-boss*. Sir Alonne has no rules beyond its *data card*.

SMELTER DEMON

Heat-up. The Smelter Demon does not heat up as other bosses do (see §15.5). When the Smelter Demon's health is reduced to or below its *heat-up* point 12 :

1. Return the *behaviour deck* and its discard pile to the game box.
2. Shuffle the Smelter Demon's *heat-up cards* and draw five.
3. Place the five drawn cards face down as the new behaviour deck.
4. Return the undrawn heat-up cards to the game box.

17.6 Explorers

OLD DRAGONSLAYER

The Old Dragonslayer is a *mini-boss*.

Components. The Old Dragonslayer uses the Dragonslayer Ornstein model of the core set, with its own *data card*, *health dial*, eight *behaviour cards*, and two *boss treasure* cards.

Special ability. The Old Dragonslayer's special ability is Corrupted Dragonslayer. The first three times the Old Dragonslayer loses four or more health to a single attack, one of its *heat-up cards*, chosen at random, is placed face down on top of its *behaviour deck*. The deck is not shuffled, and the card is the next one the Old Dragonslayer draws (see §16.1).

PURSUER

The Pursuer is a *main-boss*. Several of its behaviour cards show a *dodge difficulty* of 0 (see §17.1, Zero Dodge Difficulty).

Special ability. The Pursuer's special ability is Ceaseless Pursuit. On each of its *turns* the Pursuer draws and resolves two behaviour cards, one after the other. If the behaviour deck is empty when either card is due, the deck is renewed before that card is drawn (see §16.1). The *weak arcs* that apply to character attacks are those of the second card, the card most recently resolved (see §15.6).

Heat-up. When the Pursuer's health is reduced to or below its *heat-up* point 12 , one random heat-up card is shuffled into its behaviour deck, as for any *boss* (see §15.5). From that moment until the *encounter* ends, the *attack value* of every attack on the Pursuer's behaviour cards is increased by one.

Hungry Mimic and Voracious Mimic

The Hungry *Mimic* and the Voracious Mimic are fought as mini-boss encounters when a *chest* proves to be a mimic. Their rules, including their lack of arcs, their heat-up, and their treasure, are stated with the mimic rules (see §13).

17.7 Tomb of Giants

The Black Knight is a *mini-boss* and Gravelord Nito is a *main-boss*. Both are played with the replacement *data cards* and *behaviour cards* listed in the card amendments (see Appendix B). Neither has rules beyond its data card.

17.8 Black Dragon Kalameet

Black Dragon Kalameet is a *mega-boss*. The *Level 4 encounter* that precedes it and the placing of its *mega-boss game board* are stated with the setup rules (see §6.7). The campaign *section* that ends with Kalameet is set out with the campaigns (see §19.1).

Components

- 1x Black Dragon Kalameet model
- 1x Data card
- 1x Health dial
- 13x Behaviour cards: 10 standard cards, 2 signature cards (Mark of Calamity and Hellfire Blast), and 1 heat-up card (Hellfire Barrage)
- 8x Strafe cards
- 4x Calamity tokens
- 2x Mega-boss treasure cards
- 4x Level 4 encounter cards
- 1x Mega-boss game board

Signature card. One of Kalameet's two *behaviour cards*, Mark of Calamity and Hellfire Blast, that are included in every *behaviour deck* built for Kalameet.

Setup

The mega-boss *encounter* is set up as any mega-boss encounter (see §6.7), with the following differences. Kalameet's behaviour deck is built by this procedure in place of the general one (see §15.5).

1. Place Kalameet's model on the mega-boss *spawn node* with its front arc facing the centre of the game board.
2. Set aside the *heat-up card*, Hellfire Barrage.
3. Shuffle the 10 standard behaviour cards and draw four.
4. Return the six undrawn standard cards to the game box.
5. Add the two *signature cards* to the four drawn cards, and shuffle the six cards to form the behaviour deck.
6. Shuffle the eight *strafe cards* and place them face down beside the behaviour deck as the strafe deck.

Special Ability

Kalameet's special ability is Calamity & Ruin. Every behaviour deck built for Kalameet includes both signature cards, Mark of Calamity and Hellfire Blast.

Heat-up

Kalameet has one heat-up card, Hellfire Barrage. When Kalameet's health is reduced to or below its *heat-up* point 124, Hellfire Barrage is shuffled into the behaviour deck as the general rule directs (see §15.5).

Unique Icons

Kalameet's behaviour cards show two icons of their own: the calamity icon and the strafe icon.
An attack that shows the calamity icon inflicts the *calamity condition*. Each character *hit* by the attack gains one calamity token (see §8.5, Calamity).

The strafe icon marks a strafe attack. A strafe attack is a magical attack ✧ that targets the characters on particular *nodes*, in place of the characters within an arc and a *range*.

Strafe card. A card that shows the nodes a strafe attack targets and the landing node on which Kalameet's model is placed afterwards.

When a strafe icon is resolved:

1. If the strafe deck is empty, turn its discard pile face down without shuffling to form the new strafe deck.
2. Remove Kalameet's model from the game board. Every other model stays on its node.
3. Reveal the top card of the strafe deck.
4. Resolve the attack against every character on a node that the strafe card shows as targeted.
5. Discard the strafe card.
6. Place Kalameet's model on the landing node shown on the strafe card, facing as it faced before it was removed.
7. *Push* each character on the landing node to an *adjacent node* chosen by that character's player (see §8.4).

The strafe attack uses the *attack value* and the *dodge difficulty* of the behaviour card that shows the strafe icon. Each targeted character *resists* or *dodges* the attack separately (see §9.4; §9.5).

> EXAMPLE Kalameet resolves a behaviour card that shows the strafe icon. Kalameet's model is removed from the game board, and the top strafe card is revealed. The Knight stands on a targeted node and resists the attack. The Herald stands on the landing node, which the card does not show as targeted, and is not attacked. The strafe card is discarded, Kalameet's model is placed on the landing node, and the Herald is pushed to an adjacent node chosen by the Herald's player.

17.9 Executioner's Chariot

The Executioner's Chariot is a *mega-boss* fought in two parts. Before its *heat-up* it follows a fixed pattern and cannot be damaged; after its heat-up it is fought as any *boss*. The *Level 4 encounter* that precedes it and the placing of its *mega-boss game board* are stated with the setup rules (see

§6.7). The campaign that includes the Chariot is The Undead Colosseum (see §19.9).

Components

- 2x Executioner's Chariot models: the skeletal horse and the chariot
- 1x Data card, double-sided, with the Executioner's Chariot on the front and the Skeletal Horse on the heat-up side
- 1x Health dial
- 4x Track behaviour cards, named Death Race and numbered 1 to 4
- 9x Standard behaviour cards
- 3x Heat-up cards
- 1x Mega-boss setup card
- 2x Mega-boss treasure cards
- 2x Black Hollow Mage and 4x Falchion Skeleton models, with their two enemy data cards
- 4x Level 4 encounter cards and 6x encounter cards of Levels 1 to 3
- 1x Mega-boss game board

Mega-boss setup card. The card that shows the enemy *spawn nodes* on which the Black Hollow Mages and the Falchion Skeletons are placed at the start of the mega-boss *encounter*.

The two models are one boss. Until the heat-up they share one *node*, *move* together, and count as one boss model for the *node model limit* (see §5.3).

The centre of the Chariot's game board is a wall, not a node. Nodes on opposite sides of the centre are not adjacent, and *range* is counted around it (see §5.1; §5.4). No model may move, *dodge*, or be *pushed* into the centre.

Setup

The mega-boss encounter is set up as any mega-boss encounter (see §6.7), with the following differences. Two decks are built in place of the general *behaviour deck* (see §15.5).

1. Place the *data card* with its front side face up.
2. Place both Chariot models together on the mega-boss spawn node.
3. Place the two Black Hollow Mages and the four Falchion Skeletons on the enemy spawn nodes shown on the *mega-boss setup card*.
4. Stack the four *track behaviour cards* face down in numerical order, with the card numbered 1 on top and the card numbered 4 at the bottom, to form the track deck. Do not shuffle it.
5. Shuffle the nine standard behaviour cards and draw four.
6. Shuffle the three *heat-up cards* and draw one.
7. Shuffle the five drawn cards together and set them aside face down as the heat-up deck.
8. Return the undrawn behaviour cards to the game box.

The Black Hollow Mages and the Falchion Skeletons are enemies, not bosses. They use their own data cards and are scaled for the number of characters (see §8.3). The *health dial* is not used until the heat-up.

Special Ability

The front side of the data card shows the special ability Crash and shows no starting health 24, no *block* value, and no *resist* value. Until the Chariot heats up, it cannot be attacked or damaged, and no attack or effect of a character affects it. Crash is the Chariot's heat-up (see §17.9, Heat-Up).

Until the heat-up, each boss *turn* of the encounter (see §16.1) is taken by every enemy model on the game board. The Chariot, each Black Hollow Mage, and each Falchion Skeleton take one turn each in descending *threat* order, with ties settled as in any encounter (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order). One character then takes a turn, and the enemy models take their turns again. The Black Hollow Mages and the Falchion Skeletons act as their data cards direct (see §9.1).

Track behaviour card. One of the four behaviour cards, named Death Race and numbered 1 to 4, that direct the Chariot's turns in fixed order until it heats up. Each card shows the node to which the Chariot moves and the nodes that its attack targets.

On each of its turns before the heat-up, the Chariot resolves one track behaviour card:

1. If the track deck is empty, turn its discard pile face down without shuffling to form the new track deck.
2. Reveal the top card of the track deck.
3. Move both Chariot models together to the node shown on the card.
4. Turn both models so that their front arc faces directly away from the node they left.
5. Resolve the card's physical attack against every character on a node that the card shows as targeted.
6. Push each character *hit* by the attack to an *adjacent node* that the card does not show as targeted. The players choose the node.
7. Push each enemy model on a targeted node to an adjacent node that the card does not show as targeted. The players choose the node.
8. Discard the card.

The attack of a track behaviour card targets nodes in place of arcs and range, and the targeted nodes include the node the Chariot left and the node it entered. Each targeted character blocks or dodges the attack separately, using the *attack value* and the *dodge difficulty* on the card (see §9.4; §9.5). Enemy models pushed in step 7 suffer no damage. A model with no untargeted adjacent node to enter stays on its node (see §5.2).

The track deck is not shuffled at any time. The four cards are resolved in numerical order, and the card numbered 1 follows the card numbered 4.

HEAT-UP

The Chariot's heat-up is Chariot Crash. The Chariot does not heat up at a heat-up point 12 (see §15.5). It heats up at once when no Black Hollow Mage and no Falchion Skeleton remains on the game board.

1. Remove the chariot model from the game board. The skeletal horse stays on its node and keeps its facing.
2. Flip the data card to its heat-up side, the Skeletal Horse.
3. Set the health dial to the starting health shown on the heat-up side.
4. Return the track behaviour cards to the game box.
5. Place the heat-up deck built at setup face down beside the game board as the behaviour deck.

From the heat-up, the encounter continues as any boss encounter against the skeletal horse (see §16.1). The skeletal horse and the characters alternate turns, the skeletal horse draws from its behaviour deck, and attacks against it are resolved against the block and resist values on the heat-up side. The skeletal horse does not heat up again. The boss is defeated when the health dial reaches zero (see §16.5).

The heat-up side shows the special ability Crush. When a character's block or resist roll reduces the damage of an attack on one of the skeletal horse's behaviour cards to zero, that character suffers one damage. Crush does not apply to an attack that the character dodges.

UNIQUE ICONS

The Raise Skeleton icon appears on the Black Hollow Mage's data card. It is resolved in the same way in every encounter that contains a Black Hollow Mage.

When a Black Hollow Mage resolves the Raise Skeleton icon, the players count the enemy models on the tile whose names include the word "Skeleton". If fewer are on the tile than at the start of the encounter, the players choose one such enemy killed during the encounter and place its model, with no *wound tokens*, on the enemy spawn node nearest to that Black Hollow Mage. If two or more enemy spawn nodes are equally near, the players choose among them. If the count is not lower than at the start of the encounter, the icon has no effect.

> EXAMPLE The Knight kills the fourth Falchion Skeleton while one Black Hollow Mage remains, and the Chariot does not heat up. On its turn the Black Hollow Mage resolves the Raise Skeleton icon. No Falchion Skeleton is on the game board and four were there at the start, so the players place one Falchion Skeleton, with no wound tokens, on the enemy spawn node nearest to the Black Hollow Mage. The Warrior kills the Black Hollow Mage, and the Knight kills the returned Falchion Skeleton. No Black Hollow Mage and no Falchion Skeleton remains, and the Chariot heats up at once.

17.10 Bosses of Other Expansions

The Four Kings (mega-boss, The Four Kings expansion). The Four Kings is played from its *data card* and the general boss rules (see §15 and §16). Apply the special rules supplied with that expansion. The Four Kings is fought with several boss models (see §17.1, Two Boss Models in One Encounter).

Gaping Dragon (mega-boss, Gaping Dragon expansion). The Gaping Dragon is played from its data card and the general boss rules (see §15 and §16). Apply the special rules supplied with that expansion. The Gaping Dragon's attacks inflict the *corrosion condition* (see §8.5, Corrosion).

Guardian Dragon (mega-boss, Guardian Dragon expansion). The Guardian Dragon is played from its data card and the general boss rules (see §15 and §16). Apply the special rules supplied with that expansion.

The Last Giant (mega-boss, The Last Giant expansion). The Last Giant is played from its data card and the general boss rules (see §15 and §16). Apply the special rules supplied with that expansion.

Manus, Father of the Abyss (mega-boss, Manus, Father of the Abyss expansion). Manus, Father of the Abyss is played from its data card and the general boss rules (see §15 and §16). Apply the special rules supplied with that expansion.

Old Iron King (mega-boss, Old Iron King expansion). The Old Iron King is played from its data card and the general boss rules (see §15 and §16). Apply the special rules supplied with that expansion.

Vordt of the Boreal Valley (mega-boss, Vordt of the Boreal Valley expansion). Vordt of the Boreal Valley is played from its data card and the general boss rules (see §15 and §16). Apply the special rules supplied with that expansion. Vordt's attacks inflict the *frostbite* condition (see §8.5, Frostbite).

Crossbreed Priscilla (main-boss, Painted World of Ariamis expansion). Crossbreed Priscilla is played from its data card and the general boss rules (see §15 and §16). Apply the special rules supplied with that expansion. Its data card and *behaviour cards* are the replacement cards listed in the card amendments (see Appendix B).

Heavy Knight (mini-boss, Painted World of Ariamis expansion). The Heavy Knight is played from its data card and the general boss rules (see §15 and §16). Apply the special rules supplied with that expansion. Its data card and behaviour cards are the replacement cards listed in the card amendments (see Appendix B).

CHAPTER 18

18 Campaign Play



A campaign is a long road between many fires. The party carries its souls, its equipment, and its scars from one section to the next, and each bonfire it reaches lies deeper in the dark than the last.

18.1 Setup

Campaign play follows the standard game except as this chapter states. Where a *campaign* states a rule of its own, that rule takes precedence over this chapter (see §19).

Campaign. A game played through a fixed list of *sections*, taken in order, in which the characters keep what they have gained from one section to the next.

Section. One list of tiles within a campaign: a *bonfire* tile, a number of encounter tiles with their *encounter levels*, and the bosses to be faced.

The party chooses one of the 12 campaigns (see §19). Two of them, The First Journey and The Coiled Sword, require only the core set (see §19.1, §19.2). Each of the other campaigns states the expansions it requires. A campaign has three to six sections, and each section lists its tiles in order outward from the bonfire tile.

Each character keeps their *stat tiers*, *treasure cards*, *souls*, and tokens from one section to the next. Death and hollowing follow the standard game in every *encounter* of a campaign, including every *mega-boss* encounter (see §7.2).

Campaign Setup

At the start of a campaign the party carries out the setup of the standard game (see §6), with the following changes.

- The party does not select bosses, and random boss selection is not used (see §6.5, Boss Selection). The bosses are those the campaign lists.
- *Legendary treasure* cards are set aside and enter neither treasure deck at any time (see §18.8).
- The spark dial is set as in the standard game, and its maximum is fixed at the same time (see §18.3).
- The tiles, *encounter cards*, and treasure cards are laid out for the campaign's first section, in place of the encounter setup of the standard game (see §18.1, Section Setup).
- The optional rules of the standard game are chosen during setup (see §6.5, Optional Rules), with one exception. A mega-boss is not chosen as an optional rule and is faced only where the campaign lists one.

Section Setup

The first section is set up at the start of the campaign. Every other section is set up when the section before it is completed, by the setup that follows the *mini-boss* in the standard game (see §6.6). In both cases the section's list takes the place of the standard route, as follows.

- As many encounter tiles as the section lists encounters are drawn at random from all of the encounter tiles, in place of the four of the standard game. Each is placed with either side face up, as the party chooses.
- The bonfire tile, the encounter tiles, and the tile of each boss are arranged as a single route in the order the section lists them (see §6.5, Encounter Tiles).
- Each encounter tile is dealt one encounter card of the level the section lists for its position, in place of the levels printed on a boss's data card. Where the section names an encounter, that encounter card is placed face down on the tile in place of a dealt card.
- The encounter decks are built from the sets the campaign names, in place of the set that supplies the next boss (see §6.5, Expansion Encounters).
- Each encounter tile is dealt one treasure card per character from the treasure deck of the current tier (see §18.5).
- A mini-boss is fought on the mini-boss tile, and a *main-boss* on the two *boss tiles* joined as one (see §15.3). A mega-boss is fought on its game board (see §18.1, Level 4 Encounters and Mega-Bosses).
- A section that lists the Gargoyle as fought twice sets the Twin Gargoyles encounter, which is one boss encounter (see §17.1, Twin Gargoyles).
- The *fog gate* token is placed on the *doorway* to the boss's tile (see §18.2). A section that lists no boss has no fog gate.
- The *shop* is restocked as campaign play directs (see §18.6, Blacksmith Andre's Shop), and no *spark* is added during the setup of a section (see §18.3).
- If *invaders* are in play, no more than one invasion is provoked in each section (see §12.2).

Section Completion

A section is completed when the last *boss* it lists is defeated (see §16.5). A section whose list ends in an encounter instead of a boss is completed when that encounter is *cleared* for the first time (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution).

When a section is completed by the defeat of a boss, the boss's defeat is resolved as in the standard game (see §16.5), with two changes. The party gains its spark at once, up to the dial's maximum (see §18.3). The setup that follows the boss is the setup of the next section (see §18.1, Section Setup), and the characters then rest at the bonfire without spending a spark.

When a section is completed by clearing an encounter, the encounter is resolved as any cleared encounter (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution). The party then sets up the next section, and the characters rest at the bonfire without spending a spark. No spark is gained (see §18.3).

When the last section of the campaign is completed, the campaign ends, and no setup and no rest follow (see §18.1, The Final Boss).

When a boss is defeated and its section is not yet completed, the party gains the boss's rewards and its spark (see §16.5, §18.3). Each character who died in the boss encounter is revived as after any cleared encounter, except that the ember token of the boss's defeat keeps that character from becoming *hollow*, so no hollow cube is placed (see §7.5, Encounter Recovery; §16.5). The exploration then continues. No section is set up, the shop is not restocked, and no rest is granted.

Level 4 Encounters and Mega-Bosses

A *Level 4 encounter* listed in a section is fought on the Level 4 encounter side of a *mega-boss game board*. The game board takes the place of an encounter tile at that position in the section's route. The game board and the Level 4 encounter cards are those of the mega-boss the section lists. If the section lists no mega-boss, they are those of a mega-boss expansion the campaign requires.

The Level 4 encounter is set up, fought, and rewarded as in the standard game (see §6.7, Level 4 Encounters), with the soul reward of the standard game (see §18.5). Where the section names the Level 4 encounter, that encounter card is used. A cleared Level 4 encounter is not fought again and is not counted as a skipped encounter when the party next travels the route (see §7.5, Encounter Start).

When a section lists two Level 4 encounters, both are fought on the same game board, one after the other. When the first is cleared, the party removes every token, model, and card from the game board and sets up the second Level 4 encounter on it.

A mega-boss listed in a section is fought on the mega-boss side of its game board, which is set up when the section's last Level 4 encounter is cleared (see §6.7, The Mega-Boss Encounter). The game board keeps its place in the route. A mega-boss that is not the campaign's *final boss* is fought under the same rules as any other boss. Its defeat grants the rewards of a boss (see §16.5) and does not end the campaign, which continues with the next section.

The Final Boss

The campaign's final boss is the last boss listed in its last section. The players win the campaign when the final boss is defeated (see §7.1). A campaign whose last section ends in an encounter has no final boss, and the players win it when that encounter is cleared. The players lose a campaign as they lose the standard game (see §7.1, §18.3).

Player Versus Player Encounters

Player versus player (PvP) encounters remain an optional rule in campaign play (see §20.1). When they are in play, a *PvP encounter* follows the defeat of each boss, as in the standard game. The PvP encounter that follows the campaign's final boss decides the *ultimate victor* (see §20.8).

When the boss's defeat completes a section, the setup and the rest that follow the PvP encounter are those of the completed section (see §18.1, Section Completion; §20.9). When the boss's defeat does not complete its section, no rest follows the PvP encounter. Every character who took part is instead restored as at the start of the PvP encounter (see §20.1), each character who died in it returns to the tile, and the exploration continues.

18.2 The Fog Gate

In campaign play the *fog gate* token marks the *doorway* through which the characters enter a *boss encounter* and has no other effect. It is placed during the setup of a *section* on the doorway to the boss's tile, as in the standard game (see §15.1). The boss encounter begins when the characters pass through it (see §15.2).

The token is not moved to the *bonfire* tile when the characters first pass through it, and it gives no shortcut. After every rest the party travels the route from the first encounter tile, and each encounter on the route is fought or skipped (see §7.5, Encounter Start).

An *embered* character may call a *summon* at the fog gate, as in the standard game (see §12.1).

18.3 Sparks

The *spark* dial is set at the start of a *campaign* to six minus the number of characters, as in the standard game (see §6.4, §7.4). The dial's maximum is that starting value plus one. The dial cannot be turned past its maximum, and a spark gained while the dial shows its maximum is not added.

Characters	Starting Sparks	Maximum Sparks
1	5	6
2	4	5
3	3	4
4	2	3

Each time a *mini-boss*, *main-boss*, or *mega-boss* is defeated, the party gains one spark, up to the maximum (see §16.5). The Twin Gargoyles are one boss and grant one spark (see §17.1, Twin Gargoyles). Clearing an *encounter* grants no spark, even when it completes a *section*. The spark for a boss is added when the boss is defeated, and the setup of the next section adds no other.

A rest at the *bonfire* costs one spark, as in the standard game (see §11.2). A rest is free only when it follows the completion of a section (see §18.1, Section Completion). The defeat of a boss that does not complete its section grants a spark but no free rest.

While the party rests, it may buy back one spark. Every character pays four *souls* of their own to the supply, and the spark dial is turned up by one. If any character holds fewer than four souls, the party cannot buy the spark, because souls cannot be transferred or pooled (see §7.6).

The party may buy no more than one spark during each rest and cannot buy a spark while the dial shows its maximum. The spark is bought after the rest's own spark has been spent, and it may be bought during a free rest. Sparks are gained in no other way, except when a player leaves the campaign (see §18.4).

If the characters are required to rest while the spark dial shows zero, the players lose the campaign (see §7.1). The party cannot rest while the dial shows zero, so no spark is bought to prevent that loss.

> Example The Knight, the Herald, and the Assassin begin a campaign with the spark dial at three, and its maximum is four. The party has rested once, and the dial shows two. After clearing the second encounter of the first section, the party returns to the bonfire tile and rests again, and the dial is turned down to one. The Knight holds six souls, the Herald four, and the Assassin five. Each of them pays four souls, and the dial is turned up to two. The Knight is left with two souls, the Herald with none, and the Assassin with one.

18.4 Adding and Dropping Players

A player may join or leave a *campaign* in progress. Either change is made only while the characters are on the *bonfire* tile and no *encounter* is in progress. A player joins or leaves a standard game in progress under the same rules. The party has no more than four characters (see §1).

The party spends one *spark* for each player who joins. A player may join only while the spark dial shows two or more. When a player joins, the party carries out the following steps.

1. Turn the spark dial down by one.
2. Set up the new character as at the start of the game, with *starting equipment*, every stat at the base tier, and no *souls* (see §6.1).
3. Place the new character's model on the bonfire tile.
4. Set the spark dial's maximum for the new number of characters (see §18.3).
5. If the spark dial shows more than the new maximum, turn it down to the new maximum.
6. Deal one *treasure card* of the current tier face down to each encounter tile that still holds its treasure cards (see §18.5).

The party gains one spark when a player leaves. When a player leaves, the party carries out the following steps.

1. Give every treasure card the departing character holds to the remaining characters, as the players choose. Each card is placed in the *inventory* of the character who receives it.
2. Return the departing character's souls, and any *dropped souls* of that character still on a tile, to the supply.
3. Return the departing character's model, dashboard, and tokens to the game box.
4. Set the spark dial's maximum for the new number of characters (see §18.3).
5. Turn the spark dial up by one, unless it shows the new maximum.
6. Remove one treasure card at random from each encounter tile that still holds its treasure cards, and place it on the bottom of the treasure deck of its tier.

From the moment a player joins or leaves, the new number of characters is used for enemy scaling (see §8.3), for the spark dial's maximum, and for every cost and reward counted per character. No *ember card* is added to the *shop* when a player joins (see §18.6, Blacksmith Andre's Shop).

> Example The Knight, the Herald, and the Assassin stand on the bonfire tile with the spark dial at three. The Warrior's player joins the campaign. The party turns the dial down to two and sets up the Warrior with starting equipment and no souls. The campaign now has four characters, so the dial's maximum falls from four to three, and every enemy placed from then on is scaled for four characters.

18.5 Encounter Rewards

Encounters are rewarded as in the standard game (see §7.6, §7.7). The *souls* awarded are those of the standard reward table: the full reward and the *reduced reward* for each *encounter level*, and the rewards for *invaders* and bosses, are not changed in campaign play (see §7.6).

An encounter already marked *cleared* is skipped or fought again as in the standard game (see §7.5, Encounter Start). Fought again, it awards the reduced reward and no treasure.

The first time an encounter is cleared, each character takes one of the *treasure cards* dealt to its tile, as in the standard game (see §7.7). In campaign play the current tier is tier one from the start of the *campaign* until the *bonfire ascetic* is burnt, whatever bosses have been defeated, and tier two from then on (see §18.7). Every treasure card dealt to an encounter tile or placed beneath a *chest* comes from the treasure deck of the current tier (see §5.5, Chests). Treasure cards already dealt when the bonfire ascetic is burnt are not replaced.

Boss treasure is gained only by defeating bosses (see §16.5). The treasure of a *Level 4 encounter* is that of the standard game (see §6.7, Level 4 Encounters). *Legendary treasure* enters neither treasure deck and is gained only by *transposition* (see §18.8).

18.6 The Bonfire

The *bonfire* rules of the standard game apply in campaign play (see §11), with the changes of this section. While the party rests, it may also buy back a *spark* (see §18.3), burn the *bonfire ascetic* (see §18.7), and transpose *boss treasure* (see §18.8).

Stat Tier Costs

The *Firekeeper* raises stats as in the standard game (see §11.3), at the following costs.

Stat tier bought	Cost in souls
Stat tier one	4
Stat tier two	8
Stat tier three	16
Stat tier four	20

The value of a stat at stat tier four is the same as in the standard game (see §3.3).

Blacksmith Andre's Shop

Blacksmith Andre's *shop* follows the standard game (see §11.4), with the following changes.

The shop is restocked only when a *section* is completed, during the setup of the next section and before the rest that follows (see §18.1, Section Completion). The defeat of a boss that does not complete its section does not restock the shop. Before the shop is restocked, its unsold cards, other than *ember cards*, are placed on the bottom of their treasure decks (see §6.3, Restocking After a Boss). Step 7 of a rest restocks the shop only if a section has been completed and the shop has not been restocked since (see §11.2).

The tier two shop is closed until the bonfire ascetic is burnt, and the defeat of a *mini-boss* does not open it. It is stocked at once when the bonfire ascetic is burnt (see §18.7). From then on it is restocked with the tier one shop each time a section is completed.

No *legendary treasure* card and no boss treasure card enters either treasure deck or either shop. The step of the standard restock that shuffles legendary treasure into the tier two treasure deck is not carried out (see §6.3, Restocking After a Boss). Boss treasure is gained only by defeating bosses (see §16.5), and legendary treasure only by *transposition* (see §18.8).

No ember card is added to the shop after the setup of the campaign, whether a section is completed or a player joins (see §6.3, §18.4).

Shop Price Table

Card or service	Purchase cost in souls	Sell value in souls
Tier one card	2	1
Tier two card	4	1
Boss treasure card	-	4
Legendary treasure card (*transposition*)	4 and one boss treasure card	4
Bonfire ascetic	16, paid by the party	-

A boss treasure card sells for four souls in campaign play, in place of the six of the standard game, and is returned to the game box when sold (see §11.4, Sales). A legendary treasure card sells for four souls and is placed face down on the bottom of the legendary treasure deck (see §18.8). An ember card is priced as a tier one card. Every other price, and every other rule of purchase and sale, is that of the standard game (see §11.4).

18.7 Bonfire Ascetic

In campaign play the defeat of a boss does not open tier two treasure. The party opens it by burning the *bonfire ascetic*.

The party may burn the bonfire ascetic once in a *campaign*, while resting at the *bonfire* (see §11.2). The cost is 16 *souls* in all, paid to the supply by any combination of the characters. This payment is the one exception to the rule that souls cannot be pooled (see §7.6). The bonfire ascetic is not burnt unless the full 16 souls are paid.

When the bonfire ascetic is burnt, the party stocks the tier two *shop* from the tier two treasure deck, in the way the tier one shop is stocked at the start of the game and without *ember cards* (see §6.3, Stocking at the Start of the Game). The tier one shop is not restocked at that time. Both shops are next restocked when a *section* is completed (see §18.6, Blacksmith Andre's Shop).

From the moment the bonfire ascetic is burnt, the current tier is tier two for the rest of the campaign. Every treasure card dealt to an encounter tile or placed beneath a *chest*

from then on comes from the *tier two treasure* deck (see §18.5). Treasure cards already dealt are not replaced.

From the same moment, every enemy that is subject to enemy scaling has its base health increased by two for the rest of the campaign (see §8.3). The increase is cumulative with the health increase for the number of characters. The bonfire ascetic does not change enemy attack values or movement values.

A *boss*, a *mimic*, a *phantom*, and a *crystal lizard* are not affected by the bonfire ascetic (see §8.3).

> EXAMPLE The Knight, the Herald, and the Assassin rest at the bonfire and burn the bonfire ascetic. The Knight pays eight souls, the Herald five, and the Assassin three, 16 in all. In the next encounter the party meets a Hollow Soldier, whose data card shows a base health of 1 and an attack value of 4. Its health is 5: the base health of 1, plus two for the bonfire ascetic, plus two for three characters. Its attack value stays at 4.

18.8 Transposition

Transposition exchanges a *boss treasure* card for a *legendary treasure* card. It is the only source of legendary treasure in campaign play.

Transposition is available after the last boss of the first *section* is defeated. In a *campaign* whose first section ends in an encounter, it is available after that section is completed (see §18.1, Section Completion). From then on a character may transpose during any rest at the *bonfire*, including a rest that costs no *spark* (see §11.2).

When transposition becomes available, the party prepares the legendary treasure cards as follows.

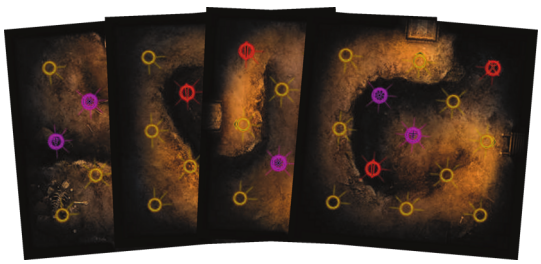
1. Gather every legendary treasure card and shuffle them face down to form the legendary treasure deck.
2. Place the legendary treasure deck beside the bonfire tile.
3. Deal five legendary treasure cards face up beside the bonfire tile.

During a rest, a character transposes as follows.

1. Return one boss treasure card that the character holds to the game box. The card takes no further part in the campaign.
2. Pay four *souls* to the supply.
3. Take any one of the five face-up legendary treasure cards and place it in the character's *inventory*.
4. Deal one card from the legendary treasure deck face up beside the bonfire tile, so that five cards are again face up.

A character may transpose any number of times during one rest. Each transposition requires its own boss treasure card and its own four souls, and the character pays with their own souls (see §7.6). If the legendary treasure deck is empty, step 4 is not carried out, and fewer than five cards remain face up.

A legendary treasure card is equipped and traded as any other treasure card, and it sells for four souls (see §18.6, Shop Price Table). *Transposed treasure* is a kind of tier two treasure card and is not gained by transposition (see §6.2).



ENCOUNTER TILES



CHAPTER 19

19 Campaigns

Twelve roads lead out from the first bonfire. One climbs through the Undead Burg to Anor Londo, another descends into the Abyss, and a third never leaves the arena. This chapter sets out all twelve campaigns, section by section.

Each campaign states the sets it requires and lists the tiles of each *section* in order outward from the *bonfire* tile; a section is laid out and completed as the campaign setup rules state (see §18.1).

19.1 The First Journey

This campaign requires the core set. The party may add the Black Dragon Kalameet expansion to play Section Four.

The encounter decks of Sections One to Three are built only from the *encounter cards* of the core set (see §6.5, Expansion Encounters).

Section One: Undead Burg

1. *Bonfire* tile
2. Level 1 *encounter*
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Gargoyle (*mini-boss*), fought twice (see §17.1)

Section Two: Sen's Fortress

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 1 encounter
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Level 2 encounter
6. Titanite Demon (mini-boss)

Section Three: Anor Londo

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter
3. Level 2 encounter
4. Level 3 encounter
5. Level 3 encounter
6. Level 3 encounter
7. Ornstein & Smough (*main-boss*)

Section Four: Bathed in Flame

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 3 encounter
3. Level 3 encounter
4. *Level 4 encounter*
5. Black Dragon Kalameet (*mega-boss*)

Section Four is an optional rule. It requires the Black Dragon Kalameet expansion. The party decides during setup whether Section Four is in play.

The *mega-boss game board* is placed with its Level 4 encounter side face up and with one of its *doorways* aligned with a doorway of the second Level 3 encounter tile, not with a doorway of the bonfire tile (see §18.1). When the Level 4 encounter is *cleared*, the party flips the game board to its mega-boss side (see §6.7, The Mega-Boss Encounter). A cleared Level 4 encounter does not *reset* when the characters rest at the bonfire (see §6.7, Level 4 Encounters).

The Level 3 encounter decks of Section Four are built from the encounter cards of the core set. If the party owns the Darkroot expansion, they are built from the encounter cards of that expansion instead.

19.2 The Coiled Sword

This campaign requires the core set.

The encounter decks of every *section* are built only from the *encounter cards* of the core set (see §6.5, Expansion Encounters).

Section One: High Wall of Lothric

1. *Bonfire* tile
2. Level 1 *encounter*
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 1 encounter
5. Level 2 encounter
6. Level 2 encounter
7. Winged Knight (*mini-boss*)

Section Two: Undead Settlement

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 1 encounter
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Level 2 encounter
6. Level 3 encounter
7. Boreal Outrider Knight (mini-boss)

SECTION THREE: HIGH WALL OF LOTHRIC

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter
3. Level 2 encounter
4. Level 3 encounter
5. Level 3 encounter
6. Level 3 encounter
7. Dancer of the Boreal Valley (*main-boss*)

19.3 Ambush Lies Ahead

This campaign requires the core set and the Phantoms expansion. The party may add the *encounter cards* of any other expansion.

The party does not place *invader tokens* during this campaign (see §12.2). An *encounter* that lists an *invader* includes that invader the first time the characters enter that encounter, and the invader is fought under the invader rules (see §12.2). Each listed invader appears once in the campaign, whether that encounter is *cleared* or *failed*.

SECTION ONE: UNDEAD BURG

1. *Bonfire* tile
2. Level 1 encounter
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Gargoyle (*mini-boss*), fought twice (see §17.1)

SECTION TWO: SEN'S FORTRESS

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 1 encounter
3. Level 1 encounter with Kirk, Knight of Thorns
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Level 2 encounter with Maneater Mildred
6. Titanite Demon (mini-boss)

SECTION THREE: ANOR LONDO

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter
3. Level 2 encounter with Xanthous King Jeremiah
4. Level 3 encounter
5. Level 3 encounter with Paladin Leeroy
6. Level 3 encounter
7. Ornstein & Smough (*main-boss*)

19.4 The Gauntlet

This campaign requires the core set and the Phantoms expansion. The party may add the *encounter cards* of any other expansion.

The party does not place *invader tokens* during this campaign (see §12.2). An *encounter* that lists an *invader* includes that invader the first time the characters enter that encounter, and the invader is fought under the invader rules (see §12.2). Each listed invader appears once in the campaign, whether that encounter is *cleared* or *failed*.

SECTION ONE: INVADER RUINS

1. *Bonfire* tile
2. Level 1 encounter
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 1 encounter with Melinda the Butcher
5. Level 1 encounter with Maldron the Assassin
6. Level 2 encounter with Kirk, Knight of Thorns

Section One is completed when the Level 2 encounter with Kirk, Knight of Thorns is cleared (see §18.1).

SECTION TWO: INVADER HALL

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter
3. Level 2 encounter with Oliver the Collector
4. Level 2 encounter with Xanthous King Jeremiah
5. Level 3 encounter with Maneater Mildred
6. Level 3 encounter with Fencer Sharron

Section Two is completed when the Level 3 encounter with Fencer Sharron is cleared (see §18.1).

SECTION THREE: INVADER SPIRE

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter with Armorer Dennis
3. Level 2 encounter with Paladin Leeroy
4. Level 3 encounter with Marvelous Chester
5. Level 3 encounter with Invader Brylex
6. Level 3 encounter with Longfinger Kirk

Section Three is completed when the Level 3 encounter with Longfinger Kirk is cleared (see §18.1).

19.5 Facing the Abyss

This campaign requires the core set and the Darkroot expansion. The party may add the Explorers and Characters expansions.

The encounter decks of every *section* are built only from the *encounter cards* of the Darkroot expansion (see §6.5, Expansion Encounters).

SECTION ONE: DARKROOT GARDEN

1. *Bonfire* tile
2. Level 1 *encounter*
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Level 2 encounter
6. Level 3 encounter: Hydra Lake

Section One is completed when Hydra Lake is *cleared* (see §18.1).

SECTION TWO: DARKROOT BASIN

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 1 encounter
3. Level 2 encounter
4. Level 3 encounter
5. Level 3 encounter
6. Great Grey Wolf Sif (*main-boss*)

SECTION THREE: ROYAL WOOD

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter
3. Level 3 encounter
4. Level 3 encounter
5. Level 3 encounter
6. Artorias (main-boss)

19.6 Demon Hunting

This campaign requires the core set and the Asylum Demon expansion. The party may add the Explorers and Characters expansions.

Section One has no *bonfire* tile. When the characters rest during Section One, the party spends one *spark* and the characters are restored as for any rest (see §11.2). The characters revive on the bonfire tile listed in Section Two and enter Section One again at its first *encounter* tile. The *Firekeeper* and *Blacksmith Andre* cannot be visited until Section Two.

SECTION ONE: UNDEAD ASYLUM

1. Level 1 encounter
2. Level 1 encounter
3. Asylum Demon (*mini-boss*)

SECTION TWO: UNDEAD BURG

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 1 encounter
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Gargoyle (mini-boss), fought twice (see §17.1)

SECTION THREE: SEN'S FORTRESS

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 1 encounter
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Level 2 encounter
6. Titanite Demon (mini-boss)

SECTION FOUR: SEN'S FORTRESS

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter
3. Level 3 encounter
4. *Level 4 encounter*
5. Stray Demon (*mega-boss*)

SECTION FIVE: ANOR LONDO

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter
3. Level 2 encounter
4. Level 3 encounter
5. Level 3 encounter
6. Level 3 encounter
7. Ornstein & Smough (*main-boss*)

19.7 Call of the Abyss

This campaign requires the core set, the Darkroot expansion, and The Four Kings expansion. The party may add the Explorers and Characters expansions.

SECTION ONE: UNDEAD PARISH

1. *Bonfire* tile
2. Level 1 *encounter*
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Level 2 encounter
6. Titanite Demon (*mini-boss*)

SECTION TWO: DARKROOT BASIN

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 1 encounter
3. Level 2 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Level 3 encounter
6. Great Grey Wolf Sif (*main-boss*)

SECTION THREE: ROYAL WOOD

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter
3. Level 3 encounter
4. Level 3 encounter
5. Level 3 encounter
6. Artorias (main-boss)

SECTION FOUR: THE ABYSS

1. Bonfire tile
2. *Level 4 encounter*
3. Level 4 encounter
4. The Four Kings (*mega-boss*)

19.8 A Hollow Pursuit

This campaign requires the core set and the Explorers expansion. The party may add the Characters expansion.

Section One: The Crestfallen's Retreat

1. *Bonfire* tile
2. Level 1 *encounter*
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 1 encounter
5. Level 2 encounter
6. Old Dragonslayer (*mini-boss*)

Section Two: Lower Earthen Peak

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 1 encounter
3. Level 2 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Level 3 encounter: Gallery of the Hidden Warrior

No *ambush card* is placed beside the tile of Gallery of the Hidden Warrior. The *chest* on that tile is a Voracious Mimic. When the party opens the chest, a *mimic* encounter begins as if an ambush card showing Mimic had been revealed (see §13.1).

Section Two is completed when the mimic is killed, not when Gallery of the Hidden Warrior is *cleared* (see §18.1).

Section Three: Threshold Bridge

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter
3. Level 3 encounter
4. Level 3 encounter
5. Level 3 encounter
6. Pursuer (*main-boss*)

19.9 The Undead Colosseum

This campaign requires the core set, the Darkroot expansion, the Explorers expansion, the Vordt of the Boreal Valley expansion, and the Executioner's Chariot expansion. The party may add the Characters expansion.

The Level 1, Level 2, and Level 3 encounter decks are built from the *encounter cards* of the core set, the Darkroot expansion, and the Explorers expansion together. The *Level 4 encounter* deck is built from the Level 4 encounter cards of the Vordt of the Boreal Valley expansion and the Executioner's Chariot expansion together. The six named *encounters* are encounter cards of the Executioner's Chariot expansion.

When the characters rest at the *bonfire*, a *cleared* encounter does not *reset*, and its encounter card stays face up. A cleared encounter is not fought again, and the party passes its tile without paying the cost of skipping it (see §7.5, Encounter Start). A *failed* encounter resets (see §11.5). When an encounter is cleared, every character gains the campaign soul reward for its level and two further *souls* (see §18.5).

Section One: Warm Welcome

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 1 encounter
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 1 encounter: Silent Pathway
5. Level 2 encounter
6. Gargoyle (*mini-boss*)

Section Two: Guardian's Gate

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 1 encounter: Quiet Graveyard
3. Level 2 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Old Dragonslayer (mini-boss)

Section Three: Trained Beast

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter
3. Level 2 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter: Mausoleum Ruins
5. Level 3 encounter
6. Great Grey Wolf Sif (*main-boss*)

Section Four: Haunting Warrior

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter: Misty Burial Site
3. Level 3 encounter
4. Pursuer (main-boss)

Section Five: Dark Champion

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 3 encounter: Corrupted Crypt
3. Level 4 encounter
4. Executioner's Chariot (*mega-boss*)

Section Six: Terror of the Ring

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 3 encounter: Desolate Cemetery
3. Level 4 encounter
4. Vordt of the Boreal Valley (mega-boss)

19.10 Into the Depths

This campaign requires the core set, the Darkroot expansion, and the Gaping Dragon expansion. The party may add the Explorers and Characters expansions.

Section One: Broken Path

1. *Bonfire* tile
2. Level 1 *encounter*
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Level 2 encounter
6. Winged Knight (*mini-boss*)

Section Two: Shattered Spire

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter
3. Level 2 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Titanite Demon (mini-boss)

Section Three: Crypt of the Fallen

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter
3. Level 3 encounter
4. Level 3 encounter
5. Artorias (*main-boss*)

Section Four: Warriors' Revenge

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 3 encounter
3. Level 3 encounter: Outskirts of Blighttown
4. *Level 4 encounter*
5. Ornstein & Smough (main-boss)

Section Five: The Depths

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 4 encounter: Darkened Chamber
3. Level 4 encounter: The Depths
4. Gaping Dragon (*mega-boss*)

19.11 Playing with Fire

This campaign requires the core set and the Iron Keep expansion. The party may add the Explorers and Characters expansions.

Section One: Poison Pool

1. *Bonfire* tile
2. Level 1 *encounter*
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Level 2 encounter
6. Level 3 encounter: Smoking Gallery

Section One is completed when Smoking Gallery is *cleared* (see §18.1).

Section Two: Threshold Bridge

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 1 encounter
3. Level 2 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Level 3 encounter
6. Smelter Demon (*main-boss*)

Section Three: Ironhearth Hall

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 2 encounter
3. Level 3 encounter
4. Level 3 encounter
5. Level 3 encounter
6. Sir Alonne (main-boss)

19.12 Big Game Hunting

This campaign requires the core set, the Asylum Demon expansion, The Last Giant expansion, and the Manus, Father of the Abyss expansion. The party may add the Explorers and Characters expansions.

Every *boss* encounter of this campaign, including the *mini-boss* encounter, is fought on a *mega-boss game board*. After Section One is completed, the party plays Section Two A, Section Two B, and Section Two C in the order it chooses. The players win the campaign when all three are completed.

Section One: Asylum Hunt

1. *Bonfire* tile
2. Level 1 *encounter*
3. Level 1 encounter
4. Level 2 encounter
5. Level 2 encounter
6. Asylum Demon (mini-boss)

Section Two A: Forest Hunt

1. Bonfire tile
2. *Level 4 encounter*
3. The Last Giant (*mega-boss*)

Section Two B: Bridge Hunt

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 4 encounter
3. Stray Demon (mega-boss)

Section Two C: Chasm Hunt

1. Bonfire tile
2. Level 4 encounter
3. Manus, Father of the Abyss (mega-boss)

CHAPTER 20

20 Player versus Player



When the boss lies dead, the bonfire's peace is not yet earned. The characters who brought it down turn their weapons on one another, and the last one standing takes the honours. This chapter states how such a contest is set up, fought, and won.

20.1 Setup

Player versus player (PvP) encounters are an optional rule. They require no expansion. The party decides during setup whether PvP encounters are in play (see §6.5, Optional Rules).

PvP encounter. A contest fought between the characters alone, without enemies, on the tile on which a boss has been defeated.

When PvP encounters are in play, one *PvP encounter* is fought after each *mini-boss*, *main-boss*, and *mega-boss* is defeated. It is fought on the tile on which that boss was defeated: the mini-boss tile, the main-boss tile, which is the two *boss tiles* joined as one (see §15.3), or the *mega-boss game board*. It follows the rewards for the boss's defeat (see §16.5) and precedes the rest at the *bonfire* that follows every boss but the *final boss* (see §20.9).

The winner of a PvP encounter gains a *victory bonus* for the PvP encounters that follow; the winner of the PvP encounter that follows the *final boss* is instead the *ultimate victor* (see §20.8). A PvP encounter awards no *souls* and no *treasure cards*. Death in a PvP encounter costs nothing, and the rest that follows the PvP encounter restores every character (see §20.7 and §20.9).

A character who died in the boss *encounter* takes no part in the PvP encounter that follows it. Every other character takes part. *Phantoms*, both *summons* and *invaders*, take no part. If fewer than two characters take part, no PvP encounter is fought and no character wins.

The PvP encounter is set up as follows.

1. Remove every enemy model, *wound token*, and *trap token* from the tile.
2. Remove every *damage cube*, *stamina cube*, *hollow cube*, and *condition* token from each character who takes part.
3. Turn the *luck*, *estus flask*, and *heroic action* tokens of each character who takes part to their ready sides.
4. Settle the turn order (see §20.2).
5. Place each character's model, in turn order, on a corner node chosen by that character's player and occupied by no other model.
6. Set the *aggro token* aside (see §20.2).
7. Shuffle the trap tokens in the supply face down and place them beside the tile.

A corner node is the *node* nearest to one of the four corners of the tile, among the nodes that hold no *terrain*. *Gravestones*, *barrels*, *chests*, and pillars stay on the tile as they stand and keep their effects (see §5.5).

Steps 2 and 3 restore the characters but are not a rest at the bonfire (see §11.2). No *spark* is spent, no encounter is *reset*, and the characters cannot visit the *Firekeeper* or Blacksmith Andre. An *embered* character keeps the *ember token*.

20.2 Turn Order

A *PvP encounter* has no enemy *turns*. The characters who take part take their turns one at a time in descending *threat* order (see §3.1). The order is kept for the whole PvP encounter.

If two or more characters share a threat value, the players decide the order of the tied characters before the first turn. If the players cannot agree, the order of the tied characters is decided at random.

In a PvP encounter a *round* is one turn by each character still in play. When the last character in the order has taken a turn, a new round begins with the first character in the order. A dead character takes no turn. Rounds continue until the PvP encounter ends (see §20.8).

The *aggro token* is not used in a PvP encounter.

20.3 Character Turns

A character's *turn* in a *PvP encounter* follows the rules of the standard game (see §10.1). The character recovers stamina, takes *minor actions*, takes one *major action*, and moves as in any other *encounter* (see §10.2). Every limit of the standard game applies, including the limit of one *spell attack option* per turn (see §4.3). No model leaves the tile (see §5.2).

The *Attack* major action is made against another character (see §20.4). The other major actions and every minor action are unchanged.

At the end of each character's turn, that character's player places one *trap token* (see §20.6).

20.4 Attacking a Character

In a *PvP encounter* the *target* of a character's attack is another character. The character who makes the attack is the attacker, and the targeted character is the defender. The attacker resolves the attack as an attack against an enemy (see §10.3), and the defender defends as against an enemy's attack (see §9.3), except as this section states.

The attacker makes the attack as follows.

1. Choose an *attack option* of an *equipped* card and pay its stamina cost.
2. Name one other character within the attack option's *range* as the target (see §5.4).
3. Roll the attack option's dice, apply every modifier, and use any rerolls.
4. Add one to the result for each *victory bonus* the attacker holds (see §20.8).

The final result is the *attack value*. The modifiers and rerolls of the standard game apply to the roll: the +1 of a *scaled* weapon (see §10.5), the reroll of a *two-handed* weapon (see §10.4), and the *luck* token (see §3.5, Luck).

The icons and text of an attack option apply to a defender as they apply to an enemy (see §10.3). An attack option that bears the *shaft* icon cannot target a character on the attacker's *node*. An attack option that bears the *AoE* icon targets every other character on the chosen node: the attacker rolls once, and each of those characters chooses and resolves a defence of their own against the same attack value. Each use of an attack option that bears the *repeat* icon is a separate attack, with its own roll and its own defence.

When the attack value is final, the defender chooses one of the following defences before rolling any dice.

- The defender may *block* an attack that deals *physical damage* or *resist* an attack that deals *magical damage* (see §9.4). The defender suffers damage equal to the attack value minus the *defence total*, to a minimum of zero, and is *hit*.
- The defender may *dodge* as against an enemy's attack (see §9.5). The *dodge difficulty* is given by the table in this section.
- The defender may *parry* as against an enemy's attack, with the attacker in the place of the enemy, if the conditions for a parry are met (see §9.6). The dodge difficulty is given by the same table.
- The defender may decline to defend. The defender suffers damage equal to the attack value and is hit.

A character has no fixed block or resist value. A defender who blocks or resists rolls the dice and takes the two highest (see §9.4).

A successful parry *staggers* the attacker and allows the defender one *riposte* against the attacker (see §9.6). The riposte is an attack under this section with the roles reversed, and its dodge difficulty is set by the stamina cost of the attack option chosen for it. The target of a riposte may block, resist, or dodge it but cannot parry it.

The defender places one *damage cube* on their *endurance bar* for each point of damage suffered (see §3.4). An *embered* defender reduces the damage of an attack as in any other encounter (see §7.3).

The dodge difficulty of a character's attack is set by the stamina cost printed on the attack option.

Stamina cost of the attack option	Dodge difficulty
0	3
1	2
2	2
3	1
4	1
5 or more	1

EXAMPLE The Assassin attacks the Knight, who stands on an adjacent node, with an attack option that costs one stamina. The Assassin places one stamina cube and rolls two blue dice, which show 2 and 3, for an attack value of 5. An attack option that costs one stamina has dodge difficulty 2. The Knight chooses to dodge, places one stamina cube, and rolls two dodge dice, which show one success and one blank. The total of 1 is lower than the dodge difficulty, so the dodge fails and the Knight is hit. The Knight rolls only the block dice of the armour card, two black dice, which show 1 and 2, for a defence total of 3. The Knight suffers two damage and places two damage cubes.

EXAMPLE On the Knight's turn, the Knight attacks the Assassin with an attack option that costs four stamina and rolls an attack value of 6. An attack option that costs four stamina has dodge difficulty 1. The Assassin chooses to dodge, places one stamina cube, and rolls two dodge dice, which show one success and one blank. The total of 1 equals the dodge difficulty, so the dodge succeeds. The Assassin is not hit, suffers no damage, and moves to an adjacent node.

20.5 Pushes and Conditions

An *attack option* that bears the *push* icon pushes each character it *hits*. The push follows the rules of the standard game (see §8.4), and *terrain* affects the pushed character as in any other encounter (see §5.5). A push onto a *node* that holds a face-down *trap token* triggers the trap (see §20.6).

A condition icon on an attack option places the matching *condition* token on each character it hits. A condition on a character has the same effect and the same duration as in any other encounter (see §8.5). Only a character who is hit is pushed or receives a condition token (see §8.1).

In a *PvP encounter*, a choice that a rule of the standard game leaves to the players is made by the player whose character makes the attack or the movement that calls for the choice.

20.6 Traps

At the end of each character's *turn*, that character's player draws one *trap token* from the supply without looking at its face and places it face down on an outermost available *node* of that player's choice. A trap token placed in a *PvP encounter* may occupy a node of any type.

A node is available when it holds no model, no trap token, and no other *terrain*. The outermost available nodes are the available nodes along the edges of the tile. When no node along the edges is available, the outermost available nodes are the available nodes of the next ring inward, and so on towards the centre of the tile. If no node is available, or if no trap token remains in the supply, no trap token is placed.

A character who enters a node that holds a face-down trap token triggers it as in the standard game, and the token is turned face up (see §5.5, Traps). A blank token has no effect. If the token is not blank, each character on that node must attempt to *dodge* it as an attack with the *dodge difficulty* shown on the token (see §9.5). The damage value shown on the token is not used.

A character cannot choose to suffer a trap's damage in a PvP encounter. A character whose dodge fails dies. A character who has no free space on their endurance bar for the stamina cube of the dodge cannot attempt it and dies (see §20.7). A face-up trap token stays on its node and has no further effect during the PvP encounter.

> EXAMPLE The Herald's turn ends, and the Herald's player draws a trap token and places it face down on an empty node along the edge of the tile, adjacent to the Warrior's node. On the Knight's turn, the Knight's attack hits the Warrior and pushes the Warrior onto that node. The token is turned face up and shows dodge difficulty 1 and damage 3. The Warrior places one stamina cube and rolls two dodge dice, which show two blanks. The dodge fails and the Warrior dies.

20.7 Death

In a *PvP encounter* a character dies in one of two ways. The character dies when they must place a *damage cube* on their *endurance bar* and no space is free (see §3.4). The character also dies when a trap kills them (see §20.6).

Death in a PvP encounter costs nothing. The steps that follow a death in any other encounter are not carried out (see §7.2). The character drops no *souls*, keeps the *ember token*, receives no *hollow cubes*, and is not *lost*.

When a character dies, that character's player removes the model from the tile, and the character takes no further *turns* in that PvP encounter.

A PvP encounter is neither *cleared* nor *failed* (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution). However it ends, the party spends no *spark* for it and is not required to rest. Every character, including each character who died, is restored by the rest that follows the PvP encounter (see §20.9).

20.8 Victory

A *PvP encounter* ends when one character, or no character, remains on the tile. The last character on the tile wins the PvP encounter. If every remaining character dies at the same time, the PvP encounter ends and no character wins.

If no character suffers damage and no character dies during three consecutive *rounds*, each character still in play suffers one damage at the end of every round that follows, until the PvP encounter ends. A character cannot defend against this damage.

Victory bonus. The reward for winning a PvP encounter that follows the defeat of a boss other than the *final boss*: +1 to the attack value of each of the winner's attacks in every subsequent PvP encounter.

When a character wins a PvP encounter that follows the defeat of a boss other than the final boss, the character gains one *victory bonus*. One *wound token* of value 1 is placed beside the winner's dashboard to mark it. In every subsequent PvP encounter, the character adds one to the *attack value* of each of their attacks for each victory bonus held (see §20.4). Victory bonuses are cumulative, have no effect outside PvP encounters, and are kept until the game ends.

Ultimate victor. The character who wins the PvP encounter that follows the defeat of the final boss.

The winner of the PvP encounter that follows the defeat of the final boss is the *ultimate victor*. That PvP encounter awards no victory bonus. If no character wins it, the game has no ultimate victor. Victory over the final boss is shared by every player, whatever the outcome of the PvP encounter (see §7.1).

> EXAMPLE The Assassin wins the PvP encounter that follows the mini-boss, and one wound token is placed beside the Assassin's dashboard. In the PvP encounter that follows the main-boss, which is the final boss of this game, the Assassin rolls a total of 4 for an attack and adds one for the victory bonus, for an attack value of 5. The Assassin is the last character on the tile and is the ultimate victor.

20.9 After the PvP Encounter

When a *PvP encounter* that follows the defeat of a boss other than the *final boss* ends:

1. Return every *trap token* on the tile to the supply.

2. Carry out the setup that follows that boss (see §6.6 and §6.7).

That setup ends with a rest at the *bonfire* that costs no *spark* (see §11.2). The rest restores every character, including each character who died in the PvP encounter and each character who died in the boss encounter. It is the one rest that follows the boss's defeat (see §16.5); a PvP encounter grants no second rest.

When the PvP encounter that follows the defeat of the final boss ends, the game ends. No setup and no rest follow it.



OLIVER THE COLLECTOR



INVADER BRYLEX



MARVELOUS CHESTER



PALADIN LEEROY



FENCER SHARRON



KIRK, KNIGHT OF THORNS



MELINDA THE BUTCHER



MALDRON THE ASSASSIN



CHAPTER 21

21 Glossary

Terms set in italics in this book are defined here. Where a definition and a chapter disagree, the chapter governs.

Adjacent node. A node directly next to another node horizontally, vertically, or diagonally. Nodes separated by a wall, including a wall printed across a tile or a mega-boss game board, are not adjacent, and nodes on different tiles are not adjacent (see §5.1).

Aggro. The state of being the enemies' preferred target. Enemy movement icons and attack icons marked with the skull icon target the character who holds the aggro token (see §9.2, §9.3).

Aggro token. The single token that marks the character with aggro. It is placed on the character with the highest threat at the start of each encounter and, after each round of character turns, moves to the character who inflicted the most damage on enemy models during that round (on a tie, or if no damage was inflicted, the holder keeps it). If the holder dies it moves to the living character with the highest threat. In boss encounters it moves to any character who damages the boss during their turn (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order; §16.4).

Ambush card. A card from the Explorers expansion that shows Treasure or Mimic. When mimics are in play, one is dealt face down beside each encounter tile and is turned face up only when the party chooses to open that tile's chest (see §13.1).

Area attack. A boss attack whose icon bears the area icon. It is made into the attack arcs of the arc diagram beneath it and targets every character within the card's range who is in one of those arcs. Each targeted character defends separately, and an area attack cannot be parried (see §16.3; §15.6).

Area-of-effect (AoE). A character attack option marked with the area-of-effect icon. It targets one node within range: one attack roll is compared with the block or resist of every enemy on that node, and every enemy there is hit (see §10.3, Area-of-Effect).

Armour. An equipment card bearing the armour icon. One armour card may be equipped in the armour slot. After a failed dodge, only the block or resist dice of the armour card and of the upgrade cards attached to it are rolled (see §9.5).

Armour slot. The dashboard slot that holds one equipped *armour* card (see §3.2).

Attack arc. A *boss arc* shown in green on the arc diagram beneath an *area attack*. The area attack targets every character within range who is in that arc (see §15.6; §16.3).

Attack (major action). The major action in which a character makes up to one attack with each weapon or spell equipped in a weapon slot, each attack using one attack option and paying its stamina cost (see §10.3).

Attack option. One line of a weapon or spell card, showing a stamina cost, dice and modifiers. Using an attack option is the *Attack* major action.

Attack value. The total of the values rolled on an attack's dice after rerolls, with any fixed modifier applied once to the total, plus one for a *scaled* weapon and minus one for a *staggered* attacker, to a minimum of zero (see §10.3). For enemies the attack value is the fixed number printed in the attack icon, scaled for the number of characters (see §9.3).

Back-up slot. The dashboard slot that holds up to two treasure cards of any kind, carried but not equipped (see §3.2). During an encounter, cards in the back-up slot may be exchanged with the weapon and armour slots only by the *Equip* minor action; an *ember card* must be in the back-up slot to be used.

Barrel. A terrain token or model with an intact side and a destroyed side. No model may *move* into a node containing an intact barrel; a model that *dodges* or is pushed into the node destroys the barrel. Barrels are restored when the characters rest at the *bonfire* (see §5.5, Barrels).

Base health. The health printed on an enemy's data card, before enemy scaling (see §8.2).

Basic node. The most common node type. Basic nodes adjacent to a doorway are also entry nodes.

Behaviour card. A card drawn from the behaviour deck of a boss, mimic, invader, or summon at the start of that model's turn. Its icons are resolved from left to right. A boss's current behaviour card sets the range and the dodge difficulty of its attacks and shows its weak arcs until the next card is drawn (see §15.5; §16.1).

Behaviour deck. The face-down deck of behaviour cards from which a boss, mimic, invader, or summon draws one card at the start of each of its turns. A boss's behaviour deck is built during setup and built again each time its failed encounter is reset (see §15.5). When the deck is empty at the start of a turn, the discard pile is turned face down without shuffling to form the new deck.

Behaviour icon. A movement or attack icon on an enemy data card or a behaviour card. Icons are resolved left to right; an icon that has no valid target, or that cannot be resolved, is skipped (see §9.1).

Blacksmith Andre. The smith at the *bonfire* who keeps the *shop*, buying and selling treasure cards for *souls*, and who

attaches and removes *upgrade cards* at no cost. He is visited only while the party rests at the bonfire (see §11.4).

Bleed. A condition. A model holds at most one bleed token. When a bleed token is to be placed on a model that already holds one, the model instead suffers three damage that block and resist do not reduce, and its bleed token is removed. A bleed token is otherwise removed only when the encounter ends (see §8.5, Bleed).

Block. The defence rolled against an attack that deals physical damage. The defence total is the sum of the two highest block dice rolled from all equipped cards, with the fixed modifiers of those cards then applied (see §9.4). For enemies, block is the fixed value subtracted from a physical attack value.

Bonfire. The characters' safe haven, represented by the *bonfire* tile, which has no nodes. The Firekeeper and Blacksmith Andre wait there and are visited only while the party rests. Returning to the bonfire tile costs nothing; resting there costs one *spark* (see §11.1, §11.2).

Bonfire ascetic. In campaign play, a one-time communal payment of 16 *souls* made while resting at the *bonfire*, the one exception to the rule that souls cannot be pooled. It opens tier two treasure and the tier two shop and increases by two the base health of every enemy subject to enemy scaling for the rest of the campaign, cumulative with the health scaling for the number of characters. Enemy attack values are not changed (see §18.7).

Boss. A single powerful enemy whose turns are driven by a behaviour deck and whose base is divided into four arcs. There are three ranks: *mini-boss*, *main-boss*, and *mega-boss*. A boss is not scaled for the number of characters and cannot be pushed by characters (see §15; §16).

Boss arc. One of the four sectors (front, left, right, back) into which a boss's base is divided. The arcs extend across the tile: each node lies in at least one arc, and a node on the line between two arcs lies in both (see §15.6).

Boss spawn node. The spawn node of a boss's type: the mini-boss spawn node, the main-boss spawn node, or the mega-boss spawn node. The boss model is placed on it at the start of every boss encounter (see §15.3).

Boss tile. One of the two tiles on which mini-boss and main-boss encounters are fought. A mini-boss encounter is fought on the mini-boss tile alone; a main-boss encounter is fought on both boss tiles joined as one tile, the main-boss tile. A mega-boss is fought on the mega-boss game board supplied with it (see §15.3).

Boss treasure. A treasure card supplied with a boss. One of a boss's treasure cards is awarded at random when the boss is defeated (see §16.5). Boss treasure cannot be bought; it sells for six *souls* and is returned to the game box when sold (see §11.4; for campaign play, see §18.6).

Calamity. A condition from the Black Dragon Kalameet expansion. A model holds at most one calamity token, which reduces the total of each of its block, resist, and dodge rolls by one. A calamity token is removed only when the encounter ends (see §8.5, Calamity).

Campaign. A game played through a fixed list of *sections*, taken in order, in which the characters keep what they have gained from one section to the next. The book supplies 12 campaigns; campaign play follows the standard game except as its own chapter states (see §18.1, §19).

Catalyst. A weapon card that stores up to three spells of a matching school: a pyromancer flame stores pyromancies, a staff or catalyst stores sorceries, and a talisman or chime stores miracles. A stored spell occupies no equipment slot; its attack options are used as if it were equipped, and its block, resist, and dodge dice are ignored (see §4.3).

Character dashboard. The board that records a character's class: the heroic action, the four equipment slots, the stat progression track, the endurance bar, the threat value, and the four token slots (see §3.1).

Chest. A terrain token or model that blocks movement, dodging, and pushes. A chest holds one face-down treasure card of the current tier, revealed when the encounter is *cleared* and awarded to the party (see §7.7). With mimics in play, opening a chest requires revealing the tile's *ambush card* (see §13).

Class-specific treasure. A treasure card marked with a small white class emblem. It is sorted into the tier one or tier two deck by its stat requirements exactly as common treasure is.

Cleared. The result of an encounter in which every enemy model is killed and at least one character survives. A *cleared* encounter card is marked with a black cube, keeps the cube through a *reset*, and may thereafter be skipped until the encounter is *failed*. The first clear rewards full *souls* and treasure; every later clear rewards the *reduced reward* and no treasure (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution).

Common treasure. A treasure card that is not starting, class-specific, transposed, legendary or boss treasure. Common treasure with any stat requirement of 25 or more is tier two; all other common treasure is tier one.

Condition. A lasting effect marked by a condition token on a model: *bleed*, *poison*, *frostbite*, *stagger*, *calamity*, or *corrosion*. A condition token is placed on each model hit by an attack that bears the matching icon, after the attack is resolved. A model holds at most one token of each condition, except poison (see §8.5).

Corrosion. A condition from the Gaping Dragon expansion. A model holds at most one corrosion token, which reduces the total of each of its block rolls by one. The token is removed when the affected model next suffers damage (see §8.5, Corrosion).

Crystal lizard. An optional enemy from the Iron Keep expansion, placed on a terrain node that the encounter card marks with the crystal lizard symbol. It flees rather than fights, is not scaled, does not count towards clearing the encounter, and escapes without award when the encounter is *cleared*. The character who kills one takes a Titanite Scale card, and once one has been killed in an encounter none is placed there again (see §14).

Damage cube. A red cube. Each point of damage a character suffers places one damage cube on the endurance bar, filling

from the right. A character who must place a damage cube and has no space dies.

Data card. The card that defines an enemy, boss, mimic, or phantom: name, threat, range, dodge difficulty, block and resist, behaviour icons or behaviour deck size, health, and special ability (see §8.2 for enemies; §15.4 for bosses).

Defence total. The sum of the two highest block or resist dice rolled, to which the fixed modifiers of the equipped cards are then applied; a single die counts alone, no dice count as zero, and a total of less than zero is zero. Damage suffered equals the attack value minus the defence total, to a minimum of zero (see §9.4).

Distract. An icon found only on summon behaviour cards. During the boss's next turn the summon is treated as holding the aggro token; the token itself is not moved (see §12.1).

Dodge. A defence against an attack that targets the character. The character pays one stamina, may pay two further stamina for one extra green die to a maximum of four dice, and succeeds if the dodge icons rolled equal or exceed the attack's dodge difficulty. A successful dodge avoids the hit and the character must move to an adjacent valid node; after a failed dodge only the armour card's block or resist dice are rolled (see §9.5).

Dodge difficulty. The number of dodge icons a dodge or parry roll must equal or exceed. It is printed on an enemy data card, a boss behaviour card, or a trap token (see §9.5). In player versus player it is derived from the stamina cost of the attacker's attack option.

Doorway. A gap in a tile's wall through which characters pass between tiles. Basic nodes beside a doorway are entry nodes.

Drink Estus (major action). The major action in which a character flips the *estus flask* token to its used side and removes every damage cube from their endurance bar. It may be taken only while the token shows its ready side (see §3.5, Estus Flask; §10.1).

Dropped souls. *Souls* placed on an encounter tile by a character who died there or, when an encounter was *failed*, by a living character. Only the character who dropped them may reclaim them, by surviving to clear that encounter; any still on the tiles when a boss is defeated are returned to the characters who dropped them. They are returned to the supply if that character dies first (see §7.6; §6.6).

Ember. An *ember card* consumed by a character as the *Ember* major action, or the state of being *embered* that results (see §4.4, §7.3).

Ember card. A tier one shop card. Discarding an *ember* card from the back-up slot (the *Ember* major action, or outside an encounter) makes the character *embered* (see §7.3). A character may carry only one *ember* card and cannot carry one while *embered*; a card held when the character becomes *embered* passes to another character (see §7.3).

Ember token. The token that marks an *embered* character. It begins the game beside the dashboard, is placed in the dashboard's ember slot when the character becomes embered, and is removed when the character dies (see §3.5, Ember; §7.3).

Embered. The state of a character with an *ember token*. An embered character is not *hollow*, reduces by one the damage of any attack that deals three or more, may call a *summon* before a boss encounter, and provokes *invasions*. The state ends when the character dies (see §7.3).

Encounter. A battle fought on one or more tiles against the enemies set out by an encounter card, or against a boss. An encounter ends *cleared* or *failed* (see §7.5); a PvP encounter ends in neither way (see §20.7).

Encounter card. The card dealt face down to each tile that lists the encounter's level, enemies, terrain and traps. It is revealed when the characters enter the tile.

Encounter level. The difficulty of an encounter, from 1 to 4. The levels of the encounters leading to a boss are printed on that boss's data card and increase from the tile adjacent to the bonfire tile towards the boss tile (see §6.5). In the standard game Level 4 encounters precede mega-bosses only (see §6.7). In campaign play each section lists the levels of its encounters (see §18.1).

Endurance bar. The track of 10 spaces on the dashboard that holds both stamina cubes (filling from the left) and damage cubes (filling from the right). A *hollow* character's two hollow cubes block the two rightmost spaces, leaving eight (see §3.4).

Enemy scaling. The adjustment of every enemy to the number of characters fixed at setup: more health with two or more characters, movement values of 1 resolved as 2 with two or more characters, and +1 attack value with four characters. Bosses, mimics, phantoms, and crystal lizards are never scaled (see §8.3).

Entry node. A basic node beside the doorway through which the characters entered the tile. Characters are placed on entry nodes at the start of an encounter, no more than three to a node. In a Level 4 encounter all four nodes along the wall beside the doorway are entry nodes (see §6.7).

Equip. A minor action, once per turn, in which a character exchanges any number of cards among the back-up slot, the two weapon slots, and the armour slot. It is the only way to change equipped cards during an encounter; the inventory cannot be accessed (see §10.1).

Equipment card. A treasure card that a character equips in a weapon or armour slot, stores in a catalyst, or attaches to an equipped card: weapon, shield, catalyst, spell, armour, and upgrade cards (see §4.1).

Equipped. The state of a card in the armour slot or a weapon slot of the dashboard. Cards in the back-up slot and the inventory are not equipped (see §3.2).

Estus flask. A character token. Flipping it as the Drink Estus major action removes all damage cubes from the endurance bar; stamina cubes, hollow cubes, and condition tokens are not removed. It is readied only by resting at the *bonfire* (see §3.5, Estus Flask).

Facing. The direction in which the centre of a boss's front arc points. A boss faces directly towards an adjacent node and changes its facing only when a movement icon or a turn icon turns it (see §15.6).

Failed. The result of an encounter in which every character dies, or in which any *hollow* character dies. A *failed* encounter awards nothing; every living character drops their *souls* on the tile, its card is turned face down and its black cube removed, and the characters must rest at the *bonfire* (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution).

Final boss. The last boss of the game: the main-boss, or the mega-boss if the players chose to add one. Defeating the final boss wins the game (see §7.1). In campaign play the final boss is the last boss listed in the campaign's last section (see §18.1).

Firekeeper. The figure at the *bonfire* who raises a character's stats, one *stat tier* per purchase, in exchange for that character's *souls*. Stat tiers one to four cost 2, 4, 8, and 10 souls (see §11.3; for campaign play, see §18.6).

Fog gate. The token that marks the doorway of a boss encounter. A boss encounter begins when the characters pass through it. The first time they pass through, the token is moved to the *bonfire* tile, where it is a shortcut to that boss until the boss is defeated (see §15.1). In campaign play it is aesthetic only (see §18.2).

Frostbite. A condition. A character with a frostbite token cannot recover stamina and cannot take the *Rest* major action; any other model with a frostbite token reduces each of its movement values by one. The token is removed at the end of the model's next complete turn (see §8.5, Frostbite).

Gravestone. A terrain token or model. No model may *move*, *dodge*, or be pushed into a node containing a gravestone. When an encounter that contains a gravestone is *cleared*, the players may *scry* one card (see §5.5, Gravestones; §7.5, Encounter Resolution).

Health dial. The dial that records the health of a boss, summon, invader, or mimic. Enemies record damage with wound tokens instead (see §15.4).

Heat-up. The event in which a boss, mimic, or invader becomes more dangerous. When a boss's health is reduced to or below its heat-up point, one heat-up card taken at random is shuffled into the cards that remain in its behaviour deck (see §15.5); a mimic or an invader adds one of its unused behaviour cards instead. Some bosses heat up differently (see §17).

Heat-up card. A behaviour card marked with the heat-up symbol. Heat-up cards are set aside when the behaviour deck is built, and one of them joins the deck when the boss heats up (see §15.5).

Heat-up point. The health value, printed on a boss's data card, at or below which the boss heats up (see §15.5).

Heroic action. The once-per-rest ability printed on the dashboard, resolved as a minor action by flipping the *heroic action* token to its used side. Its printed wording overrides other rules. The token is readied only by resting at the *bonfire* (see §3.5, Heroic Action).

Hit. A target is hit by an attack when it is within the attack's range and does not avoid the attack by a successful *dodge* or *parry*, even if the attack deals no damage. Pushes and conditions carried by an attack apply only to models that the attack hits (see §8.1).

Hollow. The state of a character revived after dying. Two *hollow cubes* block the two rightmost spaces of the endurance bar, leaving eight. Hollow is removed only by resting at the *bonfire* or by becoming *embered*. A hollow character who dies is *lost*, and the encounter is *failed* (see §7.2).

Hollow cube. One of eight cubes of a colour distinct from the damage, stamina, and stat cubes. Two hollow cubes block the two rightmost spaces of a *hollow* character's endurance bar (see §7.2).

Invader. A hostile phantom brought into one encounter by an *invasion*. An invader acts after each character's turn using its own behaviour deck, is not scaled, counts towards clearing the encounter while it is on the tile, vanishes without award if a character dies, and awards *souls* and its treasure card when killed (see §12.2).

Invader token. A token from the Phantoms expansion that shows an invader or is blank. When an *invasion* is provoked, one token is placed face down on each face-down encounter card, one of them showing an invader; a token is revealed when the characters fight that encounter (see §12.2).

Invasion. The placing of invader tokens that brings one invader into the game. An invasion is provoked when the encounter cards are dealt while a character is *embered*, or when a character becomes embered by discarding an *ember card* while a face-down encounter card lies on a tile; no more than one is provoked before the mini-boss is defeated and no more than one after it (see §12.2).

Inventory. A character's unlimited stack of unequipped treasure cards, kept face down beside the dashboard. Outside an encounter it may be rearranged freely and cards may be traded one for one between inventories; during an encounter it cannot be accessed (see §3.2).

Leap. A boss movement marked with the leap icon. The boss is removed from its node and placed on the node of its target, at any distance, without changing its facing. Every character on that node is pushed to a valid adjacent node chosen by that character's player, and the push is not limited by arcs (see §16.2).

Legendary treasure. A rare treasure card marked with an orange light under a chest. It cannot be purchased; five are shuffled into the tier two deck when the tier two shop is first stocked, and one drawn while stocking a shop is shuffled back (see §6.2, §6.3). In campaign play legendary treasure enters neither treasure deck, is obtained only by *transposition*, and sells for four *souls* (see §18.6, §18.8).

Level 4 encounter. The single encounter fought on the Level 4 encounter side of a *mega-boss game board* after the main-boss is defeated and before the mega-boss encounter. All four nodes along the wall beside the doorway are entry

nodes; once *cleared* it is not fought again and does not reset (see §6.7). In campaign play a Level 4 encounter is fought where its section lists it, on a mega-boss game board placed in the section's route (see §18.1).

Lost. The state of a *hollow* character who has died (see §7.2). A *lost* character is removed from play, the encounter is *failed* at once, and the character is revived only when the characters rest at the *bonfire*.

Luck. A character token. Flipping it allows the character to reroll any or all dice of one of their own attack or defence rolls; the dice are chosen together and the new results stand. It is readied only by resting at the *bonfire* (see §3.5, Luck).

Magical damage. Damage from an attack marked with the white circle icon. Magical damage is reduced by resist.

Main-boss. The second boss of the standard game, fought on both boss tiles joined as one after the mini-boss is defeated. Its defeat wins the standard game unless a mega-boss is in play (see §6.6; §15.3).

Major action. The one principal action of a character's turn: *Attack*, *Rest*, *Drink Estus*, or *Ember*. A character may take one major action per turn (see §10.1).

Mega-boss. An optional final boss from a mega-boss expansion, fought on its own game board after a Level 4 encounter. Death and hollowing in a mega-boss encounter follow the usual rules (see §7.2). In campaign play a mega-boss is faced only where the campaign lists one, and a mega-boss that is not the campaign's final boss is fought under the same rules as any other boss (see §18.1).

Mega-boss game board. The double-sided board supplied with a mega-boss expansion. Its Level 4 encounter side is the tile of the Level 4 encounter and its mega-boss side is the tile of the mega-boss encounter (see §6.7, §15.3).

Mega-boss setup card. The card of the Executioner's Chariot expansion that shows the enemy spawn nodes on which the Black Hollow Mages and the Falchion Skeletons are placed at the start of the mega-boss encounter (see §17.9).

Mimic. An optional enemy from the Explorers expansion that masquerades as a chest. When the party opens a chest whose *ambush card* shows Mimic, the Hungry Mimic (before the mini-boss is defeated) or the Voracious Mimic (afterwards) is fought in a *mimic encounter*. Killing it awards two treasure cards in place of the chest's one (see §13).

Mimic encounter. The encounter fought against a *mimic* on the tile of a *cleared* encounter whose chest the party has opened. It is fought as a mini-boss encounter without arcs, with the characters on the nodes they occupy and before any recovery or reward (see §13.2).

Mini-boss. The first boss of the standard game, fought on the mini-boss tile (see §6.5; §15.3).

Minor action. An action a character may take during their turn before the major action, after it, or both: *Walk*, *Equip*, and *Heroic Action* once each per turn, and *Run* any number of times (see §10.1).

Move. A change of node made by a model through the *Walk* or *Run* minor action, a *shift* icon, or an enemy or boss movement icon. The movement after a successful *dodge* and the movement of a *push* are not moves (see §5.2).

Nearest character. The living character at the shortest range from an enemy. If two or more characters are tied, the nearest character is the one who holds the aggro token, otherwise the one with the highest threat, and otherwise the one the players choose (see §9.2).

Node. A circular space on a tile. Every model occupies exactly one node. Nodes are basic, spawn or terrain.

Node attack. An enemy attack that bears the node icon. It targets every character on the node of the character named by its skull icon or nearest-character icon; each character defends separately, and a node attack cannot be parried (see §9.3).

Node model limit. At most three non-boss models and one boss model may occupy a node. A model entering a full node forces one occupant to be pushed to a valid node chosen by the players (see §5.3).

Parry. A defence available to a character with a shield equipped in the left weapon slot when the attacker is on the character's node; an attack that pushes, a node attack, and a boss attack outside §15.6 cannot be parried. The character pays one stamina and rolls dodge dice against the attack's dodge difficulty. Success makes the attack miss, staggers the attacker, and allows a *riposte*; failure deals the full attack value with no block or resist roll and staggers the character (see §9.6).

Phantom. A *summon* or an *invader*: a model of the Phantoms expansion with a data card and behaviour cards. A summon is friendly and an invader hostile; a phantom is neither a character nor a boss (see §12).

Physical damage. Damage from an attack marked with the crossed swords icon. Physical damage is reduced by block.

Pillar node. One of the four terrain nodes printed on the mega-boss side of the Asylum Demon expansion's *mega-boss game board*, on each of which a *pillar token* is placed at the start of a boss encounter fought there (see §17.3).

Pillar token. A terrain token placed on each of the four pillar nodes of the Asylum Demon mega-boss game board. No model may *move*, *dodge*, or be pushed into its node until the pillar is destroyed (see §5.5, Pillars; §17.3).

Poison. A condition. A model may hold any number of poison tokens. At the end of each of its turns a model suffers one damage for each poison token it holds, which block and resist do not reduce, and then removes all of its poison tokens (see §8.5, Poison).

Push. Forced movement of a model from its node to an adjacent valid node. A push is caused by a push-attack, by a push-move, by the node model limit, or by a boss model moving onto the node of another boss model. A push is not a move and costs no stamina; a gravestone, a chest, and a pillar token block it, and a push with no valid node does not happen (see §8.4).

Push-attack. An attack that bears the push icon. A model it hits is pushed directly away from the attacker, whether or not the attack dealt damage (see §8.4).

Push-move. An enemy or boss movement that bears the push icon. Characters on the enemy's node are pushed aside before it moves, and characters on each node it enters are pushed directly away from the node it left; a push icon that carries a damage value also makes each entry a physical attack (see §8.4).

PvP encounter. An optional contest fought between the characters alone, without enemies, on the tile on which a boss has been defeated, after each boss's defeat and before the rest that follows it. It has no enemy turns and no aggro token, is neither *cleared* nor *failed*, awards no *souls* and no treasure, and death in it costs nothing (see §20.1).

Range. The maximum distance between an attacker and its target, counted in nodes along the shortest chain of adjacent nodes. Range 0 is the same node; range 1 is an adjacent node; range ∞ is unlimited. Range is never blocked by terrain or models (see §5.4).

Reduced reward. Half the full soul reward, rounded down, gained by every character when an encounter that has been cleared before is cleared again (see §7.6).

Relevant stat. The stat whose requirement is the highest of the four stat requirements printed on a weapon card; if two or more requirements are tied for the highest, the character chooses one of the tied stats. A weapon is *scaled* by comparing the character's relevant stat with that requirement (see §10.5).

Repeat. An icon that causes an entire attack option or behaviour card to be resolved the number of times shown. For a character's attack option the stamina cost is paid once and each resolution is a separate attack roll with its own target (see §10.3, Repeat).

Reset. The state of an encounter after the characters have rested at the *bonfire*: its encounter card is face down, its enemy models have been removed, and its terrain tokens remain in place. A *cleared* encounter keeps its black cube through a reset; a *failed* encounter has none (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution; §11.5).

Resist. The defence rolled against an attack that deals magical damage, resolved as block is with resist dice (see §9.4). For enemies, resist is the fixed value subtracted from a magical attack value.

Rest (major action). The character removes every stamina cube from their endurance bar; damage cubes, hollow cubes, and condition tokens stay. A character cannot *Rest* in a turn in which they have *run*, cannot *run* after resting in the same turn, and cannot *Rest* while holding a *frostbite* token (see §10.1).

Resting at the bonfire. The party action, costing one *spark* unless it follows the defeat of a boss (in campaign play, unless it follows the completion of a *section*; see §18.3), that revives dead and *lost* characters, removes every damage cube, stamina cube, hollow cube, and condition token, readies the heroic action, luck, and estus flask tokens, allows visits to the Firekeeper and Blacksmith Andre, and resets every encounter. It neither places nor removes an *ember token* (see §11.2).

Revised card. A card listed in Appendix B that takes the place of the printed card of the same name. Where a revised card differs from the printed text, the text given in Appendix B governs (see Appendix B).

Riposte. The attack a character may make at once against the attacker after a successful *parry*, using one attack option of the weapon in the right weapon slot and paying its stamina cost. A riposte cannot be parried, and it does not count against the attacks of the character's own turn (see §9.6).

Round. One pass of the encounter turn order: every enemy model takes a turn in descending threat order, then every character takes a turn in descending threat order (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order).

Run. A minor action: the character spends one stamina and moves one node. It may be taken any number of times per turn. A character who has *run* cannot *Rest* in that turn (see §10.2).

Scaled health. An enemy's base health plus the increase that enemy scaling gives for the number of characters. An enemy is killed when the total value of its wound tokens equals or exceeds its scaled health (see §8.2).

Scaled (weapon). A weapon equipped by a character whose *relevant stat* exceeds the weapon's highest printed stat requirement by five or more. It is marked with a red cube and each of its attack options adds one to its attack value. Spells are never scaled (see §10.5).

Scry. To reveal one hidden card (the top card of a treasure deck, a face-down encounter card, or the top card of the next boss's behaviour deck) and either return it or send it away (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution).

Section. In campaign play, one list of tiles: a *bonfire* tile, a number of encounter tiles with their encounter levels, and the bosses to be faced. A section is completed when the last boss it lists is defeated or, for a section whose list ends in an encounter, when that encounter is *cleared*. The shop is restocked and a rest that costs no *spark* is granted only when a section is completed (see §18.1).

Shaft. A weapon icon. An attack option with the shaft icon cannot target a model on the attacker's own node (see §10.3, Shaft).

Shield. A one-handed weapon card that shows block or resist dice and has no attack option. A shield is a weapon for equipment slots and for two-handed attacks, and a shield for stocking the shop and for parrying (see §4.1).

Shift. An icon found on attack options and on summon behaviour cards. A character whose attack option bears it may move up to the number of nodes shown, before the target is chosen if the icon precedes the dice and after the attack's damage and effects if it follows them. A *shift* is a *move*, costs no stamina, and does not use the *Walk* or *Run* minor action (see §10.3, Shift; §12.1).

Shop. Blacksmith Andre's stock of face-up treasure cards, in a tier one shop and a tier two shop. A tier one card costs two *souls* and a tier two card four; a tier one or tier two treasure card sells for one soul and a boss treasure card for six, and starting equipment cannot be sold (see §11.4). The tier one shop is stocked at setup and the tier two shop when the mini-boss is defeated; both are restocked only after a boss is defeated (in campaign play, after a section is completed), unsold cards going to the bottom of their deck first (see §6.3).

Signature card. One of Black Dragon Kalameet's two behaviour cards, Mark of Calamity and Hellfire Blast, that are included in every behaviour deck built for Kalameet (see §17.8).

Souls. The currency of the game, tracked by soul tokens on each character's dashboard. *Souls* are gained by *clearing* encounters, defeating bosses, and killing invaders, and are dropped on death. They are spent while resting at the *bonfire* and, as the one exception, to call a *summon* at the fog gate (see §7.6, §12.1). *Souls* cannot be transferred between characters. A character adventuring alone begins with six *souls* (see §6.1).

Spark. The *bonfire*'s charges, tracked on the spark dial. The party begins with six minus the number of characters, gains one for each boss defeated, and spends one each time the characters rest at the *bonfire* (see §7.4). If the characters are required to rest while the dial shows zero, the players lose the game (see §7.1). In campaign play the dial's maximum is one more than its starting value and a *spark* may be bought back for *souls* (see §18.3).

Spawn node. A node on which enemy models are placed at the start of an encounter. Boss tiles have a boss spawn node.

Spell. An equipment card or upgrade card whose art shows a scroll: a pyromancy, a sorcery, or a miracle. A character may use at most one spell attack option per turn, and spells are never scaled or two-handed (see §4.3).

Stagger. A condition. A staggered character subtracts one from the total of each attack, block, resist, and dodge roll; any other staggered model reduces its attack values, its block and resist values, and its dodge difficulty by one. The token is removed at the end of the model's next complete turn. Stagger is placed by attacks that bear the stagger icon, by stamina overflow, and by a parry (see §8.5, Stagger; §9.6; §10.1).

Stamina cube. A black cube. Each point of stamina a character spends places one stamina cube on the endurance bar, filling from the left.

Starting equipment. The three or four equipment cards a character begins with, marked with that character's class icon (see §6.2). Starting equipment cannot be sold (see §11.4).

Stat cube. A white cube that marks a character's *stat tier* on a stat progression track (see §3.3).

Stat requirement. One of the four values (STR, DEX, INT, FTH) printed on an equipment card or upgrade card; for a weapon listed in Appendix A, the values given there replace the printed values (see Appendix A). A character may equip a card only if each of their stats equals or exceeds the matching requirement of the card and of every upgrade attached to it (see §4.1).

Stat tier. A character's position on each stat progression track: the base tier, or stat tier one, two, three, or four. It is marked with a *stat cube* or, at stat tier four, with a red cube in the stat tier three space. A stat at stat tier four has the value 40 or the stat tier three value plus five, whichever is higher. Tiers are bought in sequence from the Firekeeper (see §3.3, §11.3).

Strafe card. A card from the Black Dragon Kalameet expansion revealed when a strafe icon is resolved. It shows the nodes whose characters the strafe attack targets and the landing node on which Kalameet's model is then placed; a character on the landing node is pushed to an adjacent node (see §17.8).

Summon. A friendly phantom called before a boss encounter. Each *embered* character may pay two *souls* to draw one summon data card at random, and the players choose one of the drawn summons. The summon acts after each character's turn, defends with the dice on its data card, and is removed when its health dial is reduced to zero or the encounter ends (see §12.1).

Target. The model at which an attack is directed. An enemy never targets another enemy; a character targets another character only in player versus player (see §8.1).

Terrain. Gravestones, barrels, chests, and pillars, placed on terrain nodes, and trap tokens, dealt to basic nodes. Terrain stays on its nodes when encounters are reset (see §5.5).

Terrain node. A node on which a terrain token or model is placed at the start of an encounter, as the encounter card directs. A terrain node that holds no terrain is used as a basic node (see §5.1).

Threat. The value that fixes turn order, printed on the character dashboard as its Taunt Level and on enemy, boss, and phantom data cards. Enemies act in descending threat before the characters, who then act in descending threat. The character with the highest threat takes the aggro token at the start of each encounter; the players settle ties (see §3.1; §7.5, Encounter Turn Order).

Tier one treasure. The treasure deck that holds common and class-specific treasure with every stat requirement below 25. Encounter rewards and chests draw from tier one until the mini-boss is defeated (in campaign play, until the *bonfire ascetic* is burnt) (see §6.2).

Tier two treasure. The treasure deck that holds common and class-specific treasure with a stat requirement of 25 or more, all transposed treasure, and the five legendary cards. Encounter rewards and chests draw from tier two once the mini-boss is defeated (in campaign play, once the *bonfire ascetic* is burnt) (see §6.2).

Titanite. A weapon upgrade (Titanite Shard, Titanite Chunk, Titanite Slab, or Titanite Scale) that is fused permanently to the weapon it is attached to. A Titanite Chunk is attached only in place of an attached Titanite Shard, and a Titanite

Slab only in place of an attached Titanite Chunk; the replaced card returns to the bottom of the treasure deck of its tier (see Appendix B). When that weapon is sold, the Titanite is returned with it to the bottom of the treasure deck of the weapon's tier (see §4.2).

Track behaviour card. One of the four behaviour cards of the Executioner's Chariot expansion, named Death Race and numbered 1 to 4, that direct the Chariot's turns in fixed order until it heats up. Each shows the node to which the Chariot moves and the nodes that its attack targets (see §17.9).

Transposed treasure. A class treasure card marked with a blue light. All transposed treasure is tier two.

Transposition. In campaign play, exchanging one boss treasure card and four *souls* for one of the five face-up legendary treasure cards while resting at the *bonfire*. It is available after the last boss of the first section is defeated, and the boss treasure card is returned to the game box (see §18.8).

Trap token. A token, blank or showing a dodge difficulty and a damage value, dealt face down to the basic nodes of a trapped encounter. It is turned face up when a character enters its node by a move, a dodge, or a push, and each character there must suffer the damage or *dodge* it; enemies neither trigger traps nor suffer them (see §5.5, Traps). In a *PvP encounter* one trap token is placed at the end of each character's turn, and a character who fails to dodge it dies (see §20.6).

Treasure card. Any card from a treasure deck or from Blacksmith Andre's shop: *starting equipment*, *common treasure*, *class-specific treasure*, *legendary treasure*, *boss treasure*, or an *ember card*. A treasure card that may be equipped is an *equipment card* (see §2.5; §4.1).

Turn. One model's opportunity to act. In each round the enemies take their turns, then the characters take theirs in descending threat order (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order; §10.1). In a boss encounter the boss takes a turn before each character's turn, and the players choose the order of the characters (see §16.1).

Twin Gargoyles. The boss encounter set by a campaign *section* that lists the Gargoyle as fought twice: one mini-boss encounter in two parts, fought against one Gargoyle and then at once against a second, with no rest or reward between them. The rewards of a defeated boss follow only when the second Gargoyle is defeated, and a failure against either Gargoyle means both are fought again (see §17.1, Twin Gargoyles).

Two-handed. A weapon bearing the two-handed icon, or a one-handed weapon equipped while the other weapon slot holds no card; a shield in the other weapon slot is equipment in the other hand. A weapon wielded two-handed may reroll one die of each attack roll. Spells are never two-handed (see §10.4).

Ultimate victor. The character who wins the *PvP encounter* that follows the defeat of the final boss (see §20.8).

Upgrade card. A card that enhances a weapon or armour card. Blacksmith Andre attaches it beneath the card, up to the card's upgrade slots, and the character must meet its stat requirements to equip the card. Upgrade spells are instead attached as the *Attack* major action during an encounter and return to the inventory afterwards (see §4.2).

Upgrade slot. A space shown by the upgrade slots icon on a weapon or armour card; a card has zero, one, or two. Each attached upgrade card other than an upgrade spell occupies one slot (see §4.2).

Upgrade spell. An upgrade card whose art shows a scroll. It is attached to a weapon or armour card equipped to the same character as the *Attack* major action during an encounter, occupies no upgrade slot, and returns to the inventory when the encounter ends (see §4.2).

Valid node. A node that a model may enter by a given form of movement: an adjacent node not separated from the model's node by a wall and holding no terrain that blocks that form of entry. A node at its node model limit is a valid node (see §5.2).

Victory bonus. The reward for winning a *PvP encounter* that follows the defeat of a boss other than the final boss, marked by one wound token of value 1 placed beside the winner's dashboard. Each victory bonus adds one to the attack value of each of the character's attacks in every subsequent PvP encounter; victory bonuses are cumulative and are kept until the game ends (see §20.8).

Walk. A minor action, once per turn: the character moves one node without spending stamina (see §10.2).

Weak arc. A boss arc shown in red on the arc diagram of the boss's current behaviour card, the card it drew most recently. A character who attacks a boss from a weak arc adds one black die to each attack roll, however many weak arcs the character is in (see §15.6).

Weapon. An equipment card that bears the one-handed or two-handed weapon icon and whose art does not show a scroll. Shields, catalysts, bows, crossbows, and throwable weapons are weapons (see §4.1).

Weapon slot. One of the two dashboard slots, the left weapon slot and the right weapon slot, that each hold one equipped weapon card. A two-handed weapon requires the other weapon slot to be empty (see §3.2).

Wind Up. A behaviour icon printed on behaviour cards of the Asylum Demon and the Stray Demon. When it is resolved, each character may spend one stamina to move to an adjacent node before the next icon is resolved; the movement counts as a *Run* (see §17.3).

Wound token. A token of value 1, 3, or 5 that records the damage suffered by an enemy. Wound tokens with a total value equal to the damage are placed on the enemy model's base, and an enemy whose wound tokens equal or exceed its scaled health is killed and removed from the tile (see §8.2). Bosses, phantoms, and mimics use a health dial instead.



22 CHAPTER 22 F.A.Q.

The questions in this chapter are those that arise most often at the table. Each answer restates a rule of this book and cites the section that owns it. Where an answer and its section disagree, the section governs.

22.1 Characters and Actions

Q Which weapon slot is the left weapon slot, and which is the right?

A The left weapon slot is the weapon slot on the left of the dashboard as its player reads it, and the right weapon slot is the one on the right. A character moves cards between them only by the Equip minor action during an encounter (see §3.2; §10.1).

Q May a character Rest after walking?

A Yes. Only the *Run* minor action prevents the Rest major action in the same turn. Walk, Equip, Heroic Action, and the movement of a *shift* icon do not (see §10.1).

Q May a character run more than once in a turn?

A Yes. Run may be taken any number of times in a turn, at one stamina for each node. Walk, Equip, and Heroic Action may each be taken once (see §10.1).

Q Does Drink Estus remove *hollow cubes*, condition tokens, or stamina cubes?

A No. Drink Estus removes damage cubes only (see §3.5, Estus Flask).

Q May a *heroic action* be used during another model's turn?

A Only if its printed wording says so. Otherwise it is a minor action taken during the character's own turn, and its printed wording overrides any rule with which it conflicts (see §3.5, Heroic Action).

Q May a character pool *souls* with another character?

A Only to burn the *bonfire ascetic*, which the party pays for together (see §18.7). Every other cost is paid from the acting character's own souls: the Firekeeper's stat tiers, Blacksmith Andre's cards, a *summon*, and *transposition* (see §7.6).

Q May a new player join a game in progress?

A Yes, while the characters are on the bonfire tile and at the cost of one *spark*. The new character begins with starting equipment, base stats, and no souls (see §18.4).

22.2 Attack and Defence

Q May the *two-handed* reroll be used together with the *luck* token?

A Yes. The two-handed reroll rerolls one die, and the luck token rerolls any or all of the dice. Both may be used on the same roll, in either order, and each new result stands (see §10.3; §10.4).

Q Does the limit of one spell attack option per turn include *upgrade spells*?

A Yes. Attaching an upgrade spell is done as the Attack major action and is the character's one spell attack option for that turn (see §4.2, Upgrade Spells).

Q How is a *block* or *resist* roll resolved with one die, or with no dice?

A With one die, the defence total is that die's result. With no dice, the defence total is zero, and the character suffers the full attack value. Fixed modifiers are applied in either case (see §9.4).

Q May a character with no dodge dice attempt to *dodge*?

A Yes. The character pays one stamina. Against a dodge difficulty of zero the dodge succeeds without a roll. Against any higher difficulty a roll of no dice fails, unless the character pays two further stamina to add one green die (see §9.5).

Q After a failed dodge, do the modifiers of the armour dice still apply?

A Yes. The character rolls only the block or resist dice of the armour card and of the upgrade cards attached to it, and applies the fixed modifiers of those dice. The dice and modifiers of weapons, shields, and spells are ignored (see §9.5, Failed Dodge).

Q May a character with a two-handed weapon *parry*?

A No. A parry requires a shield in the left weapon slot. A weapon that bears the two-handed icon requires the other weapon slot to be empty, and a one-handed weapon wielded two-handed has no shield beside it (see §9.6; §10.4).

Q May an enemy dodge or parry a *riposte*?

A No. A riposte is resolved as any character attack against the enemy's block or resist value. Against a boss, a riposte made from a *weak arc* gains the weak-arc die (see §9.6; §15.6, Weak Arcs).

Q How is a weapon *scaled*?

A A weapon is scaled while the character's stat exceeds the weapon's highest stat requirement by five or more. Each of its attack options then adds one to its attack value. Spells are never scaled (see §10.5).

Q With four characters, does the increase of one to enemy attack values apply to a *push-move* that deals damage?

A Yes. The increase applies to every attack icon on an enemy's data card and to the damage value of a push-move. It does not apply to a boss, a *mimic*, a *phantom*, or a *crystal lizard* (see §8.3).

Q Do dead and *lost* characters count for enemy scaling?

A Yes. Enemies are scaled for the number of characters in the party, whether or not every character is in play (see §8.3).

22.3 Conditions and Terrain

Q How is *stagger* applied to a roll?

A One is subtracted from the total of the attack, block, resist, or dodge roll, after the dice have been added and every reroll taken. It is not subtracted from each die. The token is removed at the end of the staggered model's next complete turn (see §8.5, Stagger).

Q Does *frostbite* stop the one stamina recovered at the start of a character's turn?

A Yes. A character with a frostbite token recovers no stamina by any means: the character does not recover one stamina at the start of the turn and cannot take the Rest major action (see §8.5, Frostbite).

Q A character holds three *poison* tokens. How much damage does the character suffer?

A Three damage at the end of the character's turn, one for each token. All three tokens are then removed (see §8.5, Poison).

Q Does the *embered* reduction of damage apply to *bleed*, poison, and trap damage?

A No. The reduction applies only to an attack that deals three or more damage. Bleed and poison damage are not attacks, and neither is the damage of a trap (see §7.3; §8.5; §5.5, Traps).

Q May a character dodge into a node that holds a *barrel*?

A Yes. The barrel is destroyed. A character cannot dodge into a node that holds a *gravestone*, a *chest*, or a *pillar token*. A character with no valid node to enter may still dodge, and stays on their node (see §5.5; §9.5, Successful Dodge).

Q Does a character who dodges onto a face-down *trap token* trigger it?

A Yes. A character who enters the node by a move, by the movement that follows a dodge, or by a *push* turns the token face up, and each character on the node must suffer its damage or dodge it (see §5.5, Traps).

Q Do enemies trigger traps?

A No. Only characters trigger traps, and only characters are affected by them (see §5.5, Traps).

22.4 Encounters, Souls, and the Bonfire

Q Who decides when the rules leave a choice or a tie to the players?

A The players decide together. A tie in *threat* between characters is settled at Encounter Start and is kept for the whole encounter, and a tie between enemy models is settled by the order stated for enemy turns (see §7.5). When the players cannot agree on which character receives a treasure card, the card goes to the character who holds the *aggro token* (see §7.7).

Q Who holds the aggro token when its holder dies?

A The token moves at once to the living character with the highest threat (see §7.5, Encounter Turn Order).

Q May a *hollow* character skip encounters that are marked *cleared*?

A Yes, if the character has room on the endurance bar. Each character places one stamina cube for each encounter skipped, to a maximum of three, and the party may skip only if every character has free spaces for those cubes. A hollow character has eight usable spaces (see §7.5, Encounter Start; §7.2).

Q After resting at the bonfire, may a cleared encounter still be skipped?

A Yes. The rest resets every encounter, but a cleared encounter keeps its black cube. When the characters next enter its tile, the party may skip it or fight it again for the *reduced reward* and no treasure. An encounter without a black cube must be fought (see §7.5; §11.5).

Q What is the reduced reward for an encounter that is cleared again?

A Half the full soul reward, rounded down. The reward table gives both values, and campaign play uses the same table (see §7.6; §18.5).

Q An encounter is cleared, later failed, and then cleared once more. Does it pay the full reward again?

A No. The full reward and the treasure cards are awarded only while the treasure cards dealt to the tile still lie on it. A later clear pays the reduced reward and no treasure, and marks the encounter cleared again (see §7.5, Encounter Resolution).

Q The characters are required to rest, and the *spark* dial shows zero. What happens?

A The players lose the game (see §7.1).

Q Does a *Level 4 encounter* reset when the characters rest?

A Not once it has been cleared: a cleared Level 4 encounter is not fought again. A failed Level 4 encounter resets as any other encounter does (see §6.7, Level 4 Encounters).

Q Where does a sold boss treasure card go?

A To the game box. Boss treasure enters neither treasure deck (see §11.4, Sales).

22.5 Bosses

Q Are Ornstein & Smough one boss or two?

A One boss with two models. The models share one data card, one health dial, and one behaviour deck, and the boss heats up once. Each behaviour card names the model that acts. A character who attacks either model attacks the boss, and the weak-arc die is judged against the arcs of the model attacked (see §17.2).

Q A campaign section lists the Gargoyle twice. Are the two fights separate encounters?

A No. The *Twin Gargoyles* are one boss encounter in two parts. The characters do not rest between the parts, and the souls, the boss treasure card, and the spark are awarded only when the second Gargoyle is defeated (see §17.1, Twin Gargoyles).

Q In what order do the characters act in a boss encounter?

A The players choose which living character takes each character turn. No living character takes a second turn in a round until every other living character has taken one (see §16.1).

Q A character is pushed off a boss's node. Must the character stay in the same arc?

A Yes. The character is pushed to a valid adjacent node in the arc in which the character is placed. If a wall leaves no such node, the character is pushed to a valid adjacent node that touches the wall (see §15.6, Characters and Arcs).

Q Does a character who dies in a mega-boss encounter leave the game?

A No. Death and hollowing are resolved in a mega-boss encounter as in any other encounter (see §7.2; §15.2).

Q When does the aggro token move in a boss encounter?

A At the end of the turn of each character who inflicted damage on the boss during that turn. Damage inflicted by a summon does not move it (see §16.4).

22.6 Phantoms, Mimics, and Crystal Lizards

Q When does a *summon* act in a boss encounter?

A After each character's turn and before the boss's next turn (see §12.1, Summon Turns).

Q May an *invader* appear in a boss encounter?

A No. Invader tokens are placed only on the encounter cards of encounter tiles (see §12.2, Invader Tokens).

Q May a summon and an invader take part in the same encounter?

A No. A summon is called only for a boss encounter, and no invader appears in one (see §12.1; §12.2).

Q An invader is on the tile and a character dies. Does the encounter continue?

A Yes. The invader vanishes at once and awards nothing, and the encounter continues against the remaining enemy models. The invader does not return (see §12.2, Combat with an Invader).

Q Must an invader be killed for its encounter to be cleared?

A Not always. While the invader is on the tile, the encounter is not cleared. It is cleared when every enemy model, the invader included, has been killed, or when the invader has vanished and every other enemy model has been killed (see §12.2, End of an Invasion).

Q A chest proves to be a *mimic*, and every character dies. What happens?

A The mimic encounter is failed, and with it the encounter that held the chest. The mimic returns to its chest, and the characters must rest at the bonfire. Each later time that encounter is cleared, the party again decides whether to open the chest (see §13.4).

Q Do *crystal lizards* prevent an encounter from being cleared?

A No. The encounter is cleared when every other enemy model has been killed, and every crystal lizard still on the tile escapes and awards nothing (see §14).

22.7 Campaign Play

Q When may a character transpose boss treasure?

A During any rest at the bonfire once the first *section* of the campaign has been completed. Each transposition costs one boss treasure card and four souls (see §18.8).

Q Does the bonfire ascetic increase enemy attack values?

A No. It increases the base health of every enemy that is subject to enemy scaling by two, in addition to the increase for the number of characters. Attack values and movement values are unchanged (see §18.7).

Q Is the *fog gate* a shortcut in campaign play?

A No. In campaign play the fog gate token marks the entrance to the boss encounter and nothing more (see §18.2).

Q How many sparks may a party hold in campaign play?

A One more than the number with which the party began. A spark is gained for each boss defeated, up to that maximum (see §18.3).



APPENDIX A

A Weapon Stat Revisions

The *stat requirements* in this appendix replace those printed on the *weapon* cards listed. A weapon not listed keeps its printed requirements. The revised requirements decide the treasure tier of a listed weapon: a requirement of 25 or more in any stat makes the card *tier two treasure*, and a card whose requirements are all below 25 is *tier one treasure* unless its treasure type places it elsewhere (see §6.2). A listed weapon is *scaled* against the highest requirement given here, and the stat of that requirement is its *relevant stat* (see §10.5).

Revised Requirements

The table gives the four *stat requirements* of each listed *weapon*: strength (STR), dexterity (DEX), intelligence (INT), and faith (FTH). A character may equip a listed weapon only if each of the character's stats equals or exceeds the matching requirement in the table (see §4.1, Stat Requirements). The Tier column shows 1 for *tier one treasure* and 2 for *tier two treasure*.

WEAPON	STR	DEX	INT	FTH	TIER
Avelyn	23	30	0	0	2
Bewitched Alonne Sword	18	24	0	0	1
Black Knight Greataxe	32	20	0	0	2
Black Knight Halberd	32	18	0	0	2
Brigand Axe	19	16	0	0	1
Butcher Knife	24	0	0	0	1
Caestus	12	10	0	0	1
Carthus Curved Greatsword	25	35	0	0	2
Carthus Curved Sword	19	30	0	0	2
Chariot Lance	22	33	0	0	2
Claws	12	20	0	0	1
Crystal Straight Sword	21	30	0	0	2
Dark Silver Tracer	12	26	0	0	2
Dragon Tooth	40	25	0	0	2
Drake Sword	27	17	0	0	2
Drakewing Ultra Greatsword	33	23	0	0	2
East-West Shield	28	0	0	0	2
Falchion	17	30	0	0	2
Four-Pronged Plough	23	18	0	0	1
Giant's Halberd	27	16	0	0	2
Gold Tracer	25	35	0	0	2
Gravelord Sword	32	18	0	0	2
Great Mace	28	0	0	0	2
Halberd	31	18	0	0	2
Irithyll Rapier	24	24	0	0	1
Irithyll Straight Sword	23	23	0	0	1
Lifehunt Scythe	32	23	0	0	2
Lucerne	22	31	0	0	2
Mace	16	0	0	0	1
Manikin Claws	14	24	0	0	1
Morning Star	16	0	0	0	1
Murakumo	27	17	0	0	2
Onikiri and Ubadachi	26	36	0	0	2
Painting Guardian Curved Sword	18	26	0	0	2
Parrying Dagger	10	18	0	0	1
Partizan	28	17	0	0	2
Pike	23	16	0	0	1
Poison Throwing Knives	0	14	0	0	1
Priscilla's Dagger	0	31	0	0	2
Rapier	14	21	0	0	1
Reinforced Club	23	0	0	0	1
Rotten Ghru Dagger	17	17	0	0	1
Rotten Ghru Spear	12	21	0	0	1
Royal Dirk	18	31	0	0	2
Scimitar	18	20	0	0	1
Shield Crossbow	33	20	0	0	2
Shotel	26	29	0	0	2
Silver Knight Spear	22	26	0	0	2
Silver Knight Straight Sword	16	22	0	0	1
Spiked Mace	32	22	0	0	2
Spotted Whip	23	30	0	0	2
Sunlight Straight Sword	15	15	0	0	1
Throwing Knives	0	14	0	0	1
Uchigatana	14	32	0	0	2
Umbral Dagger	18	35	0	0	2
Vordt's Great Hammer	33	0	0	0	2
Warden Twinblades	17	26	0	0	2

Weapon	STR	DEX	INT	FTH	Tier
Washing Pole	37	21	0	0	2
Winged Knight Halberd	32	16	0	0	2
Winged Spear	20	22	0	0	1

Every listed weapon has 0 INT and 0 FTH. A weapon shown with 0 STR or 0 DEX has no requirement in that stat, and every character meets it.

> Example The Brigand Axe's revised requirements are 19 STR and 16 DEX, so strength is its *relevant stat*. The Knight has 24 STR and 20 DEX, meets both requirements, and equips the Brigand Axe. The Knight's strength exceeds 19 by five, so the Brigand Axe is *scaled*, and each of its *attack options* adds one to its *attack value*.

Treasure Type

The Tier column follows from the revised *stat requirements* alone. A listed card that is *transposed treasure* or *legendary treasure* is *tier two treasure* whatever its requirements (see §6.2). A listed card that is *boss treasure* enters neither treasure deck and is placed with its boss (see §6.2).


Silver Knight Spearman


Ironclad Soldier


Sir Alonne


Stone Knight


Stone Guardian


Pursuer


Guardian Armour



APPENDIX B

B Card Amendments

The cards listed in this appendix are added to the cards in play or take the place of printed cards. The *revised cards* replace the printed cards of the same name. Where a card listed here differs from its printed text, the text given here governs. Where only part of a card is amended, every other part of the card is as printed.

Additional Treasure

Each card listed in this section is added to the *treasure cards* in play. Each card is sorted during setup by the treasure type marked on it and by its *stat requirements* (see §6.2). A card marked as *boss treasure* is placed with its boss and enters neither treasure deck (see §6.2).

CARD	AMENDMENT
Black Knight Greataxe	Add the card. Its stat requirements are those given in Appendix A.
Black Knight Halberd	Add the card. Its stat requirements are those given in Appendix A.
Black Knight Shield	Add the card.
Black Knight Sword	Add the card.
Bloodshield	Add the card.
Blue Titanite	Add the card as amended (see Appendix B, Revised Treasure).
Bonewheel Shield	Add the card.
Carthus Curved Greatsword	Add the card. Its stat requirements are those given in Appendix A.
Cleric Armour	Add the card.
Crescent Axe	Add the card.
Divine Blessing	Add the card.
Exile Greatsword	Add the card.
Gravelord Sword	Add the card. Its stat requirements are those given in Appendix A.
Gravelord Sword Dance	Add the card.
Greatsword	Add the card.
Hollow Soldier Shield	Add the card.
Lifehunt Scythe	Add the card. Its stat requirements are those given in Appendix A.
Lothric Knight Greatsword	Add the card.
Mask of the Child	Add the card.
Painting Guardian Armour	Add the card.
Paladin Armour	Add the card.
Pike	Add the card. Its stat requirements are those given in Appendix A.
Priscilla's Dagger	Add the card. Its stat requirements are those given in Appendix A.
Red and White Round Shield	Add the card.
Red Tearstone Ring	Add the card.
Skull Lantern	Add the card.
Soul Spear	Add the card.
Steel Armour	Add the card.
Sunlight Shield	Add the card.
Thorolund Talisman	Add the card.
Throwing Knives	Add the card. Its stat requirements are those given in Appendix A.
Tower Shield	Add the card.
Velka's Rapier	Add the card.
Xanthous Robes	Add the card.

Revised Treasure

Each card listed in this section is played as amended here, and it is sorted during setup by its treasure type and *stat requirements* as amended (see §6.2). A ring is an *upgrade card* (see §4.1). In this section, the wearer of a ring is the character who has *equipped* the card to which the ring is attached.

CARD	AMENDMENT
Black Leather Armour	Replace the printed rules text with: "The character who has this card equipped pays no stamina to attempt a *dodge*." Step 1 of the dodge is skipped (see §9.5). Where two printings of the card exist, the printing that carries this text is used.
Blue Titanite	Replace the printed treasure type with *legendary treasure*. Replace the printed INT requirement with 25. The rules text is unchanged.

Card	Amendment
Carthus Milkring	Replace the printed rules text with: "The wearer adds 1 to the count of dodge icons rolled for a dodge." The 1 is added in step 6 of the dodge (see §9.5). Where two printings of the card exist, the printing that carries this text is used.
Chloranthy Ring	Replace the printed rules text with: "At the start of each of the wearer's turns, the wearer and every other character on the wearer's *node* each recover 1 stamina." The wearer recovers this stamina in addition to the stamina of step 1 of the turn (see §10.1).
Covetous Silver Serpent Ring	Replace the printed rules text with: "When the wearer gains the soul reward for a *cleared encounter*, the wearer gains 1 additional soul." The additional soul is gained with the full reward and with the *reduced reward* (see §7.6).
Demon Titanite	Replace the printed card with the *revised card*. The rules text, stat requirements, and treasure type are unchanged.
Eastern Armour	Replace the printed rules text with: "The character who has this card equipped pays 1 additional stamina to attempt a dodge." Step 1 of the dodge costs 2 stamina (see §9.5). Where two printings of the card exist, the printing that carries this text is used.
Mon Ring	Add to the printed rules text: "This effect may be used only while this card is face up. When the effect is used, turn this card face down." The card is turned face up each time the characters rest at the *bonfire* (see §11.2).
Sellsword Twinblades	The one-handed card of this name is used. A two-handed card of this name is returned to the game box.
Tiny Being's Ring	Replace the printed rules text with: "At the start of each of the wearer's turns, the wearer removes 1 *damage cube* from their *endurance bar*."
Titanite Chunk	Replace the printed rules text with: "Every *attack option* of the *weapon* adds 2 to its *attack value*. This card may be attached only in place of a Titanite Shard." Replace the printed stat requirements with 25 STR, 25 DEX, 0 INT, and 0 FTH. The card is *common treasure* and tier two (see §6.2).
Titanite Slab	Replace the printed rules text with: "Every attack option of the weapon adds 3 to its attack value. This card may be attached only in place of a Titanite Chunk." Replace the printed stat requirements with 25 STR, 25 DEX, 0 INT, and 0 FTH. The card is legendary treasure (see §6.2).
Wolf Ring	Replace the printed rules text with: "After rolling the dice for a dodge, the wearer may pay 1 stamina to reroll any or all of those dice. The wearer may do this once for each dodge." The reroll is made in step 5 of the dodge, before the dodge icons are counted (see §9.5).

Titanite Replacement

A Titanite Chunk may be attached only to a weapon that has a Titanite Shard attached. A Titanite Slab may be attached only to a weapon that has a Titanite Chunk attached. Blacksmith Andre makes the replacement while the characters rest at the bonfire (see §11.4).

The Titanite Chunk or Titanite Slab occupies the *upgrade slot* of the card it replaces. A replaced *Titanite* card does not remain fused to the weapon (see §4.2, Titanite). A replaced Titanite Shard is returned to the bottom of the tier one treasure deck, and a replaced Titanite Chunk is returned to the bottom of the tier two treasure deck.

A character may equip a weapon with a Titanite Chunk or a Titanite Slab attached only if the character has at least 25 STR and at least 25 DEX and meets the stat requirements of the weapon (see §4.2).

Enemy Data Cards

Each enemy listed in this section is played from the revised *data card* of the same name, which shows the values of an enemy data card (see §8.2). The revised data card is used with the enemy's models (see §2.2). The printed data card of that enemy is returned to the game box.

Card	Amendment
Bonewheel Skeleton	Replace the printed data card of the Painted World of Ariamis expansion with the revised data card.
Crow Demon	Replace the printed data card of the Painted World of Ariamis expansion with the revised data card.
Engorged Zombie	Replace the printed data card of the Painted World of Ariamis expansion with the revised data card.
Giant Skeleton Archer	Replace the printed data card of the Tomb of Giants expansion with the revised data card.
Giant Skeleton Soldier	Replace the printed data card of the Tomb of Giants expansion with the revised data card.

Card	Amendment
Necromancer	Replace the printed data card of the Tomb of Giants expansion with the revised data card.
Phalanx	Replace the printed data card of the Painted World of Ariamis expansion with the revised data card.
Phalanx Hollow	Replace the printed data card of the Painted World of Ariamis expansion with the revised data card.
Skeleton Archer	Replace the printed data card of the Tomb of Giants expansion with the revised data card.
Skeleton Beast	Replace the printed data card of the Tomb of Giants expansion with the revised data card.
Skeleton Soldier	Replace the printed data card of the Tomb of Giants expansion with the revised data card.
Snow Rat	Replace the printed data card of the Painted World of Ariamis expansion with the revised data card.

Boss Data and Behaviour Cards

Each *boss* listed in this section is played from the revised *data card* of the same name and the general boss rules (see §15.4, §16.1). Its *behaviour deck* is built from the revised *behaviour cards* of the same name (see §15.5). The revised cards are used with the boss's model, *health dial*, and *boss treasure* cards, and the printed data card and behaviour cards of that boss are returned to the game box. The special rules of each boss, if any, are stated with the boss special rules (see §17.7, §17.10).

Card	Amendment
Black Knight	The Black Knight is a *mini-boss* of the Tomb of Giants expansion. Replace its printed data card and behaviour cards with the revised data card and the revised behaviour cards.
Crossbreed Priscilla	Crossbreed Priscilla is a *main-boss* of the Painted World of Ariamis expansion. Replace its printed data card and behaviour cards with the revised data card and the revised behaviour cards.
Gravelord Nito	Gravelord Nito is a main-boss of the Tomb of Giants expansion. Replace its printed data card and behaviour cards with the revised data card and the revised behaviour cards.
Heavy Knight	The Heavy Knight is a mini-boss of the Painted World of Ariamis expansion. Replace its printed data card and behaviour cards with the revised data card and the revised behaviour cards.



Encounter Card, Level 1



Treasure Card



The Dice



Spark Dial

Icon Reference



 Area attack §16.3

 Armour §3.2

 Armour upgrade §4.2

 Attack arc §15.6

 Attack icon §8.2

 Barrel §2.8

 Behaviour deck size §8.2

 Black die §2.7

 Bleed §2.8

 Block §4.1

 Block and resist values §8.2

 Blue die §2.7

 Chest §2.8

 Dodge §2.7

 Frostbite §2.8

 Giant Skeleton Archer §2.2

 Giant Skeleton Soldier §2.2

 Gravestone §2.8

 Health §8.2

 Heat-up point §8.2

 Level 1 encounter §2.6

 Level 2 encounter §2.6

 Level 3 encounter §2.6

 Magical damage §4.3

 Movement icon §8.2

 Nearest character §8.2

 Necromancer §2.2

 Neutral arc §15.6

 Node attack and area-of-effect §9.3

 One-handed weapon §3.2

 Orange die §2.7

 Poison §2.8

 Push §8.4

 Push with a damage value §8.2

 Range §4.1

 Repeat §8.2

 Resist §4.1

 Shaft §10.3

 Shift §10.2

 Skeleton Archer §2.2

 Skeleton Beast §2.2

 Skeleton Soldier §2.2

 Spawn node §5.1

 Stagger §2.8

 Terrain node §5.1

 Threat §7.5

 Threat (dashboard) §3.1

 Trapped encounter §2.6

 Turn 90° left §15.6

 Turn 90° right §15.6

 Turn around §15.6

 Two-handed weapon §3.2

 Upgrade slots §4.1

 Weak arc §12.1

 Weapon upgrade §4.2

Dark Souls: The Board Game, Second Edition is a cooperative dungeon crawl for one to four players. Each player controls one character. The party explores a chain of encounters, learns the behaviours of its enemies, returns to the bonfire to rest and grow stronger, and at last faces a boss.

Nameless accursed undead, seek strength, and prepare to die.